

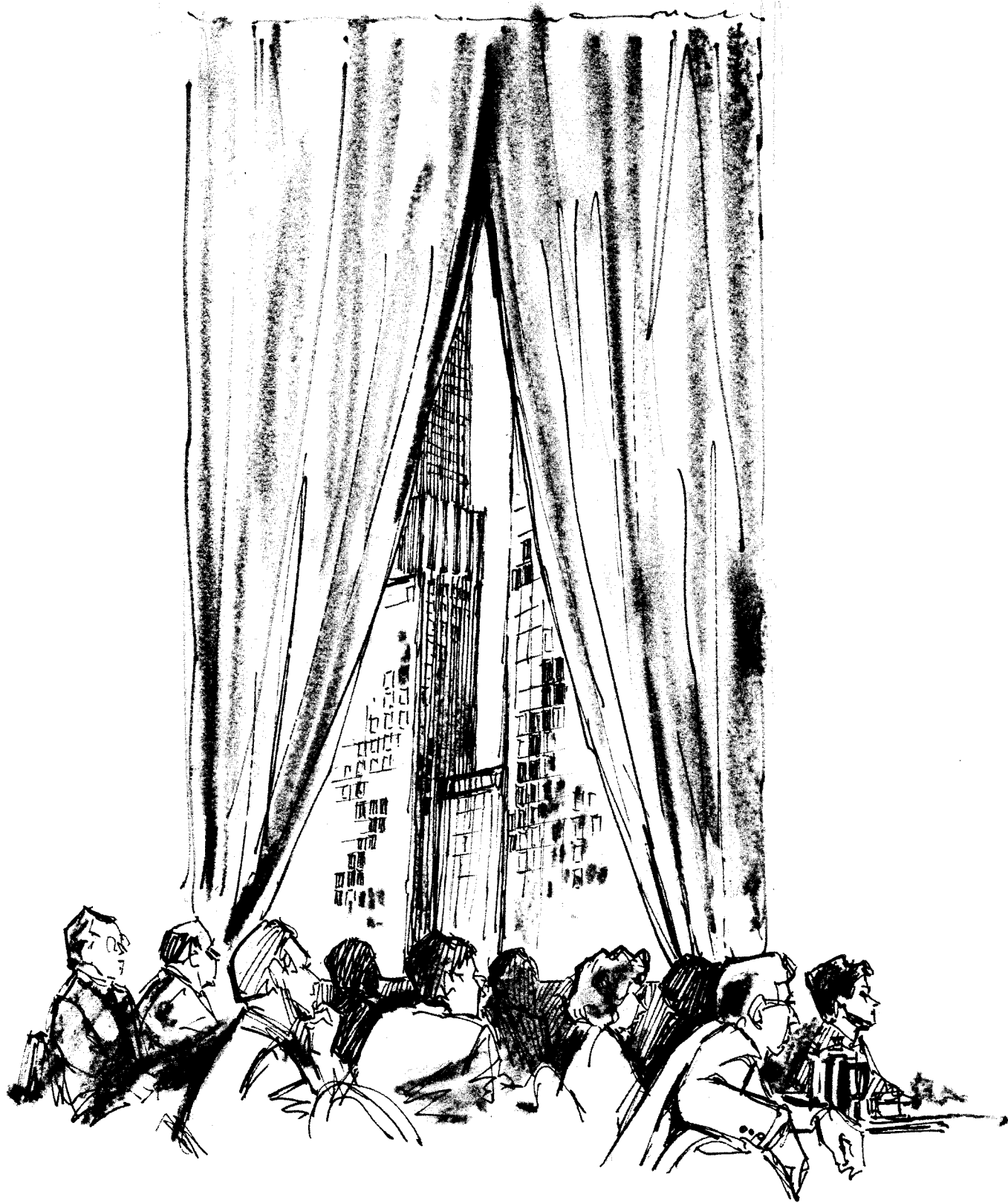
Anonymity - Living Our Traditions

**THE THIRTY-NINTH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

***1989
Final Report***

Omni Park Central Hotel, New York City, April 23 — 29

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468 PARK AVENUE SOUTH, NEW YORK, NY 10016



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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses, just as A.A. directories do.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



39TH CONFERENCE

"Anonymity—Living Our Traditions"

"If I were asked which one of these blessings I felt was most responsible for our growth as a fellowship and most vital to our continuity, I would say, the 'Concept of Anonymity.'"

As most A.A.s know, those words are taken from co-founder Bill Wilson's final message, in 1970. In the shrinking world of the 1980s, with advanced media coverage and an ever-growing membership worldwide, anonymity and all that it encompasses is increasingly important. With this in mind the 39th U.S./Canada General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous addressed the Tradition that is our "spiritual foundation" through the theme of "Anonymity—Living Our Traditions."

The 133 Conference members, made up of delegates from the 91 service areas of the U.S. and Canada, trustees, directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members, met April 23-29 at the Omni Park Central Hotel in New York City.

The Conference was chaired by Michael Alexander, newly appointed chairman of the General Service Board. Mike is no stranger to A.A., having served as Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee from 1976 to 1985.

Wayne Parks, as of April 1 G.S.O.'s general manager, co-chaired the Conference. A former Class B (alcoholic) trustee from the Southwest U.S. region, Wayne succeeded John Bragg as G.S.O.'s fifth general manager.

To allow extra time, this year's Conference officially began Sunday afternoon instead of Monday morning. Following registration, Michael Alexander began by speaking of the Conference as the voice and effective conscience of A.A. He urged that "what we do must be done in harmony and good faith. A.A. is on the threshold of bright new vistas to extend the hand of A.A. to every person on the face of this earth." Mike then read the Warranties from the Twelfth Concept for World Service—which are read before every Conference.

Mike then introduced former G.S.O. general manager John Bragg, who said a few words and asked for Conference members' prayers for G.S.O. office manager Tony Osnato, who was gravely ill. Tony, who for many years handled the logistics of the Conference and acted as liaison between G.S.O. and the hotel, passed away the following day. His presence and humor were missed this year and he will be fondly remembered by former Conference members and G.S.O. employees for many years to come.

G.S.O. general manager Wayne Parks then called the roll, introduced Conference committee chairpeople and ran through the mechanics of the Conference.

G.S.O. Conference coordinator Helen Turnquest reviewed the agenda, Conference Manual and general housekeeping items during Conference week. Delegate chairperson Herb Wales concluded the afternoon schedule with a welcoming address (see page 7).

Sunday evening the opening dinner was held in the hotel's Forum Room. Michael Alexander told Conference members and their guests that this was the first Conference in 39 years where there was not a link with the founders, for it was the first Conference dinner without co-founder Bill Wilson's widow, Lois, who died in October of 1988. Mike also remembered the two other pioneers the Fellowship lost in the past year: Class A trustees emeriti Dr. John Norris and Dr. Milton Maxwell. Thus it was fitting, Mike said, "that our attention be drawn to anonymity—the lasting and continuing message from Bill—not the *last* message. Anonymity is a companion to humility—and Bill's message on humility is essential to the program." Mike introduced Ellie Norris, widow of "Dr. Jack," who was given a respectful standing

ovation. Later in the week A.A. lost another link with its past. Dr. Leonard Strong, who was Bill Wilson's brother-in-law and a Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee from 1939-1954, died on April 26.

An A.A. meeting followed dinner, chaired by Bill Miller (Vermont) and led by Roger Mansfield (Western Michigan). Speakers were: Don Bruner (Class B trustee), Gay Garner (Georgia), John Grant (G.S.O. staff), Fran Polek (Grapevine director) and Red Walker (Alberta/Northwest Territory).

The General Service Conference meeting is much like a local group business meeting—only longer and larger. The activity-filled week began on Monday morning with the keynote address by Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee Dr. William Flynn (see page 8). Throughout the week members listened to presentations that addressed key issues for the Fellowship: Anonymity, Self-Support, Back to Basics, Finance and the Grapevine. (Presentations are printed, in full, beginning on page 18). A brief presentation was given commemorating the 50th anniversary of the publication of the Big Book, followed by a striking cake with reproductions of the original red and yellow "circus" cover and our present "A.A.-blue" dust jacket (see page 21.)

Conference members gave rapt attention to reports on the recent trip to the Soviet Union—A.A.'s most recent frontier—and were eager for news about the "most important people in the room," the members of the Moscow Beginners Group. Just slightly more than a year in advance of the celebration of A.A.'s 55th Anniversary at the 1990 International Convention in Seattle, Washington. Conference members were stirred to high enthusiasm by presentations from Joe Phelan, chairperson of the trustees' International Convention Committee; Curtis Monahan, G.S.O.'s staff member who is coordinating the Convention; and, with more than a touch of local color, a rousing presentation from Lonnie Williams, delegate from Washington state.

During the week much time is spent in committee meetings where delegates discuss and weigh matters important to the Fellowship they represent and make decisions that eventually result in Conference Advisory Actions (see page 13).

Each morning at 7:30 the General Service Conference Serenity Group, chaired by Betty Currier (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire), met in the Forum Room Lounge. A different delegate chaired each morning, sharing on a reading from *As Bill Sees It*. Friday morning, at a record five-minute business meeting, Frank King (Colorado) was elected chairperson for the 40th Conference, with Frances Cherry (South Florida) to serve as secretary/treasurer. A copy of *As Bill Sees It*, signed by all who had attended the A.A. meeting during the week, was raffled off and won by Dick Rowell (Maryland). After paying the \$11.00 in expenses, group secretary/treasurer Lou Gifford (New Hampshire)—in the spirit of the Seventh Tradition—turned over \$201.00 to the General Service Office.

Throughout the week new delegates (Panel 39) gave Area Highlight Reports (see page 56); a lunchtime workshop, based on the Conference theme, was held (see report back, page 10); and a Delegates Dinner and meeting was held on Tuesday evening. Elected to be delegate chairperson for the 1990 Conference was Reba Warren (Eastern Pennsylvania), with alternate chairperson Carolyn Beaupre (British Columbia/Yukon). Two "What's On Your Mind?" sharing sessions gave delegates and other Conference members an opportunity to express their concerns, offer suggestions, and share experience from their areas.

Just as rotation is the "spirit of service" at the group level, so it is on the General Service Board. Wednesday afternoon Conference members voted to recommend the election of five new trustees

to the General Service Board: Jacqueline Martin as Southeast U.S. regional trustee; Jan Whitney, East Central U.S. regional trustee; and John Quinn, trustee-at-large/U.S. The two new general service trustees will be Stanley Silverman and Harold Greene. The Conference also approved the trustees' Nominating Committee's recommendation of John Nelson Chappel, M.D. as Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee. All were approved at the April 29 General Service Board meeting following the close of the Conference. The board also approved the appointment of three new directors: Jane Murphy Schulberg and Bernard Benziger to the Grapevine Corporate Board, and Michael McPherson, A.A. World Services Board.

Friday morning, after the final Advisory Actions had been approved and the Back to Basics presentations given, two closing talks helped put the week in perspective.

John Bragg, who retired as G.S.O.'s general manager April 1 after five years of service, reminded the Conference that while all Twelve Traditions repeatedly ask us to give up personal desires for the common good, we realize that the sacrificial spirit—well symbolized by anonymity—is the foundation of all the Traditions.

G.S.O. staff member Betty Liddle, who will retire in September, gave her talk in three parts: I remember; I wish; and I believe. Betty, who celebrated her 26th A.A. anniversary during Conference week, said that her 17 years of service at the General Service Office had given her "the gift of being of use."

The Conference was then officially closed with the Serenity Prayer in French, Spanish and English.

Saturday morning Conference members met for the last time at the closing brunch. It was a "poignant time," said Michael Alexander, as he opened the program—traditionally, farewell talks from rotating trustees.

Dr. Bill Flynn, who served as Class A trustee for nine years, reviewed A.A.'s coming of age in the 1980s, speaking of other self-help groups, court systems, how the message has reached Poland and Russia, and posed the question of how will we extend the growth of the '80s to new frontiers in the '90s—to Native Americans and blacks. Bill told the audience that by allowing him to be of use "you gave me far more than I could ever give back."

Joe Phelan, rotating Southeast U.S. regional trustee, addressing the "people I will always know in my heart, but will not see as often," said that the "joy of rotation overshadowed the sadness."

"With the collective power of Alcoholics Anonymous and the power of God, anybody can do anything," rotating trustee-at-large/U.S. Don Pritts said. And, as though to prove his point, he told about receiving a Big Book in the penitentiary and being told that in three weeks he had to give it away. Referring to the leather-bound Big Book each trustee receives upon rotation, Don said, "Today I get a book; three weeks from now I go back to chair the Twelfth Step Group in my penitentiary." Every sober alcoholic reaches A.A. by a different path—so too, are A.A.s led into service work. General service trustee Shepherd Raimi got into service via the bridge table. One of his bridge friends was G.S.O. staff member Betty Liddle who "gave me meetings between hands and led me into service." Shep also spoke of his 91-year-old father, whom he recently heard quoting a biblical saying in Hebrew: "The stone they threw away became the cornerstone." "I knew he was speaking of me," Shep closed, "and it is thanks to all of you."



Jim Shannon, general service trustee, told his drunkalog and the room immediately responded with that special warm laughter of identification and wave of love that is felt in every A.A. meeting. Jim said he wanted to tell his story, because, in the midst of so many well-dressed people, he was afraid he might forget where he came from. Although his first G.S.R. meeting was an "awful piece of confusion," Jim said his many years in service had helped him reach a new spirituality.

Speaking last, East Central U.S. regional trustee Jack Whitehouse said, "... everything has been said except 'I love you' and service is love with its work clothes on." The current delegate from Jack's area used to chair workshops for Jack when he was a delegate; now Jack is going back to work for him, and "that's rotation."

Michael Alexander closed by saying "God placed Alcoholics Anonymous and its Legacies in our hands for a limited period of time. With its significant and glorious past there is no reason not to believe in its future."

Why, year after year, do a small group of people come together to work so hard at the General Service Conference? Former G.S.O. general manager John Bragg answered that question in his Friday afternoon closing talk, quoting from the late Class A trustee Bernard Smith, one of the architects of the General Service Conference:

"We may not need a General Service Conference to insure our own recovery. But we do need it to insure the recovery of the alcoholic who still stumbles in the darkness, seeking the light. We need it to insure the recovery of some newborn child, inexplicably destined to alcoholism. We need it to provide, in keeping with the Twelfth Step, a permanent haven for all alcoholics who in the ages ahead can find in A.A. that rebirth which brought its first members back to life.

"We need it because we are conscious of the devastating effect of the human urge for power and prestige which must never be permitted to invade A.A. We need a Conference to insure A.A. against government while insulating it against anarchy; we need it to protect the fellowship against disintegration while preventing overintegration. We need it so that Alcoholics Anonymous and Alcoholics Anonymous alone may be the ultimate repository of its own Twelve Steps, its Twelve Traditions, and all of its Services.

"We need a Conference to insure that changes within A.A. come only as a response to the needs and wants of all A.A., and not of any few. We need it to insure that the doors of the halls of A.A. shall never have locks on them, so that all people with an alcoholic problem for all time to come may enter these halls unmasked and feel welcome. We need it to help insure that Alcoholics Anonymous never asks of anyone who needs help what his or her race is, what his or her creed is, or what his or her social position is." (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 281)

Welcome

Today I bring you sober greetings from the Northwest Texas Area and by the mystical draw from the hat am privileged to extend this welcome to all delegates as we convene this 39th General Service Conference. As a new delegate last year, I approached the Conference experience with mixed feelings of awe, fear, pride, an occasional breath of humility, challenge and anticipation. I came over-prepared (in some respects) and probably forgot Rule 62 often as I sought my heroic role in the Grand Process. Luckily my good friend and sponsor (the two are *NOT* incompatible), Pete P. of Panel 37, Northwest Texas, was here to remind me that "We're survivors, not senators."

Especially for delegates of Panel 39, I would like to share two pervasive feelings which arrived with me last year, but dissipated as I came to realize they were not uniquely mine. First, I had this feeling of impending inadequacy. Still feeling not quite worthy to be among this august group, I wondered if I had sufficient foundation in our Traditions and Concepts. Soon, however, much like my early experiences in the Fellowship, I was assured that I was "garden variety" and much like everyone else. Second, you know that streak of the perfectionist in most alcoholics; have you outgrown yours yet? Well, I came to my first Conference with a fear of making a mistake and, on a broader scale, that the entire Conference might not do everything perfectly. I have since come to appreciate that the great strength of our Fellowship is its ability to survive mistakes, not avoid them. Throughout the coming week, I know you will feel the strong presence of a collective Higher Power that will guide our Conference much like a tug leading a ship through treacherous channels. As we practice our right of decision and right of participation, as conceived in the Concepts, our collective Group Conscience will lead us unerringly to right and proper actions. If I may quote from page 87 of the Big Book, "... we find that our thinking will, as time passes, be more and more on the plane of inspiration. We come to rely upon it."

To be sure, in the spirit of our Fifth Concept, some of us will find ourselves embracing a minority viewpoint and just as surely we shall discharge our duty to present the dissenting views. As we commence our committee work, report back to the floor and engage in lively debate (for which we alcoholics seem to enjoy no small reputation), our mutual love and respect for one another will generate a spirit of unity which we can all cherish forever. Our individual challenge will be to carry that spirit back to the groups at home and to do our best to share its essence with every single member of the Fellowship.

The theme of the 33rd Conference was "Anonymity – Our Spiritual Foundation." Our Fellowship has been building and growing from that foundation so that, this year, we address "Anonymity – Living Our Traditions." Striving to fit ourselves for maximum service to God (as we understand Him) and our fellows, we are presented this week with the ultimate opportunity to perform that service, always keeping principles ahead of personalities. Bill Wilson best expressed it when he said: "Compromise comes hard to us 'all-or-nothing' drunks. Nevertheless, we must never lose sight of the fact that progress is nearly always characterized by a series of improving compromises." (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 39) The opening of the Twelfth Concept includes this statement: "... in all its proceedings, the General Service Conference shall observe the spirit of the A.A. Tradition. ..." Quoting further from this Concept, "Of all bodies and groups in Alcoholics Anonymous, the Conference should above all feel bound by the A.A. Traditions. Indeed the Conference is named 'the guardian of the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous.' The Traditions themselves outline the general basis on which we may best conduct our services. The Traditions express the principles and attitudes of prudence that make for harmony. Therefore A.A.'s Twelve Traditions set the pattern of unity and of function which our General Service Conference is expected to exemplify at the highest possible degree." (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 61) As we share the coming week in the Fellowship of the Spirit, we can look forward to association with the many good friends we're about to meet. May God bless each one of us, and I thank you for this opportunity to share these thoughts.

Herb Wales (Northwest Texas),
delegate chairperson

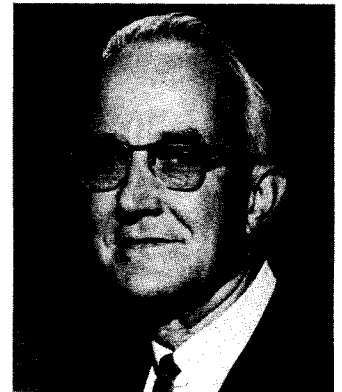
Keynote Address

It is a great honor for me to accept the invitation to be your keynote speaker this morning. I think the theme, Anonymity – Living Our Traditions, is particularly appropriate for this Conference and it has a special meaning for me in connection with the life and career in Alcoholics Anonymous of Dr. Jack Norris.

Early in my career as a trustee on the General Service Board I had a less inspiring but no less memorable experience with this Tradition. It came after the third General Service Conference I attended as a trustee. The Conference had been extremely stressful with a great many difficult issues and considerable controversy. We had worked extremely hard and on Friday evening a number of the trustees – the more experienced, veteran trustees – decided they really needed a meeting and invited me to join them. We found a meeting in Manhattan known to some of the members and we entered the meeting and were welcomed warmly. These were the trusted servants who had come from the United States and Canada to work for the good of the Fellowship and they were proud of their work and their sacrifice. Introductions were completed and my friends were anticipating a good meeting. Then from the corner I heard what is now a familiar phrase, “principles before personalities,” and out we went. That did a lot for my humility and, I am sure, for the humility of some trustees.

In a more serious vein, in a 1955 issue of the Grapevine, Bill W. wrote that anonymity is “. . . our greatest symbol of personal sacrifice. . .” and he emphasized in a number of ways the theme of sacrifice in all of the Traditions but particularly in that of anonymity. (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 211) In another framework Dr. Milton Maxwell in his book, *The A.A. Experience: A Close-up View for Professionals* (McGraw-Hill, 1984) discusses the tradition of anonymity and tries to explain the phrase which states “that we are to practice genuine humility.” Dr. Maxwell explains “. . . that means a nondefensive, nonegocentric, nonself-serving orientation to one’s self, others, and, life in general. . . .” For me, the clearest example of these two descriptions comes in the life of Dr. Jack Norris, and his service to the Fellowship. In that we have the model for our theme, Anonymity – Living Our Traditions.

Dr. Jack came on the board in 1951 and he was chairman of the General Service Board from 1961 to 1978. His last Conference was in April 1988 and his last board weekend was in July 1988. After the 1955 International Convention in St. Louis Bill wrote about Jack in his article, “When A.A. Came of Age” and he described him in 1955 as a selfless and tireless worker and asked the question, “What would we have ever done without friends like these?” (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 5) Who could have thought then that the service that Bill was describing would continue for another 33 years? What did Jack do during all of that time? When you try to learn more about it, you won’t find a clear, written record. And as you know, there is not, and never will be, a self-serving memoir, autobiography, or bestseller, with revelations about his 38 years on the General Service Board. And so we have to piece a record together from anecdotes, brief observations and some speculation about the role that he played over that long span of time. I knew him beginning in 1980 when he was in his late 70s and early 80s and I saw him in regular



John L. Norris, M.D.



attendance at meetings of the trustees of the General Service Board. I recall the numerous times he would be sitting in a discussion, listening to strong opinions on both sides of a given issue when the inevitable conflicts and personalities would arise. You would turn to Dr. Jack and he was usually able to sum up the discussion in a few soft words and help both sides understand the issues that were important. Usually, somewhere in his remarks came the phrase, "for the good of the Fellowship." It is clear as I recollect on those experiences that *that* for Jack was the guiding principle, the idea that kept him centered, the value that was more important than any other, and that was "the good of the Fellowship." He had arrived at a point in his life where, perhaps more than any living being, he could perceive the good of the Fellowship in ways that others could not.

I remember on one specific occasion I was complaining to him about the difficulties caused by rebels obstructing and upsetting things and Jack was able to chuckle and then point out the good that the rebels could do in raising new ideas or new issues. In it he was demonstrating his tolerance for disagreement and disruption as long as it helped create a clearer understanding of the principles involved. Another time, during a Conference when there was a great deal of discussion about the drug issue and groups going underground with fear of what might come of this increasing controversy, Jack nodded quietly and made the comment, "Well, they're continuing to talk about it and that's the important thing – that they continue to talk." He reminded me of an issue a number of years ago wherein the Fellowship was torn apart with controversy about the pill and he described that the use of Antabuse was causing a great deal of concern throughout the Fellowship and dire predictions were being heard. But, he pointed out, people continued to talk, discuss and look at it and slowly came to a more balanced view. The controversy is largely forgotten now and he was able to put that whole controversy in perspective. This aspect of keeping people talking was a basic principle that Jack encouraged in many ways. Perhaps one of the most obvious was his suggestion for the development of the Regional Forums. This came at a time when there was considerable misunderstanding between the General Service Office in New York and the Fellowship at large. Jack's thought was to bring the office to the Fellowship in the form of the Regional Forums and allow the controversies and the misunderstandings to be aired in open discussion. These Forums have been enormously successful, particularly in clearing up misunderstandings and in helping the whole Fellowship become more unified. And that, I suppose, is as clear an example of the role he played as any we have.

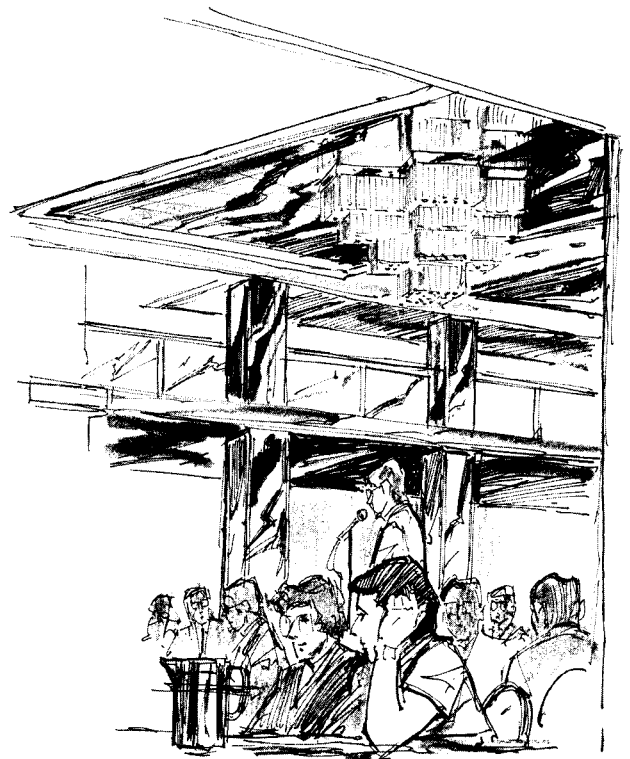
During breaks in the Conference or on board weekends Jack and I took walks about New York and I got to know him a little bit better. We talked about the old days and he would answer questions but it was, as you can imagine, difficult to get him to tell about his own role. Those were the days of the early growth and recognition of Alcoholics Anonymous. People were beginning to feel the power of this movement and what could be accomplished by it. The leaders, the trusted servants, were men of strong personalities who were creative and independent and sometimes had ideas and plans that were hard to believe. The conflicts in those days ranged from finances to the Grapevine, personalities, personnel, publications, the role of the alcoholics and the nonalcoholics, racial issues, the Conference, the Traditions and the Legacies. Many of the ideas that formed the bedrock of this Fellowship were controversial in the beginning and only proved themselves in practice. Some of the ideas, of course, had to be discarded and there needed to be strong and perceptive people to make those decisions.

History is filled with the stories of movements that began with great promise and potential and then floundered in their relatively early days on controversy, personality conflicts, and destructive self-interest. This Fellowship, the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous, has not floundered and instead now continues its growth and development and I have to think, or have to speculate, on a younger version of the Dr. Jack that I knew, sitting in on those controversial meetings and bringing that same perspective, the good of the Fellowship, to bear on those discussions, and hearing the anger, the demands, the push and keeping himself and the others focused on the good of the Fellowship.

One story Dr. Jack would tell about the old days was about one particularly stormy session with Dr. Jack holding steady while he was told in no uncertain terms that he wasn't wanted anymore, that he was getting in the way and it was time for him to go. And Dr. Jack's response was "Okay. Enough of this." I guess in modern terms he would have said, "I'm out of here." But he decided to go and a delegation from the board came to him and said, "Jack, you can't leave us now. We need you more than ever." And he, of course, stayed. That delegation saw, I think, what I and others have seen glimpses of in recent years: his strength, balance, and his clear vision of that repetitive phrase, "for the good Fellowship." When they presented their need to Jack, that basic principle of service and sacrifice was such that Jack, like so many of you, could not say "No."

I have tried to convey, then, this morning my memory of Dr. Jack as a quiet and persevering man whose service to the Fellowship only ceased with his death. He had lived his A.A. service life with the guiding principle of the good of the Fellowship and over many years had made the continuing sacrifice with little concern for his own needs and wants. In my view, the theme that you have chosen for this Conference – Anonymity – Living Our Traditions – is best understood and exemplified in the life and service of Dr. Jack Norris.

William Flynn, M.D., Class A trustee



Workshop

Thursday Conference members split up into small groups of 12 to 14 for a workshop discussion based on the Conference theme, "Anonymity – Living Our Traditions." Following are the workshop questions and a summary of the report backs.

1 Why is anonymity often referred to as the greatest single protection the Fellowship has to assure its continued existence and growth?

There was uniform agreement that anonymity is the greatest single protection of the Fellowship as a whole, but it also serves as a powerful "ego control" of its individual members. It teaches its members to replace personality with spirituality, as it simultaneously protects the vulnerable newcomer. Moreover, it introduces and reinforces humility as members work anonymously for the good of others. A great "equalizer," anonymity tempers motives of ambition and profit, and should be vigilantly practiced at all levels.

2 What are the fundamental spiritual principles involved in anonymity and how are these the spiritual foundations for our new lives in A.A.?

A primary spiritual result of anonymity is, once again, one of ego deflation, while generating in the membership the practice of self-denial and humility. As our pretensions are stripped away, we learn to follow the spirit *and* the letter of the Traditions, always being reminded that it is the message, not the messenger, that is important.

The consensus of one group was that it is as "wrong for us not to break our anonymity within the Fellowship as it is to break it at the level of press, radio, film and television." Observance of the Tradition of anonymity nurtures humility, but it also enables us to build in ourselves a strong spiritual foundation, both of which benefit all aspects of our lives. In addition, it was felt that A.A. workshops on anonymity would help us to better understand the A.A. program and, specifically, to improve the quality of sponsorship. Finally, many agreed that anonymity is a form of

discipline, promoting a sense of responsibility toward the Fellowship, while at the same time allowing members to feel God working in their lives.

3 How did anonymity develop from fear of disclosure to the very spiritual core of our sobriety?

It was felt by a number of participants that, with time, members' initial fear of disclosure is replaced by a desire to share with others the experiences of their new sober lives. So, too, the feeling among members that they have found a safe haven begins to supersede their earlier fear of disclosure. The wish to share with others is gradually combined with a growing awareness of the Fellowship's spiritual concepts, not a small part of which is "the elimination of the 'I' out of the picture." The whole process, however, takes time, and included in it is an increased belief in a Higher Power.

4 What is your thinking/area's thinking regarding the taping and selling of tapes of A.A. talks as it relates to the Tradition of anonymity?

While there was virtual agreement among all participants that tapes help to carry the message, it was also agreed that ongoing vigilance should be maintained. First and foremost, the anonymity of speakers should be protected. Equally important is the belief that commercialism should not be allowed a foot in A.A.'s door. Consequently, some participants objected to a catalogue of tapes or sales lists, others to a "tape of the month."

But since tapes are apparently here to stay, their advertising should be carefully monitored. The identity of taped speakers should be restricted to first names only and should never include their professional or A.A. status (*i.e.*, G.S.O. staff member, delegate). It was agreed that countless travelers, Loners and other confined individuals benefit from the tapes. Moreover, the need for tapes will doubtless accelerate in an ever-more complex technological society – making the challenge of protecting the anonymity Tradition all the more necessary.

5 Do you think that bumper stickers, coffee mugs, jewelry, t-shirts, etc., with A.A.'s name or A.A. slogans on them breach the spirit of anonymity? Why or why not?



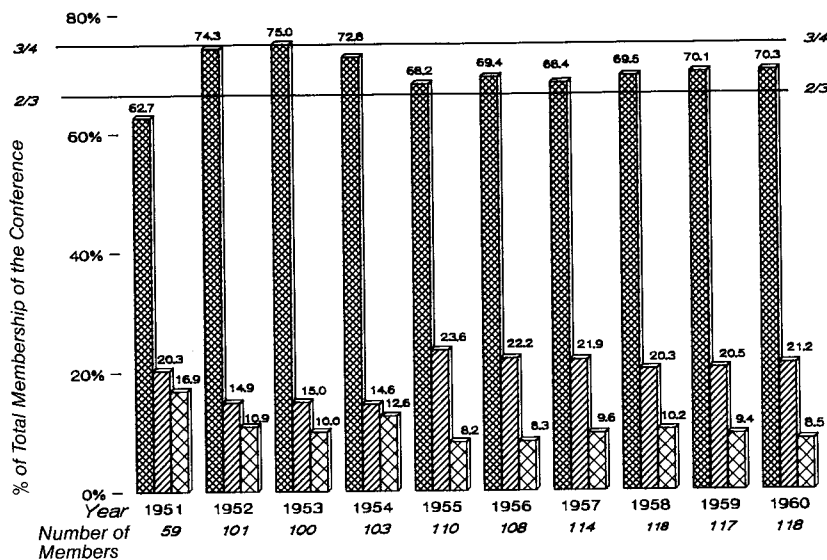
Participants were more or less divided on the subject. Some delegates felt that their general purchase and use were an individual matter, others said that displays of bumper stickers and other material like them were a form of self-advertising. A different significance was placed, however, on the material itself. For instance, it was affirmed that non-A.A.s do not appear to know that the slogans on the stickers – which are universally known – pertain to membership in the Fellowship. Anonymity is, therefore, preserved in their use. On the other hand, the use of a pin with the A.A. logo or the wearing of a ring similarly inscribed are a different matter and threaten the anonymity of the user.

Overall, participants stressed the need to guard the use of the A.A. logo, as well as the advisability of discouraging the purchase of “A.A.”-inscribed trinkets. Many participants felt that, because their purchase can’t be curtailed, there was an increased urgency to inform members of the importance of the Twelfth Tradition. On this note, one group held that A.A.’s fine literature on the subject of anonymity should be promoted to the membership at large, along with the holding of special meetings, conventions and assemblies for the better understanding “of this most important subject, so we can be better prepared to” work the program “and grow in our trust in our Higher Power.”

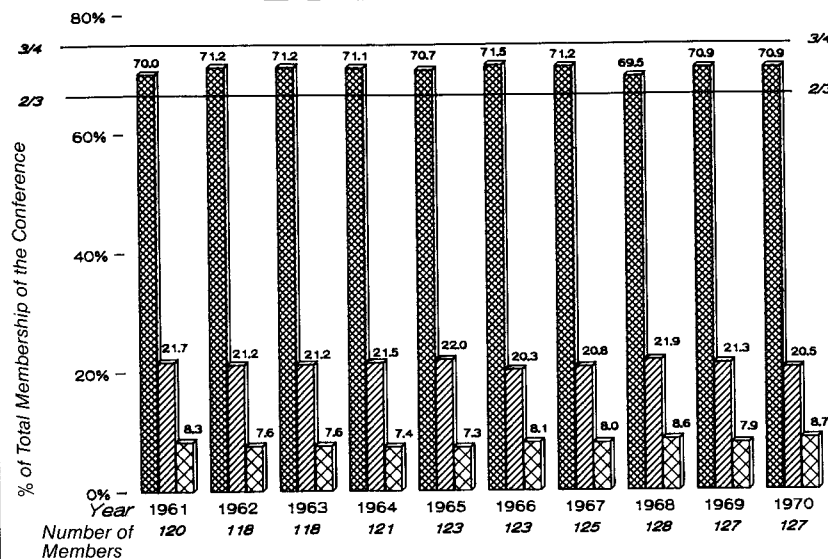


CONFERENCE MEMBERSHIP – 1951 to 1989

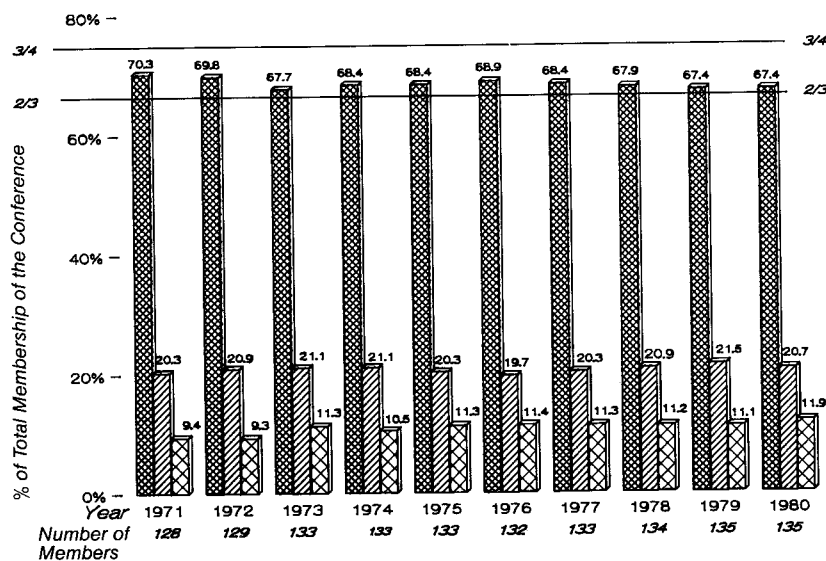
1951 - 1960



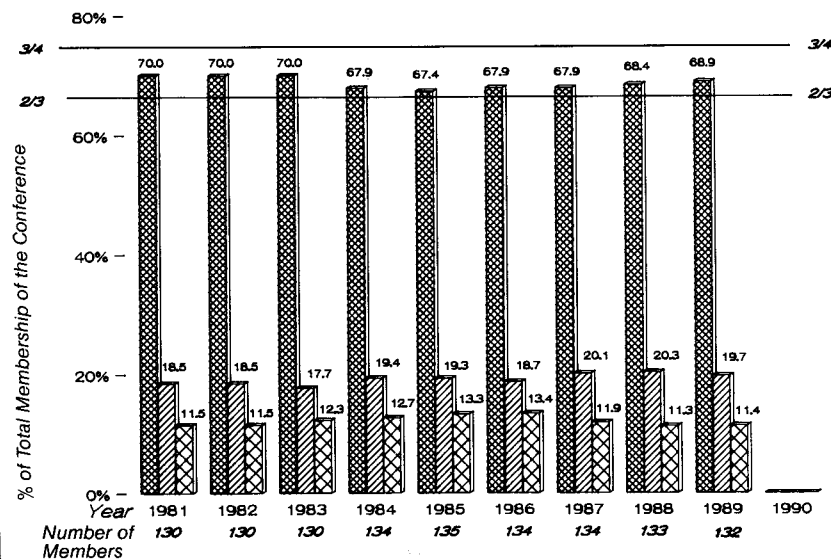
1961 - 1970



1971 - 1980



1981 - 1989



PERCENTAGE OF DELEGATES, BOARDS, STAFFS



Delegates



Boards



Staffs

Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole, or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the Conference. Additional topics that each Conference committee discussed, but took no action on, will be reported in the History and Actions of Conference Committees; available from G.S.O. upon request.

FLOOR ACTION

It was recommended that:

1 The 1989 General Service Conference appoint an ad hoc committee consisting of Panel 39 delegates and G.S.O. employees involved with the new computer system to study the problems of group registration and the A.A. directories and bring its recommendations back to the 1990 General Service Conference.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

2 The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner of the 40th General Service Conference consist of the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee as leader to introduce five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, two A.A. members alternating from among the A.A. staff, Grapevine staff, Archives and corporate boards.

There be a light system on the podium; the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be designated as chairperson of the A.A. meeting and that his or her duties be limited to introducing the leader and monitoring the time of the A.A. meeting.

3 The following themes be considered for the 1990 General Service Conference: "Home Group – Where Love and Service Begin"; "Home Group – Our Link to the Fellowship"; "Home Group – Our Responsibility and Link to A.A.'s Future."

4 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1990 General Service Conference:

- a The Importance of the Home Group
 - 1 In Recovery
 - 2 For Unity
 - 3 For Service
- b Sponsorship
 - 1 In Recovery
 - 2 For Unity
 - 3 For Service
- c Self-support
- d G.S.O. Finances

5 One workshop be held at the 1990 General Service Conference and the topic be on the Conference theme.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

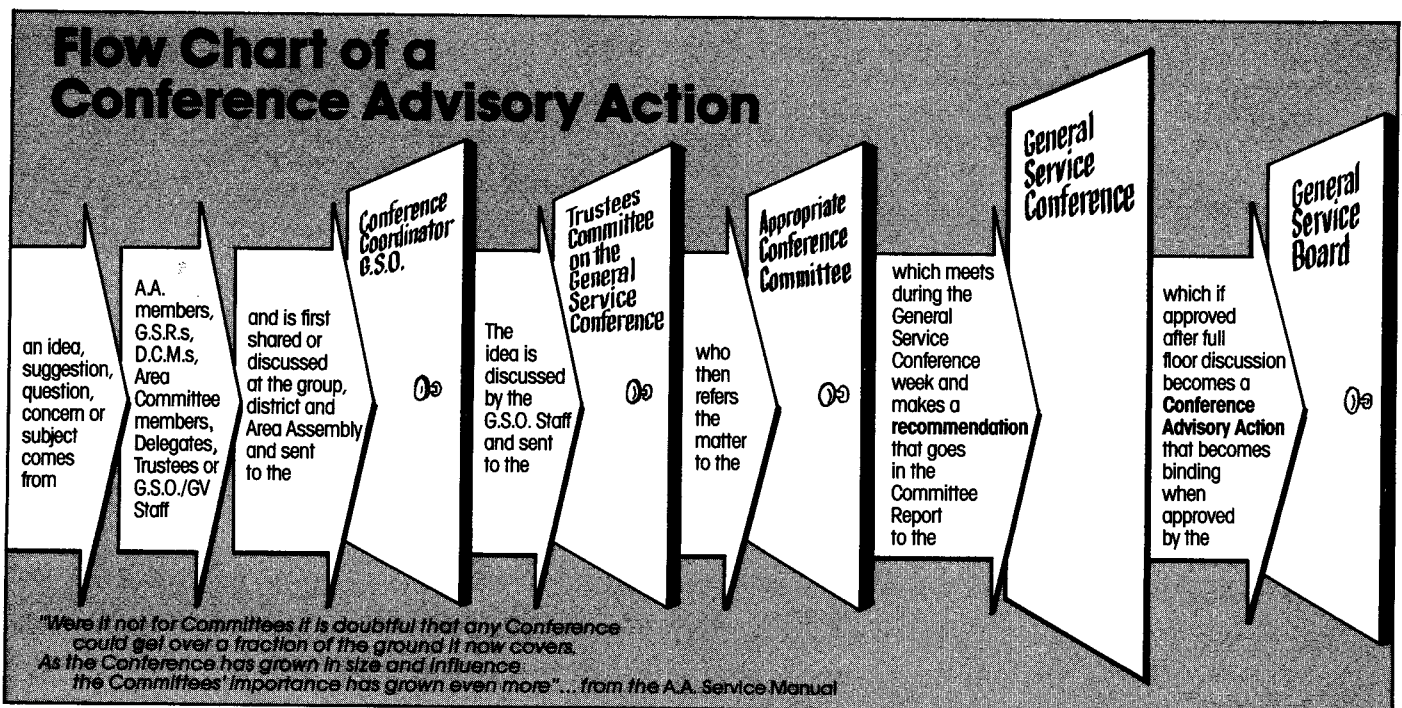
It was recommended that:

6 The revised text of the pamphlet "A.A. and Occupational Alcoholism Programs" be approved with minor changes.

7 The title of the pamphlet "A.A. and Occupational Programs" be changed to "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs."

8 In carrying the A.A. messages to minorities,

- a The focus and work of the C.P.C. trustees' Committee, C.P.C. staff and all C.P.C. committees continue to gather information on how the A.A. message of recovery can better be



carried to and through minorities, minority professionals, and all professionals who work with minorities.

- b That any initiative to better carry the A.A. message to and through minorities media and media which focus on minorities readers, viewers or listeners, and in schools with high minorities populations, be referred to the appropriate public information committees for any continued consideration.
 - c That any further consideration of how minorities may better be reached within the A.A. Fellowship with the message of becoming involved in service, be through future consideration by the General Service Conference.
 - d That our minorities initiatives reflect our primary concern for helping all alcoholics.
- 9** A revised text of the pamphlet "The Clergy Ask about Alcoholics Anonymous" be placed on the agenda for the 1990 General Service Conference C.P.C. Committee.

10 The trustees' C.P.C. Committee and G.S.O. staff update the C.P.C. Workbook giving consideration to including a service piece similar to one submitted by Southern Minnesota Assembly.

11 Consideration be given to development of a guideline for area C.P.C. committees to set up exhibits at state and local professional conventions.

12 Consideration be given by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee for a video which addresses the need to inform both professionals and A.A. members how our friends historically have helped the Fellowship and how we can cooperate within the framework of our purpose, experience and Traditions, and that discussion of the feasibility of such a project be placed on the agenda of the 1990 General Service Conference C.P.C. Committee.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

13 The name of the "Institutions Correspondence Service" (I.C.S.) be changed to "Corrections Correspondence Service" (C.C.S.) as literature comes up for reprint.

14 That the flyer "Carrying the Message Inside the Walls" be replaced with the revised version entitled "Carrying the Message Into Correctional Facilities."

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

15 The need to send complete audited financial statements to each delegate as soon as they are available has not been demonstrated, but that they will be made available upon request (available about April 1st, each year).

16 Three-part printouts, which are seen as a better working tool for delegates and D.C.M.s, be sent to the delegates every quarter instead of alternating copies of the contribution quarterly statements and quarterly contribution printouts.

17 Area contributions for delegate expenses for the Conference be increased to \$600 and that, in the spirit of the Seventh Tradition, areas continue to be encouraged to make contributions over and above this requested amount to help cover a greater portion of the Conference costs.

18 The Conference strongly reaffirms the 1986 Conference Advisory Action on self-support which reads:

"That the area delegates strongly consider implementation of the following suggestions to improve contributions to G.S.O., area assemblies, districts, and central or intergroup offices:

- a G.S.O. make available to all delegates an itemized list of group service expenses and other expenses of the board, combined into one total, representing group services supported by group contributions. (Now a part of the financial statements in the *Final Conference Report*.)
- b Area delegates contact groups quarterly, either directly or through the D.C.M.s, distributing self-support pamphlets and contribution statements.
- c The delegates encourage each group to have a folder which includes a list of addresses to whom monthly contributions could be sent (district, intergroup/central offices, area committees and G.S.O.).
- d Each area affix a list of addresses or stamp addresses on finance flyers and distribute to groups to provide them with the information on 'where to send their money.'
- e Areas could provide groups with preaddressed envelopes as to where they should contribute to the area treasury."

19 No change be made in the current literature pricing policy after considering a proposal to change the G.S.O. literature pricing from the existing procedure to one fixed price for everyone including purchasers who buy in bulk.

20 The Self-Support Pamphlet reflect the idea that the support of A.A. services (central/intergroup offices, area committee, G.S.O., and district) be a *commitment* by the individual member through his or her home group.

21 The commitment to the Seventh Tradition on the part of the individuals through their home group be emphasized where applicable in other A.A. literature as it comes up for revision.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

22 The Grapevine develop an ongoing A.A. history section, drawing on archival material, including area and regional histories.

23 In recognition of the need for a magazine price increase in the near future, delegates clarify in their areas the fact that the Grapevine is supported by subscription income and does not accept group contributions to cover operating expenses.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

It was recommended that:

24 State, provincial, and regional convention committees be alerted to the possible effect on attendance at local conventions held between May 11 and August 24, 1990, due to the International Convention.

25 A TV camera be permitted to film the Flag Ceremony from afar at the Kingdome Stadium, if appropriate precautions are taken to protect the anonymity of those in attendance at the 1990 International Convention.

26 The number of non-A.A. speakers to be invited to participate at the 1990 International Convention remain the same (21) as at previous International Conventions.

27 The Registration Form for the 1990 International Convention include a statement on travel option discounts.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

28 Work continue on a definitive book on A.A. History from 1955, as recommended by the 1986 General Service Conference, along the lines of a proposal recently submitted to the trustees' Literature Committee which focuses on major events and developments since the co-founders turned A.A. over to the Fellowship, rather than focusing on the beginning of A.A. and the history of the 91 areas of the U.S. and Canada.

29 A complete manuscript of Daily Reflections be prepared for review by the 1990 Conference Literature Committee because of the good response to the appeals for additional material from the Fellowship.

30 Work continue on an easy-to-read, illustrated Twelve Steps pamphlet suitable for people with very limited reading skills.

31 An illustrated easy-to-read manuscript entitled "Is A.A. for Me?" be approved to help carry the message to people with limited reading skills.

32 The pamphlet "The A.A. Group" be thoroughly revised to address the many issues and concerns related to A.A. groups which come before the committee year after year such as: the difference between a group and a meeting; meeting formats; how to obtain a group conscience; the duties of trusted servants and their alternates; and others as described in an outline of contents submitted by the trustees' Literature Committee.

33 The manuscript for a pamphlet for gay and lesbian alcoholics be approved with specific editorial changes which will be reviewed by the Conference Literature Committee before publication and that the title be "A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic."

34 The book *Alcoholics Anonymous* be made available in large print because of an indicated need over the years.

35 The 16mm film entitled "A.A. - An Inside View" be made available for sale in lieu of long-term lease with the understanding that the film's copyright is sufficient protection against misuse by outside entities. This recommendation is consistent with our distribution policy for our more recent films which are available to the general public.

POLICY / ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

36 The 41st General Service Conference be held April 14-20, 1991 with an alternative date of April 21-27, 1991, based on hotel accommodations and availability.

37 The 1979 Conference Action be reaffirmed: "Conference Committee selection continue to be by lot with the widest possible geographical distribution." It was the sense of the meeting that any other method could erode the confidence of the Conference in the committee system.

38 That all Conference-approved literature shall be developed within the Conference structure, but that identification of need

may be established by use of questionnaires developed in cooperation with the appropriate standing Conference committees.

39 The 1987 Conference Action from the Policy/Admissions Committee be modified to read:

"Each Conference Committee carefully consider their agenda items and strive to make their recommendations for Advisory Actions to the Conference at the policy level. To be more financially responsible, when a Conference committee recommendation involves a substantial expenditure of money, an estimate of cost and its impact on the budget be part of that recommendation."

40 That the words "and timely" be added to the end of Question #6 on the 1990 Conference questionnaire, and that space be allowed for comments. (The Question would read "Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. adequate and timely?")

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

41 Ten new English radio public service announcements (Nos. 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 9, 10 and 11) with tag line changed to "Alcoholics Anonymous - phone or check your newspaper" be approved for distribution by G.S.O.

42 One additional English radio P.S.A., with the tag line changed to "Alcoholics Anonymous - phone or check your newspaper," titled "Liberated Woman" be approved for distribution by G.S.O.

43 Two Spanish radio P.S.A.s titled "I Would Not Kiss My Children" and "Completely Bankrupt" be approved for distribution by G.S.O.

44 The 1989 Membership Survey be conducted on a random basis, by area; and that we use the same questionnaire used in the 1986 survey.

45 The following items be added to the Public Information Workbook for use by convention P.I. chairpersons:

- a "Memo to News Directors, Writers, and Commentators."
- b "Guide for a Convention Press Release" with one paragraph changed to delete the first name and last initial of the speakers and all other information that identifies convention speakers.
- c "Press Kit" to be used at Convention Press Conferences.

46 Change the Public Information Chairperson paragraph of the A.A. Guidelines on Conferences and Conventions to include references to the material now available to convention P.I. chairpeople.

47 A service piece providing guidelines for taping A.A. talks be prepared and brought to the 1990 General Service Conference for review and added to the A.A. Guidelines on Conferences and Conventions.

48 The following 1980 Conference Action be reaffirmed:

"In keeping with our Eleventh and Twelfth Traditions, A.A. members who are requested to videotape talks and meetings preserve anonymity at the level of press, radio, film, and videotapes, realizing that anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions. The committee further recommended that talks by A.A. members be given in person rather than videotaped, in view of the temptation for videotaping to place personalities before principles."

49 A.A.W.S., Inc., give television stations and A.A. service entities the opportunity to use shortened versions of any of our films now available to the public but strongly urge they be used in their entirety when possible in order to maintain the integrity of the A.A. message.

50 No action be taken on the request to drop "It Works" from existing video P.S.A.s.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

51 The description "What Is an A.A. Group" contained in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be added to *The A.A. Service Manual*, and that, when adding the material, the circular structure chart of the group be amended to include "Archives Representative."

52 The A.A.W.S., Inc. policy statement on "Use of A.A.'s Trademarks and Logos" be added to *The A.A. Service Manual*.

53 The section "Other Officer Qualifications" in the Area Committee Chapter of *The A.A. Service Manual* be amended from:

Other Officer Qualifications

An area committee may have other officers who are responsible for special activities. A public information chairperson, for example, to head up the area P.I. committee is appointed by the area committee chairperson with the approval of the area committee. Some areas have an institutions chairperson, some a convention chairperson. Other areas appoint a finance chairperson whose sole job is keeping contributions coming into area and G.S.O. treasuries. Other assignments handled by special chairpersons or coordinators include: cooperation with the professional community, liaison with central offices or intergroups; preparation of news bulletins; literature; Grapevine, etc.

to:

Other Officers

An area committee may also have officers who are responsible to the committee for special activities. Examples might include Public Information and Cooperation With the Professional Community chairpersons to head up the area P.I. and C.P.C. committees; Correctional and Treatment chairpersons to coordinate this vital Twelfth Step work; a Literature chairperson to act as liaison between the various service entities on all matters regarding A.A. literature; a Grapevine chairperson to disseminate Grapevine material; an Archives chairperson to record and maintain the history of the area; a Convention chairperson to facilitate the event; a Finance chairperson to encourage self-support for both the area needs and the needs of G.S.O.; a liaison chairperson to foster improved communication between the area and central office/intergroup; and other assignments and responsibilities, as suggested by local area needs.

54 A description of the position of D.C.M. chairperson not be added to *The A.A. Service Manual* at this time.

55 Footnotes continue to appear in the same manner as in the present 1988-89 *A.A. Service Manual* edition for the following reasons:

Footnotes in the first section of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* appear at the bottom of the page where the text referred to appears, making for easier reading.

In the *Twelve Concepts* section, however, there are two types of footnotes or, more specifically, footnotes and end notes.

a Footnotes, which are marked with an asterisk (*) and appear at the bottom of each page, reflect changes Bill Wilson made from the original writing in 1962 until shortly before his death in 1971 and are part of the entire text of each Concept.

b End notes, which are numbered and appear at the end of each Concept, reflect updated factual information that has changed since the original.

56 The existing footnotes 7 and 8 of Section 3, Concept XI be deleted and, instead, the following footnote to the entire section be included as follows:

In order to meet the changing conditions since the writing of this section, A.A.W.S., Inc., with the approval of the General Service Board, has implemented a two-year rotation of assignments for most staff members, and, since 1987, a merit pay increase system has been established.

57 Footnote 9 in Section 4, Concept XI in *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* be changed to read:

from:

"G.S.O. staff members have voting representation on trustees' committees. Additionally, the staff member serving as staff coordinator has a vote as a director of the A.A.W.S. Board."

to:

"As a director of the A.A.W.S. Board, the staff member serving as staff coordinator has a vote."



58 In order to economize financially the Eastern and Western U.S. Directories be combined.

59 The listing of clubs be deleted from the A.A. Directories.

60 The *Final Report* for G.S.R.s be sent to the delegate, with the quantity to be determined by each delegate.

61 The *Final Report* be translated into French and Spanish.

62 Reinstating of perforated, removable pages for the roster section of the *Final Report* not be done.

63 General Service Conference committee items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, not be included in the *Final Report*.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

64 A fifteen-minute film be produced for A.A. members carrying the message into treatment facilities and be presented to the 1990 General Service Conference.

Note: Although the following item did not receive the necessary two-thirds vote to become a Conference recommendation, it did receive a substantial majority and is therefore a strong suggestion for the board's consideration:

"Suggested that in the proposed film for treatment facilities the Louis B. segment of the script be deleted because of implied endorsement of Narcotics Anonymous."

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

65 The following slate of officers and trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April 1989 (see page 00; the Conference and board approved the slate approved by the trustees' Nominating Committee).



66 The following slate of directors for the A.A.W.S. Board be elected (see page 00; slate of directors approved).

67 The following slate of directors for the Grapevine Board be elected (see page 00; slate of directors approved).

68 An effort be made to rectify contradictions and inconsistencies between *The A.A. Service Manual* and legal charters and corporate by-laws.

Note: Although the following item did not receive the necessary two-thirds vote to become a Conference recommendation, it did receive a substantial majority and is therefore a strong suggestion for the board's consideration.

The following revised text be approved for substitution and inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*:

There Are . . .

Two Trustees-at-large

The trustees-at-large (2) serve as members of the trustees' International Committee and other trustees' committees or as directors of the corporate boards. They may fill in for regional trustees, as needed and/or requested.

The trustees-at-large – one from the U.S. and one from Canada – serve as the World Service Meeting delegates representing the U.S. and Canada. World Service Meeting delegates participate in two World Service Meetings which are held once every two years, the meeting place alternating between New York City and a location outside the U.S. and Canada. World Service Meeting delegates should have the same qualifications as any trustee, and also have time both to attend the World Service Meetings and to present and carry out any decisions reached at these meetings.

The trustees-at-large are requested to attend all Regional Forums in their own country and be available on a rotational basis to participate on Forum programs.

The trustees-at-large are also available for other A.A. service activities as requested by areas or regions and additional activities as may be requested by the board of trustees.

There Are . . .

Four General Service Trustees

General service trustees are active on one or more of the service corporate boards and must be available, not only every quarter, but any week and, sometimes, any day, for the solution of problems on which G.S.O. or Grapevine staff members need help. Because of this requirement, all general service trustees originally came from New York City or its commuting area and were sometimes known as "in-town trustees." The current practice of selecting general service trustees for both the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine corporate boards will continue, but these positions are no longer restricted to residents of New York City or its vicinity.

While there are no "specialists" in A.A. – only recovered drunks – it has been possible to choose, for general service trusteeships, men and women with the kind of business or professional acumen that is particularly applicable to the problems at hand, whether their backgrounds are in publishing, public relations, or administration. This brings up the question of what qualifications count most in the selection of a trustees . . ."

Presentations Shed Light on Areas of Interest

ANONYMITY

The first presentation/discussion session of the 1989 Conference took place on Monday morning. Jack Whitehouse, East Central U.S. regional trustee, moderated the session, which focused on the 1989 Conference theme, *Anonymity – Living Our Traditions*.

Anonymity and How it Developed

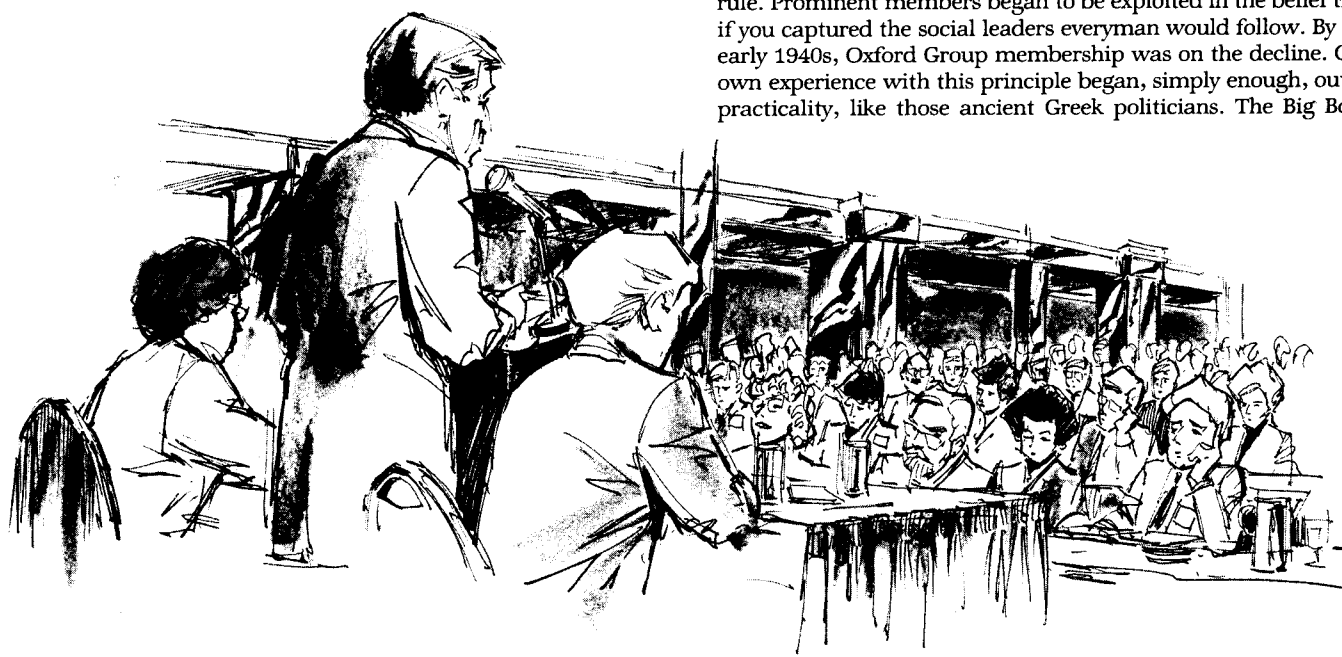
Anonymous constitutes half of our name. Anonymity is the principle mentioned specifically in two of our Traditions and contained conceptually within the other ten. Anonymity is called the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions. In the long form of Tradition Twelve it states, "... the principle of anonymity has immense spiritual significance. It reminds us that we are to place principles before personalities; that we are actually to practice a genuine humility. This to the end that our great blessings may never spoil us; that we shall forever live in thankful contemplation of Him who presides over us all." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 192) Where did it start? The word itself comes from the Greek. *An* means without. *Onoma* means name. Without a name. The word is over 4,000 years old. The principle is perhaps considerably older. In ancient Greece, as elsewhere, political pamphlets appeared that were unsigned (anonymous). This technique saved the author from imprisonment or worse.

Past trustee Ralph R., in an essay on this subject, reported that excerpts from the *Talmud* "urged upon the people of those times to recognize the danger of seeking self-greatness as opposed to the fuller satisfaction in the reward that comes from remaining one of the crowd (and working with one another) for the good of all." In *The Sermon on the Mount* by Emmett Fox, a book widely read by early A.A.s, Matthew VI is discussed: "Take heed that ye do not your alms before men, to be seen of them: otherwise ye have no reward of your Father which is in heaven. Therefore when thou doest thine alms, do not sound a trumpet before thee, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, that they may have glory of men. Verily I say unto you, they have their reward. But when thou doest alms, let not thy left hand know what thy right hand doeth: That thine alms may be in secret: and thy Father which seeth in secret Himself shall reward thee openly." Thus we begin to see another dimension in these

examples. Continuing this evolution of anonymity, in the monasteries and cloisters throughout Europe the practice of surrendering a novitiate's own name and the taking of another was widespread. These moves were designed, of course, to encourage the loss of self and to facilitate unselfish service to others.

Moving closer to our own times, Milton Maxwell, past chairperson of the General Service Board, in his analysis of the erstwhile Washingtonian movement, a hugely successful, but short-lived effort by alcoholics in the mid-1800s to find their way out of their illness, cites the fact that lack of this protective mantle of anonymity hastened their demise: "A comparison with the Washingtonian experience underscores the sheer survival value of the principle of anonymity in Alcoholics Anonymous. At the height of his popularity, John B. Gough either 'slipped' or was tricked by his enemies into a drunken relapse. At any rate, the opponents of the Washingtonian movement seized upon this lapse with glee and made the most of it to hurt Gough and the movement. This must have happened frequently to less widely known but nevertheless publicly known Washingtonians. Public confidence in the movement was impaired. Anonymity protects the reputation of A.A. from public criticism not only of 'slips' but also of failures, internal tensions, and *all* deviant behavior. . . . Equally important, anonymity keeps the groups from exploiting prominent names for the sake of group prestige; and it keeps individual members from exploiting their A.A. connection for personal prestige or fame. This encourages humility and the placing of principles above personalities. Such behavior not only generates outside admiration of A.A. but has therapeutic value for the individual members. There are further therapeutic values in anonymity: it makes it easier for alcoholics to approach A.A., and it relaxes the new member. It encourages honest catharsis and utter frankness. It protects the new member from the critical eyes of certain acquaintances while he experiments with this new way of life, for fumbling and failure will be hidden." (*The Washingtonian Movement*, pp. 447-8)

Closer still to our own times was the experience of the Oxford Group. Initially, the founder, Frank Buchman, insisted that he be called by his first name only and, further, that the movement not be called, as many proponents suggested, "Buchmanism." Later, this mantle was dropped in favor of a more publicity-minded approach. Full names, wide press coverage became the rule. Prominent members began to be exploited in the belief that if you captured the social leaders everyman would follow. By the early 1940s, Oxford Group membership was on the decline. Our own experience with this principle began, simply enough, out of practicality, like those ancient Greek politicians. The Big Book



reads: "It is important that we remain anonymous because we are too few, at present to handle the overwhelming number of personal appeals which may result from this publication." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. xiii) Then in *A.A. Comes of Age* Bill poignantly expresses his spiritual journey into this principle over the years:

"Moved by the spirit of anonymity, we try to give up our natural desires for personal distinction as A.A. members both among fellow alcoholics and before the general public. As we lay aside these very human aspirations, we believe that each of us takes part in the weaving of a protective mantle which covers our whole society and under which we may grow and work in unity.

"We are sure that humility, expressed by anonymity, is the greatest safeguard that Alcoholics Anonymous can ever have.

"Because I myself have always had strong tendencies toward the pursuit of prestige, wealth, and power, all of A.A.'s Traditions have borne down upon me with great force. You will remember that episode back in our living room on Clinton Street. That was the time when my group told me I could never become an A.A. professional. With nearly every Tradition much the same thing has happened. At first, I obeyed because I had to; I would have lost my standing in A.A. if I had not. After a while I began to obey because I saw that the Traditions were wise and right. While I conformed because it was right to do so, I still resisted inwardly.

"This was particularly true of anonymity. Today I hope I have come to a time in my A.A. life when I can obey because I really *want* to obey, because I really want the Traditions for myself as well as for A.A. as a whole. Therefore each of our Twelve Traditions is really an expression of the deflation that each of us has to take, of the sacrifice that we shall all have to make in order to live and work together.

"Dr. Bob was essentially a far more humble person than I. In some ways he was a sort of spiritual 'natural,' and this anonymity business came rather easily to him. He could not understand why some people should want so much publicity. In the years before he died, his personal example respecting anonymity did much to help me keep my own lid on. I think of one affecting instance in particular, one that every A.A. ought to know. When it was sure that Dr. Bob was mortally afflicted, some of his friends suggested that there should be a suitable monument or mausoleum erected in honor of him and his wife Anne – something befitting a founder and his lady. Of course this was a very natural and moving tribute. The committee went so far as to show him a sketch of the proposed edifice. Telling me about this, Dr. Bob grinned broadly and said, 'God bless 'em. They mean well. But for heaven's sake, Bill, let's you and I get buried just like other folks.'

"A year after his passing, I visited the Akron cemetery where Dr. Bob and Anne lie. The simple stone says not a word about Alcoholics Anonymous. Some people may think that this wonderful couple carried personal anonymity too far when they so firmly refused to use the words 'Alcoholics Anonymous' even on their own burial stone. For one, I do not think so. I think that this moving and final example of self-effacement will prove of more permanent worth to A.A. than any amount of public attention or any great monument." (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, pp. 134-137) So there we have the metamorphosis of a spiritual principle that continues within our Fellowship. In many ways it has become more necessary and valuable a sacrifice as we have prospered. May it always, actually and symbolically, be 50 percent of our name.

Frank Mauser (archivist)

Its Necessity Today

Anonymity, with its roots in spiritual principles, has preserved the privilege of life and service, which we share. The long form of our Twelfth Tradition states, "... we of Alcoholics Anonymous believe that the principle of anonymity has an immense spiritual significance." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 192) More than ever before our Fellowship stands in need of the sustaining spiritual power expressed by the practice of anonymity. God has demonstrated through us what He can do. Separated from the source of sobriety our massive Fellowship would certainly disintegrate. Our numbers are awesome. Who could estimate the numbers of our friends who stand ready to recommend us? There are thousands! By what power are these lives added and sustained? From what source does our credibility stem? Alcoholics Anonymous is a spiritual entity, a fellowship dependent on the providence of God, and we must not praise ourselves. Dr. Bob's exclamation "What indeed hath God wrought?" (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 9) and the words "Of myself I am nothing, the Father doeth the works. . . ." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 75) do carry bright promise and meaning for our Fellowship. The extent that we live them is the measure of our society's spiritual condition. When we practice the Traditions of anonymity and the spiritual principles from which they spring we sacrifice our ambitions, our need for recognition and our desire for prestige, first so that we may live, and then so the group may live. Just as selfishness can cut us off from the grace of God as individuals, so selfish striving for recognition and prestige could cause our Fellowship to slip from the grace of God.

We are a society of peers. Not one of us can honestly claim to be greater than another. Each of us has a place at the table of Alcoholics Anonymous. In my experience there have been many men and women of religion, medicine, law, and other professions who have expressed their wonder at our honesty, giving and anonymity. Members of society who know of our principles will always recommend us. Should it be evident that we live by these principles, how much greater will that recommendation be! Oh, how I know these recommendations would not be ours if we were to proclaim ourselves or seek personal recognition at the media level for our membership and activities in A.A. Anonymity is the greatest public relations tool we could ever have! It keeps us out of God's light and moves the hearts of many.

The most powerful action of A.A., the sharing of experience, strength, and hope can continue to be a spiritual success under the umbrella of our collective anonymity. The Big Book's chapter, "A Vision for You," describes our earliest Fellowship. "Seeing much of each other, scarce an evening passed that someone's home did not shelter a little gathering of men and women, happy in their release, constantly thinking about how they might present their discovery to some newcomer." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 159) Throughout the book's first 164 pages efforts of unselfishness and sacrifice are described and suggested. It was thought that selfishness and self-centeredness were the root of our troubles. Bill related in his own story that if he were to have sobriety, "... a price had to be paid. It meant destruction of self-centeredness. I must turn in all things to the Father of Light who presides over us all." (*ibid*, p. 14) The principles of anonymity are not only the principles of our Traditions but also the principles of recovery. Traditionally, confidentiality affords our members security in knowing that their membership in A.A. will not be known beyond the members of the group. The privilege of identification as a member of A.A. to friends, family, co-workers, and others belongs to the individual. He or she has the privilege of being as anonymous as is desired, even within A.A. This consideration

that we grant each other affords our newer members a sense of security and safety in our company. Though not a defined part of our Tradition of anonymity, the respect that we offer each other is certainly spiritual.

Anonymity, the ultimate expression of selflessness, gives each one of us equal opportunity to carry the A.A. message. I cherish this thought, for so many of my years have been spent vainly attempting to pound life's door down in order to take my place among the unrecognized wonderful. My heart shrank with fear as I sought helplessly to gain entrance. As A.A.'s door opened, your hands stretched to welcome me. I was helping you, so you said; you needed me! For a few years I abused my privileges, making critical noises and selfishly rendering judgments and opinions. Painfully and slowly the pride-crushing, freeing, principle of anonymity began its march into my heart. Only part way there now, I recognize its value – protecting A.A. from a few elite spokespersons and saving lives which would otherwise be lost in endless personality contests. Because of anonymity, no one need fight his or her way up the A.A. ladder. No matter how far down we've gone, when we arrive, we're here and there's just no higher place in A.A. than here.

Our membership is estimated to be between one and two million groups meeting in over 118 countries, the Big Book is published in many languages, our 1990 International Convention will attract 50,000 or more. Who could fathom the pieces of literature that are distributed each year? The whole world knows our name. Oh God, how great we might think we are. For us spiritual pride is often followed by malaise, illness and death. Media anonymity breaks, problems with taping, videotaping, expensive and somewhat exclusive gatherings of members and other infringements at our fringes plague and disturb us. What is the solution? The lessons may be learned from our history. Early in my sobriety, during a period of heavy suffering, I read *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*. The other books I held onto in those days were the "good book" and the Big Book. I came to an understanding from my study of A.A.'s history that God had answered no to many of the well-intentioned plans for A.A. that the founding members had for our Fellowship. We have been allowed to learn painful lessons of experience. Having been sober less than half the years of A.A.'s existence, I know there is a need to learn the lessons of our past. Let us search our Fellowship's history, and ceaselessly share the spirituality of anonymity. The loving hands of A.A. were reaching out to welcome lost drunks several years before my birth and there are millions still unborn who will look for our outstretched hands in years to come. What shall we grasp to ensure their life? What tool shall save us from ourselves? Anonymity. "It reminds us that we are to place principles before personalities; that we are actually to practice a genuine humility. This to the end that our great blessings may never spoil us; that we shall forever live in thankful contemplation of Him who presides over us all." (*ibid*, p. 568)

Anonymity. Its necessity today is its immense spiritual significance. As the earliest A.A. members reached for spiritual experience so we today must grasp anonymity – "What seemed at first a flimsy reed, has proved to be the loving and powerful hand of God." (*ibid*, p. 28) May it always be so!

Larry Nelson (San Diego/Imperial)

No one believes our coffee consumption

The Omni Hotel didn't have enough electrical power to handle all the coffee pots we used – they were blowing fuses right and left!

Principles Before Personalities

When I first came to this Fellowship I knew nothing about principles but I certainly met a lot of personalities. They ranged from the A.A. social clubber, the bleeding deacon and the gloom and doom "it's just luck if you stay sober" worrier, to the group guru, the elder statesman and the spellbinding speaker. I wanted what you had and you told me I'd have to go to any lengths to get it. But which lengths? Each personality had a different perspective. It took a while, but little by little I began to learn. I could look past the personalities and comprehend the principles which each one practiced – differently to be sure and with varying degrees of success, no doubt – but practicing the principles of recovery nonetheless. That was only one of the many lessons I've learned as I've been making my own spiritual journey, but it was probably the most important because placing principles before personalities is the key to practicing and preserving our three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service. An understanding of the principle of anonymity is central to that application. Bill called it self-effacement, sacrifice, self-renunciation, humility and "... continued willingness to give up our personal ambitions and desires for the common safety and welfare." (*A.A. Comes of Age*, pp. 287-288)

History seems to be repeating itself. Fifty years ago sudden public awareness of Alcoholics Anonymous resulted in countless opportunities for Bill Wilson and other early members to lend their names, and by extension the name of the Fellowship, to all manner of organizations and undertakings. Similarly, in the last few years A.A. has received renewed publicity and become the "in" experience; the quintessential treatment. As in the past, many individuals are tempted to cash in on our increased popularity. Bill and his contemporaries loved the attention and the opportunities it offered. Only painful experience taught them that the risks to the Fellowship far outweighed any temporary benefits. Times have certainly changed. We do live in a more sophisticated world. In the last fifty years we've witnessed tremendous advances in science, medicine and technology. We've learned a lot about alcoholism and how to treat it. But so far as I can see, the alcoholic is still the same. In various writings Bill has defined us as power drivers, self-important, prestige-hungry, big shots and the biggest rationalizers in the world. Science and technology haven't eradicated these defects of character. Our new sophistication and knowledge haven't lessened the dangers. If anything, we as individuals and the Fellowship as a whole are at even greater risk. Complacency and overconfidence can be our undoing. Now, more than ever, we must remember the lessons of the past. If we want to keep what we have, we must "... practice a genuine humility. This to the end that our great blessings may never spoil us. . . ." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 192)

Even as we continue to be vigilant guardians of our Legacies let us remember that Bill also advised us to be prudent. We do not need to go off the other deep end. The Twelfth Tradition urges "principles *before* personalities" not principles *without* personalities. Think for a moment about how you came to understand and practice the principles of Recovery, Unity, and Service. Was it just from reading A.A. literature? Did you do it alone? I think not. Most of us have been profoundly influenced by individual recovering alcoholics – *personalities* – as we've made our own journeys in recovery and service. The power of A.A. lies in one individual sharing with another his or her own experience, strength and hope. *What* we share – our individual understanding of Recovery, Unity and Service – is the sustenance of our Fellowship. The basic food groups, as it were. As with any nutritional

program we each determine our own needs. Our diet would be very bland and we might be less likely to stick with it, without some herbs and spices by way of those distinctive individuals whose unique expressions of experience, strength and hope have guided us. Our principles were forged from the experiences and insights of countless dynamic personalities and it is personalities – many equally dynamic – who pass it on today. If our Fellowship is to remain healthy and strong it must have effective leadership. That leadership comes from vibrant individuals – personalities – whose wisdom, foresight, creativity and dedication will help us meet the challenges of the coming years. We must seek them out and trust their leadership.

With continued vigilance and a careful balance of principles and personalities, we will preserve Bill's dream. In November 1948 his article on Tradition Twelve concluded with this paragraph: "Our A.A. Traditions are, we trust, securely anchored in those wise precepts: charity, gratitude, and humility. Nor have we forgotten 'prudence.' May these virtues ever stand clear before us in our meditations; may Alcoholics Anonymous serve God in happy unison for so long as he may need us." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 94)

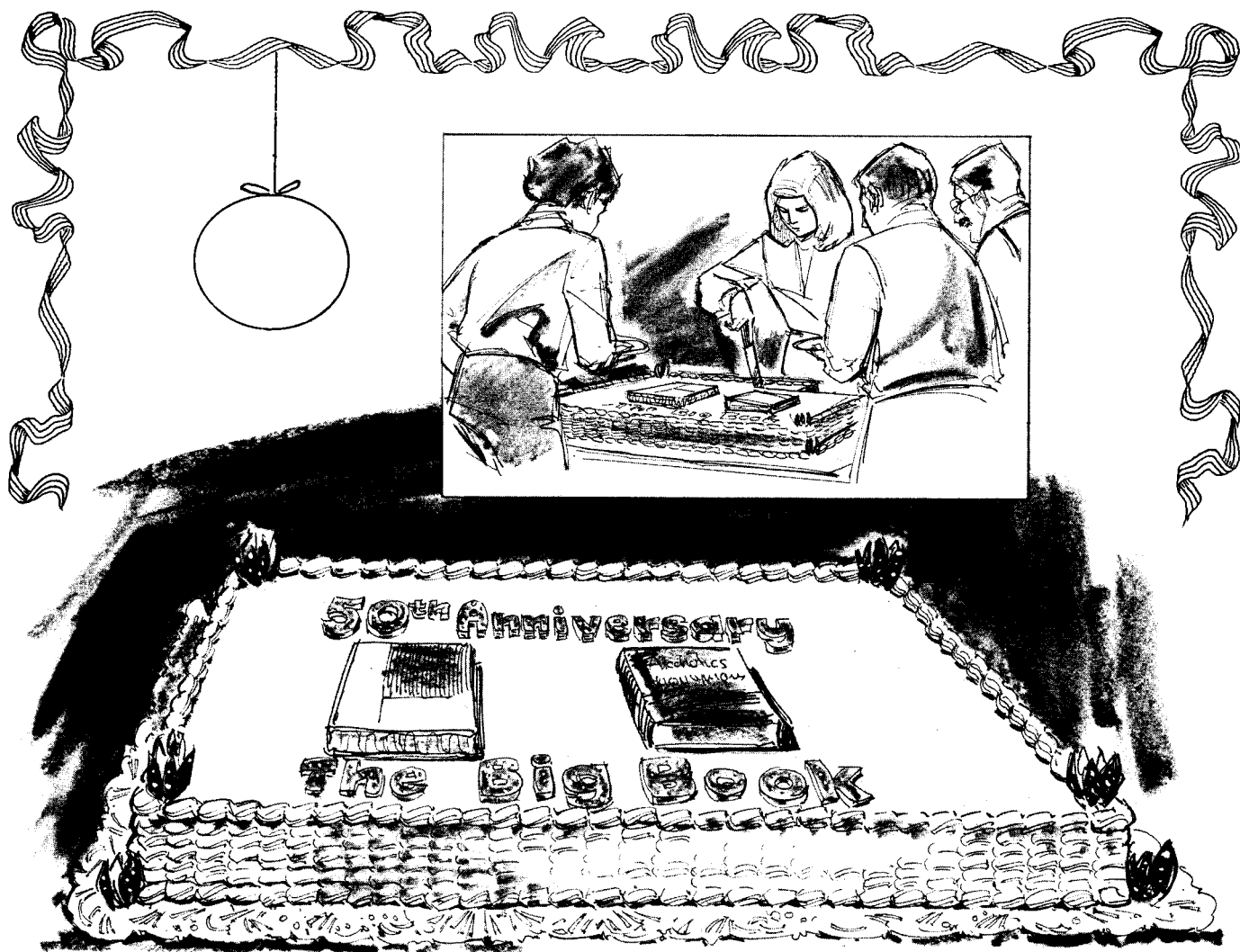
Betty Currier (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire)

BIG BOOK

Monday morning's session continued with a presentation commemorating the 50th anniversary of the first publishing of the Big Book. At 11:00 a.m. Norm Adams, director, A.A. Grapevine, shared a happy birthday message with Conference members and then one and all sang happy birthday and helped blow out the candles on an impressive birthday cake shaped like the book it commemorated.

50th Anniversary of the Big Book

We of the 39th General Service Conference are pleased to celebrate the 50th anniversary of the first publishing of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in April 1939. To mark this date the trustees' Literature Committee appointed a subcommittee to decide how to commemorate number 50 of our beloved Big Book. You would have enjoyed our luncheon. We all ate things bad for our diets and talked with our mouths full – all at the same time! Grandiosity did not get in our book by mistake. You, too, could have joined in the fun as we envisioned "five-oh" commemorative printings, fancy dust jackets, bookmarks and other mementos – "ad infinitum" as it says in our Twelve and Twelve. Suddenly,



on about our third cup of coffee, it occurred to one of our members, "we're creating souvenirs – icons!" he or she shouted. "Just what we want to avoid. We want to celebrate the *message*, not the book!" Arriving at a simple answer sometimes takes us a while. So to commemorate the first publishing of our great message of "more than one hundred men and women who have recovered from a seemingly hopeless state of mind and body. To show other alcoholics *precisely how we have recovered*. . . ." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. xiii) we present you now with our pleasure the following items that commemorate the Big Book message.

(1) How it began: Frank Mauser, our G.S.O. archivist, has provided for each of you a copy of the original manuscript of the book just before its final revision and printing in hard cover. Frank also has on display a copy of a first printing of the Big Book owned by Dr. Bob and other items for your perusal. (2) The A.A. Grapevine: Each of you has been given a copy of the April 1989 A.A. Grapevine magazine celebrating the 50th birthday of the Big Book. It is packed with articles by members and others about the impact of the book on their lives. Be sure, also, to read the book reviews in the centerfold. Very interesting! (3) A living message: The Conference Literature Committee this week will consider various ways to carry the great recovery message of the Big Book to even more suffering alcoholics who seek help, where we all – as one – want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And now, most importantly, what is a birthday party without a cake?

To celebrate our recovery,
To celebrate our gift of service,
To celebrate our joy of living,
We present
A giant Big Book birthday cake!
Happy birthday Big Book!

Norm Adams (director, A.A. Grapevine)

FINANCE

Following the joint trustees'/Conference committee meetings on Monday afternoon, Ed Gordon, G.S.O.'s director of finance and business administration, delivered a presentation on a topic of major importance to Conference members.

I would like to present, review and explain our financial statements in concept, line by line.

In the Financial section of the 1989 Conference Manual and 1989 *Final Conference Report* are several statements including G.S.O.'s Income Statements for 1987 and 1988, our Budget for 1989, Income Statements for the Grapevine for 1987 and 1988, its Budget for 1989, Combined Balance Sheets for G.S.O. and Grapevine for 1988 and 1987, plus comparison shortfall presentations for 1987, 1988, and Budget 1989.

The 1988 Income Statement will guide us through this review. Our formula for allocating income and expenses is to capture them in three major categories: (1) Publishing, (2) General Service Board – Office Expenses, and (3) General Service Board – Other Expenses of the Board.

Income, by category:

A.A.W.S. *Publishing* reflects the income from literature sales, discounts taken by purchasers, the cost of production of the literature sold, the royalties paid on literature sales, and interest earned. The net is publishing income.

G.S.B. *General Fund – Office* reflects the contributions received from A.A. groups and members and interest earned on bank accounts in which contributions are held before paying expenses.

G.S.B. *General Fund – Other*. There is no income in this category.

Expense: The expenses charged against Publishing and G.S.B. – General Fund are allocated as shown into three cost centers: publishing and two kinds of service expense, separated for historical reasons. This allocation was highly arbitrary in some cases but the totals are reasonable. The note at the bottom of this income statement addresses this "allocation."

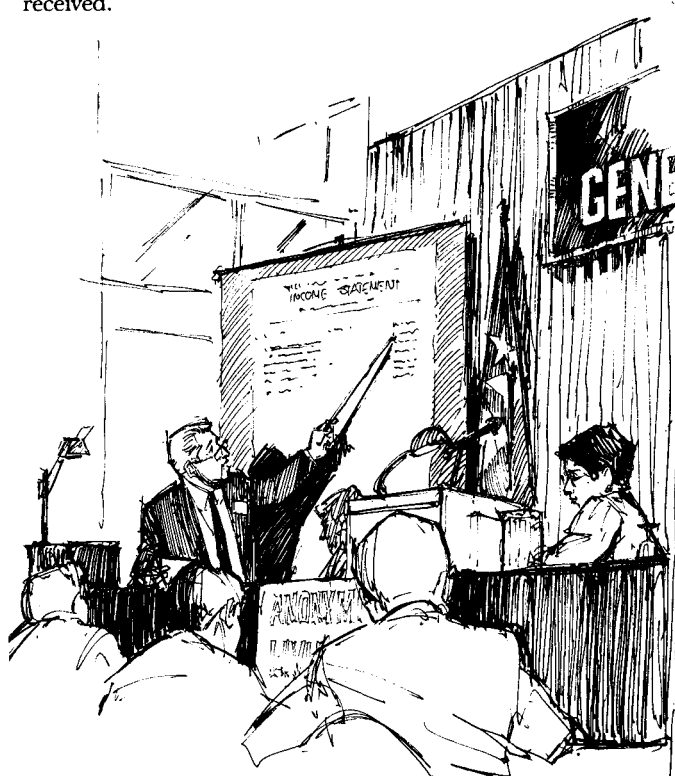
We have been addressing the issue of this "allocation" of expenses, and tested it by applying two separate methods of broad-based allocations and have made progress in a third test in using a computerized general ledger application of functional costing. All three of these tests have supported the overall result of the current method. In fact, they all result in supporting the position that the publishing operation would run at a slightly lesser cost and services would attract more expense. An explanation of each line item of expense under each category follows.

Salaries: The salaries of all positions or departments as allocated to either Publishing or to General Service Board – Office.

Pension: All the costs of our pension and retirement plan, including funding costs, audit and administrative expenses for *all* employees.

Rent and electricity: We currently occupy five floors at 468 and 470 Park Avenue South, representing 39,900 rentable square feet. The Grapevine occupies about 7,800. The amounts in this report are exclusive of the Grapevine share.

Box 4-5-9: This includes the costs for writing, editing, printing, and mailing of this bimonthly periodical. The income from paid subscriptions has been treated as a reduction of these expenses, as the cost of each subscription sold is greater than the income received.



A.A. Directories: Includes the cost of typesetting, printing, binding, and mailing of the directories given away (one to each group and district committee member). These include the Eastern U.S., Western U.S., Canadian, and International Directories.

Other service material: Represents the cost of producing hundreds of thousands of service pamphlets and materials which are distributed free of charge. Some of these include "A.A. at a Glance" (900,000 copies), "A Message To Teenagers" (900,000 copies), "Where Do I Go From Here?" (600,000 copies) and "Circles of Love and Service" (300,000 copies).

Shipping and mailing: This represents two major areas at cost; about 80% are related to the shipping of A.A. literature from our New York office and the warehouses in the U.S. and Canada. This includes postage, UPS, warehousing charges, and packaging (materials) costs. The balance of the costs are attributable to postage and UPS costs for correspondence and special mailings where the costs have not been charged to the function (such as Box 4-5-9 mailings).

Other office expenses: The expenses charged against Publishing represent furniture and office equipment, loss on bad debts, and selling expenses; the expenses charged against Office Expenses reflect the costs of stationery and office supplies, telephone, furniture and equipment, and office service and expenses (including maintenance contracts).

Insurance and payroll taxes: This represents the costs of office insurance including fire, liability and inventory, employee benefit coverages (hospitalization, major medical, and life), and payroll taxes. This covers all employees.

Professional services: The costs allocated against Publishing represent audit expenses; legal costs for labor matters; trademark, copyright and royalty matters; and general corporate work. The costs allocated to the General Service Board – Other Expenses mostly reflect audit expenses.

Board, committee and staff meetings: Under the Publishing column, the amount primarily represents the expenses associated with the monthly A.A.W.S. board meetings (travel, hotel, meals) as well as the expenses for the second Central Office/Intergroup Seminar (about \$21,000). The expenses under the Other column represent the cost of staff and committee meetings. The costs reflected under Other column represent the costs of the quarterly meetings of the board of trustees (travel, hotel, meals), as well as expenses related to the travel of regional trustees.

Writers' fees: These expenses are for projects undertaken each year; some projects overlap years. The projects reflected in 1988 were for: A.A. history book; revisions, A.A. Service Manual/and Twelve Concepts, and new formats for pamphlets; Spanish translations (mainly pamphlets); other foreign translations, such as Arabic and Russian; and other various projects requiring writers.

P.I., C.P.C. and travel: The cost under the Publishing column represent travel expenses incurred by office personnel connected to office business such as trips by publishing personnel to printers to inspect major printings, to warehouses to inspect inventories and check out prospective warehouse locations, and to new or prospective printers or manufacturers to insure quality standards. The costs under the Other column reflect the expenses associated with two functions: Cooperation With the Professional Community – most of the expenses are associated with the cost of exhibiting at about 24 health fairs and the maintenance of these professional exhibits, and attendance at non-A.A. functions. The

costs for the Public Information function vary each year, with the bulk of the costs for 1988 relating to publicity for the new videos, "Young People," and "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell."

General Service Conference: Most of the expense represents hotel costs (rooms, meals), with other key items being delegate travel, the Box 4-5-9 Early Bird, and writer and production costs for the Final Conference Report. The balance includes items such as delegate portfolios, and manuals, presentations, Advisory Actions, and other miscellaneous costs. This is net of delegate area contributions.

EDP systems development: The amount under Publishing represents the costs of maintenance, outside programmers, equipment and supplies. The cost under other expenses represents the 1988 portion of the acquisition and implementation of our new computer system.

Regional Forums and other: This represents the costs of Regional Forums, Archives and sundry. Most of this costs was for Regional Forums.

Film projects: This was the cost of producing the translations for the two films, "Young People" and "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell."

Leasehold improvements: This represents the cost of leasehold improvements for miscellaneous work done to the premises of a permanent nature.

Self-support project: This amount represents the cost of meetings, and distribution of D.C.M. kits.

Foreign literature assistance: This is the cost of assistance to other countries to help them to get started printing literature in their own country in their own language. Although these are loans to these countries to be repaid, the accounting treatment is to expense the loans in the year advanced and to treat repayments as reductions to the expense. The small balance represents reimbursements almost equaling amounts advanced.

World Service Meeting: This event occurs every two years, alternating between New York and a delegate country. The cost for 1988 represents the net cost to this G.S.O., after delegate fees of \$1,400 per delegate (country) and contributions from participating G.S.O.s have been received.

Board expense – international visits: The amounts reflect the board's involvement in dialogue and visits with the Soviet Union and Poland, both here and overseas.

Net income: The amounts here reflect the net income or expense by category. The Total column summarizes the three categories and reflects the results of the entire General Service Office operation.

The last page in the financial section highlights the 1989 Budget as well as illustrates the shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions for 1988 and 1987. As you can see, the shortfall for 1988 was \$546,000, as compared to the shortfall in 1987 of \$177,000 and the shortfall in 1986 of \$924,000 (not illustrated). The 1987 reduction in shortfall was a result of greater participation and increased contributions.

If I may leave you with one thought, your General Service Office works hard at preparing the budgets you have before you and monitoring the expenditures during the year. When we prepare the budget, we ask ourselves a question: Is this the best way to spend the A.A. dollar which starts out as the dollar in the basket and comes into G.S.O. in trust?

Edward Gordon (G.S.O. director of finance)

A.A. GRAPEVINE

Following the Tuesday afternoon Panel 39 delegates' report on area service highlights, two informed and informing presentations on the Grapevine were given. Jim Shannon, general service trustee, director on the Grapevine Corporate Board, moderated the session.

A Historical Perspective on the Grapevine

The Grapevine was born in June of 1944 right here in New York City nine years after June 10, 1935, the birth date of Alcoholics Anonymous. To put this into perspective time-wise, the invasion of Normandy in World War II was underway. From my own perspective it was the period immediately following the battle for Cassino in Italy in which I played my little part. At that time I had absolutely no knowledge of what was taking place in New York City and couldn't have cared less if I had. In hindsight my Higher Power had begun a process that was to be of vital importance to me and my life.

At home recently I found copies of the Grapevine going back to the late '50s, which shows that I was getting something from "our meeting in print" as early as that. I came to the Fellowship in January 1956 to stay. These comments may not seem pertinent to the history of our magazine but it will give you an idea of where I am coming from. In the early '40s there had been a spectacular increase in the membership, which was the beginning of the great influx that was to follow. The March 1, 1941 issue of the *Saturday Evening Post* had that famous article by Jack Alexander, which was responsible for an increase from 2,000 to 8,000 members. Obviously, with this kind of change there was a need for a communication link. Without it there would have been a vacuum. Other newsletters begun in Los Angeles and Cleveland had been successful locally. It was at this point in the evolution of the Fellowship that Lois K. spoke to Bill Wilson and suggested that something similar should be available for the members around New York City. Bill thought it was an excellent suggestion and six volunteers, known as the "six ink-stained wretches," (four women and two men) became the founders of our magazine. It was primarily intended for the New York area but with the support of Bill and the fledgling A.A. office, the bulletin was sent to all known group secretaries, about 300, and the members in the armed services. Twelve hundred copies of the first issue were circulated. A year later in a letter of Bill's dated October 3, 1945, he wrote there was a paid subscription of three thousand. Additional copies were being sold at 15¢ each. The communication gap was being filled. Bill stated that the enterprise should be nonprofit, but that it should be self-supporting and there should be no commercial advertising. These were ambitious statements made long before there were indications of how successful the Fellowship and the magazine were to become. From June 1944 to August 1948 the newsletter comprised eight pages and was tabloid size. From September 1948 until today it has been the same pocket-sized, easy-to-carry version we all recognize. In the first few months of its existence there was a problem with the name. The F.B.I. had been publishing a Grapevine within their organization for some time and objections were raised. The simple solution satisfactory to both A.A. and the F.B.I. was to call our's the A.A. Grapevine. Again in the '70s a problem arose in regard to the name. This time it came from government bureaucracy. The post office required the corporate name of an organization be placed on official envelopes and on the magazine itself. Anonymity would have been difficult to maintain with the "A.A. Grapevine" as the displayed words. The solution was to use the postal box as the legal name. In 1974 "Box 1980" became the legal name to comply with the regulations.

In case you have not noticed, "Box 1980" is displayed at the top left-hand corner of the Grapevine envelopes and also on the magazine itself. The legal name of the magazine is "Box 1980," which also happens to be the address. Over the years the appearance has changed very little from that September '48 issue. The contents still contain the Steps, Traditions, Serenity Prayer, the Preamble, letters, a humor section and above all, the articles written by the readers. Our magazine is for and by the readers.

In April 1945 a questionnaire by Dr. E.M. Jellinek was presented to the readers. From the replies came "Phases of Alcohol Addiction," a chart for helping professionals diagnose and understand the disease of alcoholism. The Grapevine announced the creation of a national health organization to be known as the National Council on Alcoholism. Marty Mann, one of the four women of the original "six ink-stained wretches," had an important role in establishing N.C.A.

The Grapevine is known as "our meeting in print" and also as "the international monthly journal of Alcoholics Anonymous." The idea of the meeting in print was created for military personnel during 1944 and 1945 and was called "Mail Call for all A.A.s in the Armed Forces." It later became "Mail Call for A.A.s at Home and Abroad" and is today "Box 1980." In 1946 it was legally incorporated as one of the two publishing arms of the Alcoholic Foundation with a board of directors of five members. Today it has ten. In 1971 it was reincorporated as a membership corporation. It should be noted that the *A.A. Service Manual* states "The Board of Trustees owns both services, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine." The Grapevine Board of Trustees consists of one Class A trustee, two general service trustees, two regional trustees, three directors and two members of staff.

The Preamble was written by the first editor, Tom Y., and appeared in the June 1947 issue. An editorial board was created in September 1958 and continues today. It acts in an advisory capacity to the editorial staff and has been helpful and supportive of them. An interesting feature in the Grapevine over the years has been the cartoon strip, Victor E., which first appeared in the July 1962 issue. Our poor little struggling drunk just managing to hang onto his sobriety is just as topical in 1989 as he was in 1962. The "About Alcoholism" section is another feature that has become an institution of the magazine. These "gray pages," as they are known because of their color, were first introduced in 1966. The General Service Conference supported the action in 1974, 1977 and 1984.

In April 1946, Bill's article "12 Points to Assure Our Future" was published. These were the Traditions. During those early days there were many articles from our non-A.A. friends: Sister Ignatia, Bernard Smith, Dr. William D. Silkworth, Rev. Sam Shoemaker, Dr. Harry Tiebout, Fulton Oursler. The Grapevine started with 1,200 copies for the June 1944 issue. There were 131,000 in March 1989. The initial annual subscription price was \$1.50. Today it is \$10.00. The 1989 budget is approximately \$2,000,000. There are presently about twenty staff members. The people involved with the magazine are very much A.A. members. One chap over a period of years wrote a number of articles. He drank regularly between articles and did not really catch on to the program for some time. Another long-time sober member who has been a trustee admits to drinking while he was a GvR. Bill himself had an article rejected by editor Sig H. for a 1953 issue. It was about raising funds for G.S.O. The important thing to note is that the editor was not fired.

The Grapevine representative was first mentioned in 1953. A few groups have had GvRs for the last 35 years but they were formally identified for the first time with the recommendation from the

1977 Conference that there be a goal of a GV representative for every group. In 1978, 1979, 1980 and 1984 the Conference reiterated the recommendation. In 1985 it went further to recommend that the committee work with other service committees to increase the use of the magazine as a tool for carrying the message. There were 286 GV reps in June 1977 and today there are over 5,000 in all 91 areas.

With the increase in circulation there have been occasional growing pains. Membership numbers have grown in a more spectacular fashion than magazine circulation, as have sales of the Big Book, which has caused questions from some parts of the Fellowship. However, changes in communication methods during the life of the magazine must also be taken into account. The reading habits of the general public have altered. Television and cassettes have become part of our lives and cannot help but have had an effect. An interesting facet of magazine circulation that describes the kinds of unknown factors involved is one which has occurred in Canada. Numbers have slowly but consistently been on the rise since 1944 with the occasional short glitch. Canada followed the trend until 1980 when the Canadian numbers reached approximately 17,000. Since then there has been a steady but gradual decrease until now when it has dropped to approximately 10,000. Analysis would seem to identify the fall of the value of the Canadian dollar compared to that of the American dollars as the culprit.

Items other than the magazine have become part of the Grapevine inventory. Tapes, calendars, books of Grapevine articles, and most currently the book *The Language of the Heart*, the collection of Bill's articles for the Grapevine, have been made available to the membership. It would be wrong to discuss the history of the magazine without mentioning the most important factor involved in its success. Editorial policy has been the prerogative of the editorial staff and has not been compromised. The Conference Charter guarantees the right of the editor to accept or reject material for publication. The magazine is for the members and is written by them. The staff has been responsible for choosing the articles which are published. These have consistently represented the issues of the day. Issues of the day over time are different but are recognizable as updated versions of recurring situations which will probably be there forever. Prior to the Twelve Traditions, the October 1944 magazine had an interview with Marty Mann. The article was about the reasons she broke her anonymity and why this was appropriate for her to do so and any others who chose to do the same. In December 1945 there was an article which featured the Lord's Prayer on page one. The October 1946 issue had an article that contained sexist remarks. Currently, the issues of the day have been on similar lines but with slightly different approaches. Anonymity, atheism, dual addiction, sponsorship, questions of whether A.A. is changing and if so, how, the merits of the Steps and the Traditions, articles from nonalcoholics, have all been printed. Responses of agreement, outrage, kindness and intolerance show that members feel it is their magazine.

There have been periods of financial successes and losses. During the increases affairs have generally gone well. During the losses, whether the result of cause or effect, affairs have occasionally gone not so well. As a matter of fact they have sometimes gone very badly. Our current editorial staff has recently overcome turbulent times to enter an era of relative calm and financial well-being. The future of the Grapevine is assured with this staff and with the support of the volunteer editorial board.

Tom Hills (Eastern Canada regional trustee)

The Traditions Make Us What We Are

For a magazine – any magazine – to be well into its forty-fifth year of continuous publication is no small feat. As the saying goes, it's a jungle out there, and many a good magazine can find itself shipwrecked on treacherous shoals. Whether they survive or not, most magazines are essentially the same. They are a blend of visual and written images. They aim to get your attention and to transmit a certain message. The dictionary that I use has a few definitions of the word "magazine" – one is pretty standard: "a periodical containing miscellaneous pieces (as articles, stories, poems) often illustrated" (*Webster's*). Yet a second definition serves to highlight what a magazine could possibly become: "a room in which powder or other explosives are kept in a fort or a ship"!

There are two essential ingredients for any magazine. First and foremost, readers – a magazine isn't much good if it just lies around on the table. Second, a magazine must have contributors to provide the material for the readers to read or the gazers to gaze upon. At this point, however, having fulfilled these two basic qualifications for magazinehood, the A.A. Grapevine begins to move in quite a different direction from the rest of the pack. When the Grapevine was first started back in 1944, the Traditions had not yet been written. However, the experiences upon which the Traditions were eventually built were very much in evidence. Egos ran wild, power drivers grabbed for headlines and money was solicited in the name of sobriety for all. Out of this hodgepodge of human emotion emerged a set of principles which were duly shaped and polished by our founders into a set of guidelines for us all. And the Grapevine, which first carried the newly formalized Traditions to the general membership of A.A. through a series of articles authored by Bill W., was an immediate recipient of the wisdom they contained.

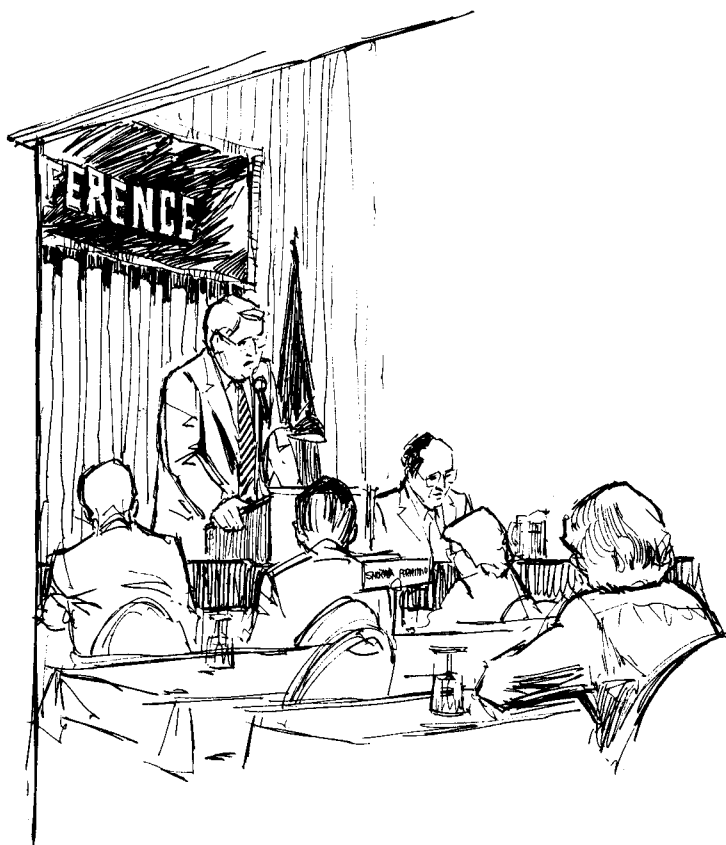
While the Grapevine has always had many of the same expenses as conventional magazines, on the income side it has had few corresponding conventional sources of revenue. Foremost on this list is that the Grapevine does not promote itself and accepts no advertising. This would be absolute suicide for any commercial magazine. Who in their right mind would ignore the powerful revenue derived from advertising dollars? Yet the Grapevine has been doing it for forty-five years. The Grapevine also has no opinion on outside issues, make no political (or other) endorsements. Even if we could, and "our candidate" won, we wouldn't be in a position to accept political kickbacks because we're instructed by Tradition Seven to decline any outside contributions. We don't get to take sides or tell anybody else where to go, regardless of our personal convictions. And because of A.A.'s anonymity Traditions, with their emphasis on humility, we can't even pump up circulation with a few "inside scoops" on well-known personalities who may just have gone into or gotten out of treatment. And most importantly, perhaps, the Grapevine can't bank on the big names of some of its contributors. In fact, we can't even pay them. So, instead of "Ebenezer Folderol, author of the acclaimed new best-selling novel," we have articles written by such A.A. notables as "G.Q., from Canada," or "Anonymous, U.S.A." No, unlike any other magazine with this much longevity of which I am aware, in terms of conventional publishing procedures, the Grapevine's hands are tied – and for that we are most grateful.

There aren't very many magazines these days that are entirely reader-written and reader-supported. And there aren't many magazines where reader interest is the only consideration driving editorial direction. For the Grapevine, readers and the writers are one and the same – members and friends of Alcoholics

Anonymous. The Grapevine is not a well-oiled, moneymaking machine. In fact, we are a nonprofit corporation whose only requirement for membership is a desire to break even. Though we are not a group in the true sense of the word, we do have the wisdom of the Fifth Tradition to guide us: "Each group has but one primary purpose – to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." This is what we're trying to do with the magazine – and in this realm, the realm of speaking heart to heart – the conventional tools of the publishing world have little relevance.

In my private life as a sober alcoholic and a member of A.A. I am well-convinced of the need for taking action. I recall, long before I went to work at the Grapevine, reading a little piece in the humor pages that went: "Pray for potatoes, but grab a hoe." It made absolute sense to me then and still does now. However, I am equally convinced of the importance of *not* doing certain things – like *not* taking the first drink – and the extraordinary spiritual benefit which can derive from that simple act. In fact, *not* drinking is the very center of my sobriety, the taproot from which all action can eventually flow. For the Grapevine, I feel it to be similar. The conventional tools of promotion, competition, advertising, big money and big names – the tools so vital to the publishing world, the elements without which so many good magazines would suffer and die – these are the very things the Traditions encourage us to do without. Clearly, it is *because* of A.A.'s Twelve Traditions – those principles born of the trial and error of many, many alcoholics – rather than in spite of them, that we, as a magazine, have flourished and grown while avoiding that second definition of magazine: "a room in which powder or other explosives are kept."

Ames Sweet (managing editor)



SELF-SUPPORT

Wednesday morning's session concluded with a presentation on the topic of self-support by Southwest U.S. regional trustee Jan Williamson.

Self-Support

On page 27 of the pamphlet "A.A. Tradition and How It Developed," Bill Wilson observes "... voluntary contributions or pledges of A.A. members should be our principal and eventually our sole support. . . ." A little over two years ago the self-support project was launched and the response of the Fellowship was phenomenal. Contributions to the General Service Office went up 37 percent and the percentage of registered groups contributing rose five points. We were off and running! But, as is so often the case, that initial burst of energy has waned. Contributions to G.S.O. for 1988 were up seven percent whereas expenses for that same period were up 15 percent. Our budget for 1989 reflects an expense increase of just over ten percent while contributions are at best holding even. This situation will leave us with a shortfall of approximately \$750,000 for this year. Having cut literature prices to the bone, we are left with very little room to maneuver. The choices, as I see them, are to (1) raise literature prices and simply accept using literature sales for group service expenses – in effect, abandon self-support; (2) continue to draw money from the Reserve Fund to meet expenses (even with a healthy Reserve Fund, we could not go on that way indefinitely, nor is that the purpose of a Reserve Fund); or (3) cut services to the Fellowship. Robert Morse, chairman of the trustees' Finance Committee, recently noted in a presentation on self-support to the General Service Board that, "the budgetary process for 1989-1990 will clearly have to recognize which services groups are willing to pay for." But which would we consider affordable? How would those decisions be made and by whom? None of these options really excites me. Surely there is another way. Our job today is to see if we can arrive at some point of inspiration to find that other way. I have always been told that when the Fellowship perceives a need, it will be met. My personal stance is that we don't want to have the same people in the same groups just dig a little deeper or divert monies from local or area services. I believe the secret lies in drawing that 45 percent of registered groups who do not presently participate – presumably at any level – into participation at every level. The question is how do we best do this?

In December the delegates received a letter from the self-support committee enclosing a page of questions and ideas to consider in connection with this presentation. Sixty-one delegates and seven alternates responded with comments and suggestions. Of these, almost everyone agreed that group contribution sheets should be sent to D.C.M.s and/or G.S.R.s regularly. Most favored doing this quarterly. Four suggestions for improving communications with groups mostly met with approval. I must tell you that the one I had thrown in the pot met with the least "yes" votes. That's okay – it gave me a chance to practice overcoming resentments! In answer to what activities have been most effective in reaching groups with the self-support message, agreement was nearly unanimous that contact with the Fellowship by group, district and area leaders brought the best results. It would seem that meetings and workshops explaining self-support and the Seventh Tradition are the most effective tools at our disposal. Other suggestions offered were: (1) declaring a Self-Support Month (Georgia does this); (2) distributing A.A. anniversary contribution envelopes at area assemblies; (3) sending "thank

you” notes to contributing groups from the area as well as from G.S.O.; and (4) using the Grapevine’s Traditions Checklist. The self-support subcommittee, composed of trustees, directors and a staff member, have been working diligently to come up with new ideas for the project. Several ideas for pieces we could send with the quarterly group statements are included in your Conference Manual for your consideration.

I am sure a great many of you have saved your comments on the December request for ideas until now. I hope these past few minutes have challenged your thinking. We want as many people as possible to share on this subject so I will ask that, as you come to the microphones, be as brief as possible. It is my firm belief that some of you will have that idea or suggestion none of the rest of us has yet thought of.

Jan Kelly Williamson (Southwest U.S. regional trustee)

Self-Support Sharing Session

Following Jan Williamson’s presentation on self-support, 13 delegates took the microphone to share their recent experiences and describe their future plans to better implement the Fellowship’s Seventh Tradition. What follows is a summary of their statements which detailed a variety of consciousness, as well as money-raising practices.

A particular week in February 1986 was set aside by the D.C.M.s in Georgia, according to delegate Gay Gardner, during which the members of all groups were asked to give \$1.25 toward the area’s G.S.O. contribution. The amount collected, \$10,000, represented a high 84.4% group participation. When the practice was discontinued in 1987 and the percentage of group participation dropped noticeably, the practice was reinstated this year by the area’s D.C.M.s with, again, a significant rise in contributions. An added bonus to the practice, Gay said, was the all-around improvement in communication among D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s, with the result that all groups became better informed “about what G.S.O. is all about.”

Panelists from two other areas described their policy of one-on-one communication. Frank Piazza said that “loving, gentle” statements were sent to all groups in California, Northern Coastal Area, regardless of their contributions. No one was chastised for not contributing, he said, adding that the sending of “Thank You” notes – again, regardless of a group’s contributions – has been particularly effective. “One of the things that motivated me was a ‘Thank You’ note when I didn’t deserve it. It hit me with a shot!” Frank said. Similarly, Bill Stigliano, Western Pennsylvania, told the delegates that, after perusing the list of groups that had not contributed, he began sending postcards. “We shouldn’t just keep talking about it to D.C.M.s,” he said, particularly when trying to reach nonparticipating groups. To them, he said he stressed the point that they could “at least” contribute the cost of services provided them for nothing, such as *Box 4-5-9* and free Directories.

“A shift in emphasis,” is what is being planned in Hawaii, according to Dick Mabery. He said that he plans to promote contributions to the Fellowship’s service structure through “definite commitments” by groups, rather than continuing the practice of receiving contributions made from “excess funds” i.e., after the necessities of rent, cake, coffee, and other items have been paid for. In a similar vein, Robert Fitzsimons, of Connecticut, stressing the importance of “not being bashful,” makes the rounds of various groups talking about the Seventh Tradition; he said that each one of his personal contributions presently takes inflation into account. “Putting in a dollar doesn’t suffice any-

more,” he said. Similarly, a notice is periodically placed in the newsletter of the Western Michigan Area, according to Roger Mansfield, asking: “Have you supported our General Service Office?” “I also do a lot of begging,” he said, when he goes from group to group, at which he stresses to the membership that G.S.O. is *their* office and what happens when there’s a decrease in donations.

When it comes to raising money, the “simple, direct approach” has proved most effective in Maine, according to Jake Ham, who said, “all I tell the groups is ‘we need some money,’ and they invariably respond to that need.” Elsewhere, in Quebec Southwest, the institution of ‘Gratitude Week’ during the week of A.A.’s anniversary was so successful last year that the donations doubled the previous year’s, according to John MacDonald. The groups were asked to donate one evening’s entire contributions to G.S.O., or to have a special collection in which to express the membership’s gratitude, he said. It was discovered that the regular contributions did not suffer as a result of the special request. John Dunn, of Arizona, said that the custom had been established at numerous meetings of explaining, at the time the basket is passed, just where the money is sent and what parts of the Fellowship it helps to support. In addition, he said, as a result of monthly “Thank-You-Grams” being sent to them for their donations, groups now look forward to receiving them.

“We’re walking like we’re talking,” is the message that is filtering down to the various groups in the North Carolina/Bermuda Area, according to Judy Mize, who said that her area secretaries let the word spread that contributions were regularly being made to G.S.O. after necessary expenses were covered. Groups were encouraged to participate in the process and “the response was tremendous,” she said, adding that “what is most important is that we keep communication open.” In Northwest Quebec, said Richard Gadoury, “we spend a lot of time conveying the message of the Seventh Tradition in all our affairs at all meetings.” He said the area’s success at raising G.S.O. contributions also stemmed from its “conservative” spending practices at the top – “no computers, few paid employees, and an awful lot of volunteers.” In Washington, D.C. there’s been an “increase in contributions,” according to delegate Ann White, because “we continue to talk self-support up at all meetings, carry a bundle of information in the trunks of our cars, and leave stacks of self-addressed envelopes for G.S.O. on the tables at meetings.” Finally, in order to resolve the problem of informing groups that did not know where to send their contributions, Northern New Jersey’s treasurer distributed a flyer to all the districts which carried all the pertinent information.



VISIT TO U.S.S.R.

The Wednesday evening session got underway with three presentations on the visit to the U.S.S.R. Sarah Price, G.S.O. staff member who accompanied the trustees to the Soviet Union, moderated the session that offered interesting insights on the historical event.

“ . . . he is coming to help us in our struggle with alcoholism.”

The visit by members of the trustees' International Committee to the Soviet Union began November 10, 1988 in Helsinki, Finland. The team was composed of Don Pritts and Webb Johnson, trustees at large; Sarah Price, staff secretary; and Dr. John Hartley Smith, Class A trustee. We met with the Finnish General Assembly and the General Service Office staff in Helsinki. We were told there has been a Finnish A.A. group active in Moscow since March 1988 and they plan to start another soon. On November 13 we took the ferry from Helsinki to Tallinn, Estonia, our first stop. We knew that because we had the box of literature we would be stopped and the literature checked. The customs lady took a pamphlet to another official in plain clothes for an “ideology check.” When she returned, she called over a uniformed man and I thought, “there goes the box.” They were talking and smiling, and the interpreter told me she had said, “See, he is coming to help us in our struggle with alcoholism.” This seemed to set the tone for the entire trip. We met with the Sobriety Society, Dr. Paulo Peep, another private psychologist, and attended an A.A. meeting with Dr. Peep's group. We met a man who operates a “hotline” telephone to help people meet their spiritual needs. We had good exchange with doctors, psychologists, psychiatrists, and recovering alcoholics. These people have a good understanding of A.A. Our primary objective was to share with professionals and treatment providers so they could better understand A.A. and perhaps allow A.A. to happen. Following our get-together, one of the psychiatrists asked us to return the next day and meet with her patients. They now plan to start a second A.A. group and work with the existing group.

In Leningrad, we met with the local Temperance Promotion Society, the head of the Ministry of Health, and a psychologist. A TV producer and her crew wanted to do some filming for a ten-minute documentary about A.A. She was very familiar with our anonymity tradition, and her cameraman focused on our hands as we talked. She decided that this ten minutes was not enough, and her plan is to come to the U.S. this summer and make a full documentary for Soviet television that will really tell what A.A. is about. We will send them our current videos. The head of the Ministry of Health is one hundred percent behind A.A. since his visit here last May. He indicated that long-term sobriety requires regular contact and working with others. These people told us there will be more A.A. and more contact. We then met with a doctor who runs a treatment foundation and teaches other doctors. He and some of his group met with us in our hotel room, which we understand is highly unusual. They know that passing it on is the way you stay sober. At this meeting there was also a reporter from *Izvestia*. She was very sympathetic and understood anonymity. The importance of our literature in explaining and helping people to grasp our principles was discussed. All of them eagerly await the Big Book translation. They lack the resources to do the Big Book themselves.

In Moscow, we met Nadia, the head of the U.S.S.R./U.S. Canada Research Foundation, whose job it is to watch and report back on trends and methods in our countries. They were delightful and well-informed, and indicated to us that they are not certain

that A.A. will work but they believe they must try it. Nadia had been in the U.S.A. and had attended the A.A. meeting at G.S.O. We attended a symposium where a pro-A.A. book written by Peter Sheherev was discussed. Dr. Sheherev, the Moscow Temperance Promotion Society deputy and some others proved to be great advocates of A.A. On Friday, Mr. Tchernykh, head of the Temperance Promotion Society, stated in the newspaper that A.A. was the tool of certain American interests to impose their beliefs on the Soviet Union. They would form no alliances and he would block this activity. However, on Tuesday at the forum, the local Temperance Promotion Society head said they would now support A.A. After listening to many narcologists, doctors, propagandists, temperance people, and local police, it is obvious to me that these people intend to clear the way to give A.A. a try. We then met with Mr. Tchernykh, who was cordial but firm. He had with him about 20 alcoholics who had recovered through the Radnic Club method. We had a fine exchange with them and found they use many of the same basic principles: admission of defeat, group unity, getting honest with oneself and the absolute necessity of passing it on and helping another achieve sobriety. The administrator had many misconceptions, particularly with anonymity, which to him meant “a secret.”

A key meeting was with the chief narcologist of the Ministry of Health, which regulates all treatment in the Soviet Union. He had many questions about our structure and the way we function. He was a tough inquisitor for about an hour. At the end of the interview, he asked “How can we help you get this started here?” We replied, “Give them space.” His chief deputy had met with us at Rutgers so he had some previous knowledge and was open. Thanksgiving dinner at the American Embassy was followed by an A.A. meeting with the Moscow Beginners Group, a Russian group that is registered with G.S.O. It was held in a room provided by the T.P.S. man who had said he would support A.A. The meeting opened with the Preamble, the reading of the Twelve Steps and Traditions. The meeting was a Second Step meeting and as the first Russian shared, I identified my own story. He then said “I have no history of God in my life, but I wanted to be sober and did what they said to do, and I have found a spiritual power within myself.”

I believe the purpose of our visit was accomplished. Adding to all the work others have done before us, more and more professionals know and are coming to trust the process of A.A. We uncovered needs G.S.O. can help meet by providing literature. I am convinced that there is no such thing as a Russian alcoholic, an Estonian alcoholic, an American alcoholic. There are alcoholics and some of them speak different languages. Our Soviet friends' great need today is for portions of our “A.A. Group” pamphlet and for some information on sponsorship. Of major importance is the Big Book, which is almost ready. It has been impossible in this short time to do more than skim over the events of this trip. I am convinced that the General Service Board U.S./Canada need not send another delegation at this time. I would not wish to shut the door on another visit if it became useful, but I believe that the basic work is going on and A.A. has developed.

Don Pritts (trustee-at-large/U.S.)

“ . . . you cannot unring a bell.”

In mid-1987 John Bragg, as a representative of A.A., accompanied a group sponsored by the National Council on World Affairs on a trip to the U.S.S.R. The group was split into subgroups that visited many cities and spoke with a number of professionals

about their number-one social problem, alcoholism. In April 1988 a group of professionals and other interested people associated with the All Union Voluntary Temperance Promotion Society visited the U.S.A. It was my privilege to escort a subgroup on a trip to Cleveland and then to Southern California to visit institutions dealing with education, prevention and treatment of alcohol problems. Two other subgroups visited the Northeast and the Midwest. Later in the summer a Soviet group visited Rutgers University. As a result of these visits and sharing session at G.S.O. during the May visit, A.A. was invited to send a delegation to the U.S.S.R. where a number of tentative appointments were arranged. As World Service Meeting delegates, it seemed logical for Don Pritts and me to go. It was decided in committee that a Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee, preferably a medical person, join the delegation to overcome potential anonymity problems and to facilitate dealing with the professional community in the U.S.S.R. That is how I got John Smith for a roommate.

John and I left Vancouver on the afternoon of November 9, 1988 and arrived in Helsinki at 5 o'clock the following day (allowing for a nine-hour time difference). We were met by Marjatta, World Service delegate from Finland, and taken to our hotel. We were wiped out and retired early. We caught up with Sarah and Don at breakfast and were then picked up for a tour of the Finnish G.S.O., which was quite impressive and well organized by a friendly and competent staff. We met A.A. number one, Columbus, who has 40 years sobriety and is responsible for A.A. in Finland. Finnish A.A. celebrated 40 years in 1988. We broke into two couples for dinner that evening. Don and I went to the home of a member where we were treated to a sauna. Don remarked later that it was the first time he had sat around with four naked guys talking A.A. The next day we were driven to a resort about 160 kilometers north to attend the quarterly meeting of their General Service Assembly. The four of us shared on various functions of G.S.O. and current activities in the Fellowship. We were presented with banners that are normally given out on anniversaries and the presenter stated that John Smith would also get one in the hope that he could attain a year's sobriety. The next morning we embarked on a voyage to Tallinn but in order to do so we had to encounter the hugging committee, which comprised all the G.S.O. staff and several other friends we had met during the previous two days. I expected to be strip-searched and interrogated by Soviet immigration people, but was pleasantly surprised when our luggage went through unopened except for our carton of literature. That night at our hotel I discovered why the Estonians called the worst thing in the world a "Drunken Finn." Hordes of Finns were roaming the hotel at all hours singing, arguing and generally having a noisy time. Apparently they come to Tallinn on the weekend to get drunk cheaply. The next two days were filled with meetings, some arranged and some off-the-cuff as the result of the other meetings. We also had time for a little sightseeing in this beautiful and historic city that dates back to the twelfth century.

We took the milk-run train to Leningrad and four of us shared a small room with four bunks and all our luggage. You almost had to go out in the hall to turn around. Vlad, our interpreter, shared similar accommodations with part of a Polish tour in the same car. The train seemed to stop about every 20 minutes. It was not a restful journey. On arrival at our hotel, Don and Sarah reconfirmed our appointments while we stocked up on mineral water because the local stuff was said to be worse than Montezuma's revenge. Between appointments we were able to do some sightseeing, especially prerevolution buildings like the Hermitage and many others. They are all now museums or government offices. One thing I objected to was that on so many lawns of

these beautiful places there were tacky kiosks advertising Pepsi-Cola. Another overnight trip under slightly better conditions (two to a room) brought us to Moscow, where we checked into the National Hotel directly across the street from the Kremlin.

Our activities in Moscow included a lunch meeting with the Moscow Beginners Group, an open critique on a book that discussed A.A. in part, a meeting with the author of that book, several prearranged meetings with the professional community, including All Union Voluntary Temperance Promotion Society (T.P.S.), and an open meeting of the Moscow Beginners Group held in space provided by T.P.S. The day before our departure, Dr. Smith and I became honorary Americans when we were taken to the U.S. Embassy and treated to a traditional Thanksgiving Day dinner with many A.A. members in attendance, which was a very enjoyable experience. Sarah and Don left very early Friday morning to return to New York. John and I were to leave the hotel in mid-afternoon and had stored our luggage in the lobby of the hotel. When transportation arrived, we found that our luggage had been put on a tour bus whose passengers were heading for some other country. After a wild taxi ride in rush hour in a dreary drizzle, we reached the airport and were fortunate to get our bags in time to board our flight, which then sat at the gate for over two hours because the baggage handlers were changing shifts and the de-icing machine was someplace else. We luxuriated at the Airport Sheraton in Frankfurt that night and got back to Vancouver the following day, filled with gratitude.

I believe that in spite of certain reservations on the part of some professionals regarding the spirituality of our program, the lack of low-cost available meeting space, and the fact that some professionals would like to use A.A. as an avenue of profit and prestige, Alcoholics Anonymous is a fact of life in Russia and you cannot unring a bell. The hundreds of responses to the open-line radio show featuring an American celebrity, and the Pravda article reminiscent of the Jack Alexander article that gave such a great boost to the efforts of our predecessors in North America bear witness to this fact. The growth of A.A. in Poland from its first group in 1978 to 30 groups in 1984 to 100 groups in 1986 and 232 in 1988 give some idea of the potential.

Webb Johnson (trustee-at-large/Canada)

"... give us meeting space."

As most of you are aware, officials in the U.S.S.R. have been working hard to change a culture which is renown for its love of vodka! Any of you who have read *Peter the Great; His Life and World* by Robert K. Massie know that and I quote "to be drunk was an essential feature of Russian hospitality. Proposing toasts that no one dare refuse, hosted guests gulped down cup after cup, turning their beakers upside down on their heads to prove that they were empty. Unless the guests were sent home dead drunk, the evening was considered a failure." Eventually this drinking took its toll; Peter the Great died at 52 and his friend, Lefort, who taught him how to drink, died at 43 years of age. So alcoholism is a centuries-old problem in Russia. Until recently it has been regarded more as a social deviance than as a disease.

Soviet efforts to make a dent in the alcoholism problem have been directed by the All Union Temperance Promotion Society, the quasi-governmental organization that deals with this problem. Their first vice-chairman, Nickolay Tchernykh, called for relative prohibition by reducing access to alcohol and increasing its price. This came about shortly after Gorbachev took over. At the same time the real target of T.P.S. effort has become youth,

a privileged class in U.S.S.R. It was believed that increased sports activity would keep a youth from drinking. Efforts have been made through the schools and teachers are required to teach students that the sober way of life is the only way. The same approach was taken here fifteen to twenty years ago but did not work. As a result of this "prohibition effort," twenty to thirty billion dollars in tax revenue has been lost and a severe sugar shortage has occurred as citizens set up their own distilleries.

In the latter part of 1988 the U.S.S.R. recognized that the prohibition method was not working and I understand it has been disbanded. New approaches are sought and this is where we come in. As you know, Russians have visited the U.S.A. and groups from the U.S.A. are returning to the U.S.S.R. carrying "the message." Groups of A.A.s have been there, which may include some of you here and the word is spreading. The bureaucrats are less suspicious of Alcoholics Anonymous and cautiously welcome A.A.'s approach to the problem – so much so that the system is relaxing and allowing "meetings" to take place and even offering space, which is available only in homes and official buildings. Narcologists, doctors who specialize in alcohol problems, are beginning to understand how A.A. works. In Tallinn, Estonia, a doctor who used to head the state program is now doing private work and "leads" a group. When I say "leads" I mean that he stays involved as, I think, he does not feel they could function on their own. He expressed his concern about the God concept and we tried to explain that the Power outside and greater than oneself (bearing in mind that the state of one's self at this stage is unhealthy) is what is intended. This can be the collective power or support of the group and in many cases is just that. The executive director of the Sobriety Society in Estonia also strongly advocated programs for youth as the answer to early drinking.

In Leningrad we were well-received and great interest was shown by the Temperance Promotion Society and Health Ministry at a meeting we attended. They also appeared to understand the anonymity Tradition, which was not always the case. The executive director is very keen on visiting the U.S. and Canada to videotape actual meetings in progress, if this can be arranged. In Moscow we met with a variety of people: recovering alcoholics, members of the medical profession, voluntary agency personnel, bureaucrats, and scientists. One of the more interesting sessions we attended was a meeting of over one hundred people who came to critique a book on alcoholism. This book had recently been published and rapidly sold out the first edition of fifty thousand copies. It contained information on Alcoholics Anonymous. Many people spoke freely about the book and how it could be improved – even the police participated. The next day we had

a meeting with the author, Peter Schikchirev, a senior researcher in the U.S.S.R. Academy of Sciences. Other meetings were held with research fellows from the Institute of U.S.A. and Canada Academy of Sciences. This organization monitors social change in our countries.

A pleasant interlude was had over Thanksgiving dinner at the American Embassy that included an excellent meal of turkey and all the trimmings, which was very much appreciated by our party. We also met members of an A.A. group that meets regularly in the American Embassy. Another A.A. group we met were the Moscow Beginners who, after a slow start, now get together four times each week and draw twenty to thirty people at the meetings. It was at the Beginners Group that we were introduced to the Reverend J.W. Canty from New York, chairman and co-founder of an organization called "Soviet-U.S. Joint Conference on Alcoholism and Drug Addiction." J.W. Canty arranged for me to meet a doctor who heads the largest medical co-operative in the U.S.S.R. It has eight hundred doctors working in thirteen clinics in Moscow. Apparently this co-operative has been helpful to A.A. in providing space and is interested in meeting with physicians from the U.S. and Canada who have a number of years' sobriety. The last meeting we had in Moscow was with Dr. A.A. Glasov, Deputy Chief of Narcology in the Ministry of Health. We talked about the program for an hour and a half and he asked many probing questions. Dr. Glasov appeared to be convinced that A.A. could help the Russian alcoholic and he in turn asked how he could assist. Don P.'s reply was "give us meeting space."

John Hartley Smith, M.D. (Class A trustee)

1990 INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

Thursday morning's session began with three presentations on the 1990 International Convention that included important information on this exciting upcoming event. G.S.O. staff member Curtis Monahan, who is the coordinator for the Convention, moderated, as well as giving a presentation.

History of International Conventions

It is my privilege and pleasure to coordinate A.A.'s ninth International Convention in celebration of our Fellowship's 55th anniversary to be held July 5-8, 1990. The theme will be "55 Years – One Day at a Time." The history of our International Convention corresponds with the growth of the Fellowship. In 1945 the Cleveland A.A.s hosted a "Big A.A. Meeting" in June to celebrate A.A.'s tenth anniversary. This Big Meeting preceded the first International A.A. Conference. (Our earlier A.A. friends referred to their "convention" as a "conference.") At this Conference the speakers were Bill W. and Dr. Bob and about 2,500 attended from 36 states, two Canadian provinces, and our neighbors to the south, Mexico. With this much enthusiasm it wasn't surprising that the Cleveland Central Office wanted to sponsor the first International A.A. Conference in 1950 in observance of A.A.'s 15th anniversary. The Cleveland/Akron groups took on the responsibility of financing half the cost of this Conference and the Alcoholic Foundation (now the General Service Board) underwrote the other half. About 3,000 were in attendance. The highlights of this occasion were Dr. Bob's last appearance and the confirmation of our Twelve Traditions as the permanent platform of unity and function on which our Fellowship would henceforth stand. After the Traditions and the other pertinent subjects were fully discussed at the closed meeting – it was that fine hour in the month of July when Alcoholics Anonymous had passed its



15th milestone – its Second Legacy of Tradition was secure. Representatives from the U.S. and Canada as well as from South Africa, the Marshall Islands and Saudi Arabia were present.

Following the 1950 A.A. International Convention, the General Service Board of A.A. and its standing committees assumed the entire responsibility for organizing and planning A.A.'s International Conventions. The site of our second A.A. International Convention was St. Louis, Missouri, in 1955. Bill Wilson declared at this time that A.A. had come of age, and the leadership of A.A. was turned over to the General Service Conference. The registration was 3,500 (about 5,000 were actually there). The Convention incurred a net loss of \$16,000, an enormous amount of money in those days. This financial setback did not discourage the A.A. representatives from Northern California. In September 1955 they suggested that the 1956 General Service Conference approve a proposal that A.A.'s anniversary Conventions be held every two years, shifting the location to permit a maximum number of members to attend. They also suggested that the 1957 Convention be held "somewhere in California." The proposal, on a voice vote, was defeated overwhelmingly but later the same Conference unanimously recommended to the General Service Board that the next Convention be held in California. The 1960 A.A. International Convention was held in Long Beach, California and resulted in a net income. The theme, which would be A.A.'s first International Convention theme, was "Recovery, Unity, and Service." In planning for the 25th Anniversary Convention at Long Beach the General Service Board authorized the filming of representative scenes at the Convention so that the General Service Board Archives might contain a pictorial record of the anniversary gathering. A special film edited from the Long Beach footage was prepared for the opening dinner of the 1961 Conference. The film evoked such a favorable response from the delegates that the question immediately arose whether the film might be released for showing before local or area A.A. meetings. Although a number of delegates commented that the film would be of intense interest to groups in their areas, it soon became apparent that a majority were disturbed by problems involved in "controlling" showings to prevent violations of A.A.'s Tradition of Anonymity. On a formal motion to release the film only eight delegates voted in favor and the motion was lost.

In 1965 we moved to Toronto where 10,400 attended A.A.'s 30th Anniversary International Convention. The theme was "Responsibility." The twelfth General Service Conference decided that the total underwriting funds should be \$13,000, of which half would be contributed by the General Service Board. The Convention Advisory Committee of the General Service Conference would undertake raising the other \$6,500 in Canada, with no individual contribution to exceed \$100. The \$13,000 total would represent underwriting funds distinct from advance registration receipts. Contributions to the underwriting funds would be returnable in whole or in part only to the extent to which the Convention registration receipts covered Convention expenses. A.A.s from around the world at the Big Meeting on Saturday night declared "When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that, I am responsible." This Convention turned out to be self-supporting.

At A.A.'s 35th Anniversary International Convention in 1970 at Miami Beach, Florida, the theme was "Unity" and the Convention had an attendance of 10,700. The registration fee was \$6.00 for all Convention sessions and for an additional \$4.00 all could attend the opening dance and closing show. This Convention was a success Fellowship-wise and financially. At the spiritual meeting on Sunday morning, our co-founder Bill Wilson made his last public appearance.

The size of our International Convention has continued to grow. In 1974, the trustees' Committee on International Convention recommended that a convention consultant be hired to assist with convention bureaus, convention centers, decorators, entertainment, and bus companies. Time has proven that this kind of expertise pays for itself by keeping overall expenses down. In the 1970s, with the proliferation of alcoholism agencies and treatment centers, we could not anticipate 19,500 registrants at our 40th Anniversary International A.A. Convention held in Denver, Colorado. "Let It Begin With Me" was the theme. The surplus of funds from this weekend was \$83,000 – an embarrassing amount of money when you're aiming to break even. New Orleans, Louisiana was the site of the 45th Anniversary A.A. International Convention where the theme was "The Joy of Living." The attendance was budgeted for 25,000 and due to inflation and the gas shortage only 22,500 were recorded in the final registration. This incurred a net loss of \$203,000 although the Convention was a success. Because of this experience, the 31st General Service Conference in 1981 recommended that all future events of this type be self-supporting. We doubled our attendance at the 50th Anniversary A.A. International Convention in Montreal, Canada with a record 45,600 registrants. To my knowledge, no A.A. event has ever received more positive media coverage. It surely was, as the theme suggested, "50 Years With Gratitude."

A.A.'s 55th birthday party is without a doubt going to be one of the most exciting we have ever had. A great many A.A.s and Al-Anons will gather in Seattle, Washington on July 5-8, 1990 to celebrate the theme of "55 Years – One Day at a Time." Seattle offers two convention centers and a covered, domed stadium seating up to 74,000, all within two miles of each other in downtown Seattle. There are hotels and dormitories to accommodate over 60,000 visitors and Seattle offers the finest metropolitan transit system in the U.S. The Pacific Northwest is well known as one of the most beautiful and scenic areas in North America. Seattle is a beautiful, cosmopolitan seaport city surrounded by mountains and several bodies of water. The city has an abundance of excellent restaurants featuring fresh Northwest seafood, fine shopping, and great theatre. Summer is Seattle's best season with warm sunny days, cool evenings, low humidity, and long daylight hours.

The Convention will open with dances throughout downtown Seattle. After the dances, there will be a Marathon Meeting, which will begin at midnight, and run until 8:30 Sunday morning. From 9:00 a.m. until 5:00 p.m. on Friday and Saturday, at the Seattle Center, at some of the downtown hotels, and at the new Washington State Convention Center, we plan to hold workshops, alkathons, panels, and special interest meetings. On Friday and Saturday nights and on Sunday morning our meetings will be held at the King County Stadium ("Kingdome"). On Friday night our meeting will open with a Flag Ceremony representing the countries in attendance at the Convention. Following the Flag Ceremony will be one of the biggest A.A. meetings ever. On Saturday night at the Kingdome we are looking forward to watching a professional show for the whole family and the Spiritual Meeting will close the Convention on Sunday morning.

The General Service Board of A.A., through its committees, is entirely responsible for running the International Convention. A local Host Committee chairperson (Eric Bergman, past trustee of the Pacific Region) will coordinate the 1,000 volunteers who will assist us with on-site registration, languages, and hospitality. Although the Convention is international, English will be the principal language spoken at the Big Meeting, with simultaneous translations in French, Spanish, and German. Workshops, panels,

and alkathons will be held in those languages. If registration warrants it, there will be simultaneous Japanese translations. Registration forms will be sent to all A.A. groups, intergroup/central offices, and G.S.O.s around the world in late September and early October 1989. We look forward to being with you, in sobriety, in Seattle.

Curtis Monahan (G.S.O. staff)

A Preview of Convention Program

After reviewing a list of 200 suggested themes, the committee wholeheartedly supported the theme of A.A.'s 55th Anniversary International Convention to be "55 Years – One Day at a Time." The committee discussed additions and changes in the list of topics for workshops, panels, and special-interest meetings on the Convention program. It was suggested that meetings be scheduled on these topics: "Self-Support," "Singleness of Purpose," "Participation in Service," and "Historical Perspective – Black Men and Women in A.A." It was also suggested that a questionnaire be developed for use at the Convention in order to determine the demographics of attendees. The committee recommended that vendors be uniformly excluded from the convention area except those contracted by the General Service Office. A souvenir item was discussed and it was recommended that the concept of a hologram be incorporated into the Convention Program as a souvenir of the 1990 International Convention.

The following is a list of some of the topics for the sessions. For workshops we have archives; anonymity; attraction vs. promotion; the Big Book; cooperation with the professional community; gays in A.A.; the Grapevine; historical perspective – black men and women in A.A.; intergroup and central offices; Loners and Internationalists; newsletters and bulletins; participation in service; our primary purpose vs. other problems; A.A. and prisons; A.A. and treatment facilities; public information; self-support; sponsorship; the Twelve Steps; the Twelve Traditions; the Twelve Concepts; A.A. and Native Peoples; and young people in A.A. Panel topics include A.A. and alcoholism agencies; A.A. and the clergy; A.A. as a community resource; A.A. and court programs; A.A. and industry; A.A. and the media; A.A. and the medical profession; A.A. and prisons; A.A. and treatment facilities; how A.A. cooperates with other self-help groups; and singleness of purpose. Special interest meeting topics include A.A., Al-Anon, Alateen; Birds of a Feather; doctors in A.A.; lawyers in A.A.; A.A. and the hearing-impaired; pioneers in A.A.; golden oldies in A.A.; women in A.A.; young people in A.A.; A.A. around the world; A.A. in Europe; A.A. in Asia; how A.A. began in Latin America; A.A.'s future in Africa; the future of A.A. in the U.S. and Canada; A.A. in the next century; and marathon meetings.

After reviewing the preliminary budget for A.A.'s 1990 International Convention, the committee approved the recommendation that the registration fee be \$55.00 (U.S.). The committee recommended that the statement on travel option discounts be forwarded to the Conference Committee on the International Convention for review. The committee heard a report from the ad hoc Site-selection Committee for the 1995 A.A. International Convention, detailing its inspections of Atlanta, Minneapolis/St. Paul, San Diego, and Toronto. Although Al-Anon's preference for Toronto as the city that could best provide side-by-side conventions for both Fellowships was noted and discussed, the committee accepted – with substantial unanimity – the Site-selection Committee's recommendation that San Diego be the site of the 1995 International Convention.

Joe Phelan (Southeast U.S. regional trustee)

A Few Words about Seattle

If I sound biased about my city, I clearly am. I think I started to love Seattle when I came through on my way to Korea and when I had the chance to settle there, I jumped at the opportunity. You will be coming to Seattle during the best time of year for guests. The weather is darn near perfect. Warm, sunny days and cool, gentle nights. We of Seattle are at our hospitable best when our very bones are warmed by the sun by day and our sleep is gentled by our ocean breezes by night. The list of things to see and do seems endless. We have a world-class zoo, first-class museums and a resident symphony. Outdoor arts abounds in our city. Arts and crafts are available year-round at our famous Pike Street Market, which is located steps away from the waterfront, where a long line of cranes for handling sea-going cargo suggest our importance in Pacific rim trade with such countries as Japan, Korea and China. Another special feature of our waterfront is a ferry fleet that transports thousands of daily commuters to and from their jobs in the Seattle area. You will attend some activities in the Kingdome, home to our Seattle Seahawks and their sixty-thousand-plus loyal fans. Our major league baseball team, the Seattle Mariners, also call the "Dome" their home. The Seattle SuperSonics Basketball Team of the National Basketball Association, plays in other facilities in our city.

Boeing's presence is felt over an area covering some sixty miles, from Everett, thirty miles north, to Kenty, thirty miles south. The fact that Boeing is the most successful airplane builder in the world is evident in the huge facilities it boasts, the constant flow of new aircraft in our sky and the pride of many Boeing employees. The Weyerhaeuser Company, the lumber giant, is very much in the industry picture of this area along with the new and growing "Silicon Valley" industry, led by the computer software giant Microsoft. I think you will be most impressed by our people who, starting with our large Native American population, represent a broad array of racial, cultural and ethnic backgrounds. Our people are ready to greet you in the warm, friendly way for which they are so well known. Please come and join us in July of 1990. We promise you and yours the grandest time!

Lonnie W. Williams (Washington)



BACK TO BASICS

Friday's closing talks were preceded by three presentations on a topic of ongoing interest to all A.A.s. The back-to-basics session was moderated by Phil Cels, Western Canada trustee.

The Group in the Structure

Without our groups there would be no structure. Without our groups there would be no Fellowship because we would miraculously recover and not need the love and fellowship of other human beings. Without our groups we would not need to learn how to live sober, responsible lives. Without our groups there would be no meetings. Without our groups we would not be here this week. We certainly would not need the Conference or Third Legacy plan of action initiated by Bill W. and Dr. Bob in 1950. There would be no Fellowship to assume responsibilities and leadership of the services of Alcoholics Anonymous. Most important, without our groups we would have no message to carry to suffering alcoholics.

As soon as I received this assignment, I began to reread our literature searching for some profound statements. I finally concluded that nearly every piece of literature published by A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine make some reference to the group. Every paragraph I read seemed to contain a part of the vital message concerning the importance of our groups and our Legacies of Recovery, Unity, and Service. Without the groups we would have no A.A. symbol (or logo), of a circle enclosing a triangle, which represents our three Legacies of Recovery, Unity, and Service. Without our Legacies our lives would continue to be chaos. Like our triangle, whenever one leg is removed, the result would be lines that would intersect haphazardly. This haphazard intersection of lines probably best describes my life before Alcoholics Anonymous. It was a group who helped so many of us begin to build the foundation of a sober life based upon Recovery, Unity and Service.

Do you remember that very first group who welcomed you to their meeting and gave you a personal message of hope? Do you remember that group who literally loved you back to health? Do you remember that group who had the most patient and tolerant members to be found anywhere when you thought you were unique or when you asked the same question at least a dozen times a night? Do you remember that group where you were asked to become a member and all of a sudden that alcoholic loneliness began to disappear? Do you remember that group who believed in you and elected you to be a group representative or officer? Do you remember the group who took your inventory when you were unable to do it yourself? Do you remember the group who delivered that tough love when you became complacent? Do you remember the group that laughed with you and not at you? Do you remember that group who loved you when you hated yourself? Do you remember the group and its members who called when you missed a meeting, who came when you were sick and who just stopped to share with you and have a cup of coffee? Do you remember the group who supported you when you became a trusted servant? Do you remember that special group who prayed with you when you struggled with acceptance of life on life's terms?

If you have not had these experiences, perhaps you have missed being a member of a home group. You have missed all of those special times that home group members freely share with each other. You have missed that fellowship and friendship that home group members cherish. My home group helps carry the message to the detox centers, jails and other area institutions. Occasionally I meet an old friend who thought he or she could drink again like normal people. These friends are attempting to get back to our Fellowship one more time. These friends continue to be among my very best teachers. I always take the time to ask them what happened? Why was it easier to pick up that drink than the telephone? Each time I hear a very similar story, they say "I stopped going to meetings and I dropped out of the group. I thought I could stay sober by myself."



From trustee John Smith, "With a name like John Smith I have no problem with anonymity – especially when I try to book into this hotel with my wife!"

"Experience has shown that for most A.A. members, membership in an A.A. group known as a 'home group' is vital in maintaining sobriety through Alcoholics Anonymous. . . . This 'Home Group concept' affords the A.A. member the privilege and right to vote upon issues which might affect A.A. as a whole and is the basis of our service structure. In Concept I Bill W. writes: 'The ultimate responsibility and final authority for World Services resides with the group – rather than with the trustees of the General Service Board or the General Service Office in New York.' "

Rebekah Hathaway (N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan)

Sponsorship in Recovery and Service

Back in the early '70s when I was a young A.A. member, a good friend of mine, Elmer S., would drop in at my home to see how I was doing. Each time he talked to me about our Fellowship, and Bill and Bob, he would also tell me about his recovery and the different functions he was performing in A.A. A few years later Elmer was elected delegate. I was so proud to have him as a personal friend and I thought to myself that since he was a delegate to the New York Conference he would be too busy to visit me, but I was wrong. Elmer kept calling on me every now and then and we would have lengthy conversations on recovery and service in A.A. I was very anxious to learn all I could about the Fellowship, knowing that knowledge could save me one day from a possible drunk, so one sure way to learn was to get involved in service. Elmer told me that I could become a delegate one day if I loved the members and the Fellowship enough to say "yes" when asked to serve and offered my service in different A.A. functions at all levels. Since then I don't know what happened but all I can remember was that I said "yes" to A.A. and the results were and still are beyond any dreams I have ever had.

It is my responsibility, as it was Elmer's, to introduce newcomers to recovery and service by my own attitude as a sponsor or as a friend and by sharing my recovery and service experience. I learned to volunteer and not always wait to be asked, knowing that I and I alone will gain from efforts that I put into A.A. Gradually I found myself talking about the miracle of my recovery and the wonderful benefits of the chance to serve in our Fellowship. As a delegate today, I can look back to my predecessors Bill, Bob, Dave and Elmer and I can't help but be grateful for their efforts to keep the A.A. door open for newcomers. On July 14, 1969 I was the one "by the grace of God" to walk through the door of A.A., so what better way to be grateful than to work my recovery through A.A. service? May I never forget the unique experience I lived through, the many services I was able to perform in A.A. and may I never retire from sponsorship in recovery and service.

Richard Gadoury (Northwest Quebec)

A.A. Literature – Tool or Mandate?

I was delighted to be asked to share on literature in a session on back to basics. What could be more basic than our literature? Yet when I received my "loving invitation" to share on a topic entitled "A.A. Literature – Tool or Mandate?" I was puzzled by the title, especially the word "or." That word, "or," suggested a confrontation, between flexibility and rigidity, perhaps between right and wrong, as if the subtitle were really "tool or weapon."

One of the meanings of the word "mandate" is literally "to put into the hands of." And the more I've looked into the history of our literature, the more convinced I've become that our literature

is both a tool *and* a mandate: A tool that has been put into our hands so that we can carry an ungarbled message to the alcoholic who still suffers. With this thought, I'd like to look at (1) how Bill Wilson regarded the purpose of our literature; (2) the role of the Conference and trustees' Literature Committee in fulfilling that goal; and (3) the challenges and opportunities of using literature as a tool today.

In the May 1964 Grapevine, Bill Wilson stated clearly what would have happened during our first 25 years if A.A. "had never published any standard literature – no books, no pamphlets. . . . By now our message would be hopelessly garbled . . . the public would have thought us a riddle. Without its literature, A.A. would certainly have bogged down in a welter of controversy and disunity. Nevertheless, effective literature was prepared, and in 1939 the publication of the Big Book became our first world service. From that time on, it became perfectly clear what A.A. is, what it believes, and how it works. Millions of our pamphlets and hundreds of thousands of our books are today in circulation. A.A.'s message can never be garbled; anyone at all can find out about us with ease." (*The Language of the Heart*, pp. 348-349)

In 1951 the trustees' Literature Committee was established at the request of the first General Service Conference to be concerned with literature to be presented to the General Service Conference for its approval. Its main objectives were to present an accurate picture of A.A. to the alcoholic who still drinks and to the general public; to provide for future growth of the Fellowship by documenting materials on the Traditions and A.A. principles, practices, and experiences; to inspire continuing participation of members; and to provide essential communication between the General Service Office and the groups. To greatly simplify, then, we see that historically our literature has existed as a written tool to carry our message ungarbled.

In recent years, cultural and technological changes have created new challenges and opportunities for us to carry that message. In 1977 the first audiovisual subcommittee was formed, and since then our message has been carried on film and audiotape as well as in print. Today, we grapple with many questions about how to fulfill our mandate. To me, the question at the heart of all our endeavors is one of accessibility. Can the people who want our message get it or are there barriers? Let me give a few examples of the kinds of barriers we have only begun to address: (1) how well do we carry the message to one-third of our population who cannot read?; (2) how well do we carry the message to people who are hearing impaired?; (3) how well do we carry the message to people who are physically isolated in institutions?; (4) how well do we carry the message to people who are isolated by cultural or language barriers?; and (5) how well do we carry the message to alcoholics in other countries such as the Soviet Union?

Each of these questions has to do with an issue facing this Conference and related in some way to our literature. Literature was never intended to replace one drunk talking to another; that is not its purpose, though it sometimes is its role. When we talk about basics, we must include our literature. This wonderful tool that saved our lives must be accessible to those who reach out for it. We have been given a precious gift; our mandate is to pass it on. To close, I'd like to quote Bill again in that same Grapevine article. "As we continue in the language of the heart to carry A.A.'s message across all distances and all barriers, may God bless us." (*ibid*, p. 349)

Jean Smith (director, A.A. World Services)



**REGIONAL MAP
OF UNITED STATES AND CANADA**

Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O.

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference – via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: Since the meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous a year ago, the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous has:

- Appointed a new general manager of the General Service Office to succeed the retiring general manager.
- Participated in arrangements for the 1990 International Convention in Seattle.
- Selected San Diego as the site for the 1995 International Convention.
- Welcomed a delegation from the Soviet Union concerned with alcoholism.
- Sent a delegation to Russia in return.
- Hosted the Tenth World Service Meeting, held in New York.
- Authorized the withdrawal of \$1,260,000 from the Reserve Fund to cover essential expenses.
- Followed the development of the computer system for the General Service Office.
- Approved the purchase of the First Edition of the Big Book (with handwritten messages from Bill and Lois Wilson) for the A.A. Archives.
- Noted, with gratitude, that the Grapevine is making money.

- Directed A.A.W.S. and the A.A. Grapevine Boards to consider ways to save money through the integration of their administrative functions in a manner consistent with continued independence for each organization.

- Participated in four Regional Forums and one Intergroup Seminar.

- Maintained an awareness of changing conditions affecting A.A.

- Reviewed countless reports, recommendations and requests.

- Produced a lesser number of its own reports, recommendations and requests.

- Taken its inventory periodically.

- Searched for ways to do the best job possible for the good of A.A.

In this recitation, I have identified some of the topics that will be reviewed in detail in reports and presentations by others. I will touch briefly on several of these topics from the point of view of the General Service Board. But first, may I say a few words in tribute and remembrance of Dr. Milton Maxwell, Dr. John L. Norris and Lois Wilson, all of whom died since last year's Conference. They were distinguished, dedicated and devoted servants of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. Without their noble efforts, A.A. would not be where it is today; and without Lois Wilson, there would be no A.A. We owe each of them everlasting gratitude for their priceless contributions to Alcoholics Anonymous.

Wayne Parks is the new general manager of the General Service Office. Wayne's permanent home is in Arkansas, but he will be living in New York during this tenure as general manager. He is no stranger to the Conference, having served as trustee of the General Service Board for a four-year period that ended at the close of the 1987 Conference. I know that all of you join me in extending best wishes to Wayne in the important responsibilities he will be shouldering as general manager.



Wayne succeeds John Bragg, whose term as general manager ends next July, but John will be available for limited service until next fall, should there be a need for his presence. John brought to the job vast executive and administrative skills, together with uncommon discipline developed in the course of a distinguished career as a scientist. We are the fortunate beneficiaries of those talents. May I be among the first to say how deeply grateful we are to John for his outstanding service to the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The exchange of visits with the Soviets was a significant development in the past year. It augurs well for the suffering alcoholic in the Soviet Union. The hand of A.A., which is extended to all alcoholics at all times and in all places, is nearing the grasp of the Soviet alcoholic. All of this is getting close attention from the General Service Board because of its broad implications for Alcoholics Anonymous.

The World Service Meeting was held in New York last fall, with 39 delegates from 24 countries in attendance. It was the largest meeting so far and it was a pleasure to be part of it. Some of the delegates are from regions a generation behind North America in their A.A. development. There was an element of *deja vu* in hearing them speak of problems that we encountered many years ago. More important, they spoke of A.A. with fervor and enthusiasm. Listening to them was a rewarding and humbling experience.

The much heralded computer system for the General Service Office will become operational this year. Eyes gleam when people at G.S.O. speak of the system's potential. They say the computer will do everything but make coffee; and they didn't even rule out that prospect. There is good reason to share their optimism for the project. We will find out what the computer can do before we meet again next year.

In 1988 the General Service Board authorized the withdrawal of \$760,000.00 from the General Reserve Fund to meet a shortfall of income and to cover indispensable expenses, some of them nonrecurring, as in the case of the computer system. In 1989 we authorized a further withdrawal of \$500,000 to complete the computer purchase and to cover anticipated needs for working capital. Recourse to the Reserve stems in part from the Conference recommendation two years ago for the reduction of the price of A.A. literature in expectation of increased contributions to the General Service Office from A.A. groups. The hoped-for balance between contributions and expenses for essential services has not fully materialized, something we will be pondering at this year's Conference.

The General Service Board accepted two awards on behalf of Alcoholics Anonymous last year. One was conferred by The American College of Physicians, and Dr. William Flynn represented the board. The other was presented by The Province of Nova Scotia and John King received it on behalf of the board.

Herb Wales, delegate chairperson, presented retiring general manager John Bragg with a Ship's Log from the delegates, which read:

"A book in which a skipper records the details of a voyage, such as his speed and course, the exact time his engine broke, any significant reductions in the number of individuals aboard while under way, and whether or not he was accompanied by his vessel when he arrived."

The delegates also presented John with a handsome Chelsea Striking Clock, for the Chris-Craft power boat that he and Mary will enjoy in their retirement.

These awards reaffirm that A.A. continues to gain wide acceptance in the ranks of professionals and among the general public. Wider knowledge and acceptance of A.A. is, of course, a highly desired development. But does it tend to induce a sense of security or degree of complacency that increases the risk of anonymity breaks? We may wish to reflect on that while we consider anonymity, our theme for this year's Conference. In that respect, let me read Bill Wilson's final message to the Fellowship:

"My dear friends,

"Recently an A.A. member sent me an unusual greeting which I would like to extend to you. He told me it was an ancient Arabian salutation. Perhaps we have no Arabian groups, but it still seems a fitting expression of how I feel for each of you. It says, 'I salute you and thank you for your life.'

"My thoughts are much occupied these days with gratitude to our Fellowship and for the myriad blessings bestowed upon us by God's Grace.

"If I were asked which of these blessings I felt was most responsible for our growth as a Fellowship and most vital to our continuity, I would say, the 'Concept of Anonymity.'

"Anonymity has two attributes essential to our individual and collective survival; the spiritual and the practical.

"On the spiritual level, anonymity demands the greatest discipline of which we are capable; on the practical level anonymity has brought protection for the newcomer, respect and support of the world outside, and security from those of us who would use A.A. for sick and selfish purposes.

"A.A. must and will continue to change with the passing years. We cannot, nor should we, turn back the clock. However, I deeply believe that the principle of anonymity must remain our primary and enduring safeguard. As long as we accept our sobriety in our traditional spirit of anonymity we will continue to receive God's Grace.

"And so – once more, I salute you in that spirit and again I thank you for your lives.

"May God bless us all now, and forever.

Ever yours,

Bill"

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous worked long and hard this year, as it has in prior years. But the work of the board is becoming more demanding and more complex with each passing year, just as it is for the Conference, the service corporations and the General Service Office. To meet its responsibilities, the board must be ever more efficient and, where appropriate, more businesslike. For example, the integration of administrative functions of A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine makes good business sense if it can be accomplished without jeopardizing the independence and integrity of either organization. Also, in pursuit of efficiency, we are trying to find at sessions of the board more time for discussion and deliberation on significant or spiritual matters affecting the Fellowship, and to allow less time for routine exercises – such as listening to verbatim reading of long reports which each of us can read faster either before or after the session. This makes our meetings both more productive and more interesting. That is my report as chairman. It is, as I said at the beginning, a preview of what you will hear from others who present reports to you. Speaking now for all of the trustees on the General Service Board, may I say that it has been our pleasure to be of service to you in the past 12 months.

Michael Alexander, chairperson

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: A.A. World Services, Inc. is, in effect, a wholly owned subsidiary of the General Service Board with the delegated responsibility to maintain oversight of the General Service Office. We meet monthly; review budgets, expenditures, and salary policy; establish prices for literature and other materials; approve or disapprove requests from outsiders and A.A. members to reprint our copyrighted literature; discuss matters of G.S.O. administration and publishing operations, and such other business as may arise from time to time.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors. Four are trustees, including two regional trustees; one is the G.S.O. general manager (as of April 1, Wayne Parks); and one is the staff coordinator. Also attending our meetings, but not voting, are other G.S.O. staff members, the director of finance, the controller, the services director, the secretary, and the recording secretary. In addition, a Grapevine staff member is usually present.

The operating departments (Publishing, Finance, and Support Services) report to the director of finance/business administration, as does the director of human resources. The A.A. staff, Stenographic/Clerical Department, as well as Archives, all report to the services director.

This report will concentrate on those items from our monthly meetings which we feel will be of interest to you.

During 1988 the A.A.W.S. Board met 12 times. The following are noted:

- Wayne Parks reported for work at G.S.O. on January 17, 1989 and has made a swift and seamless transition to his duties as general manager of the General Service Office and as such, will chair this year's General Service Conference.

- The 1988 expense budget was approved in January 1988. The income budget was also examined and approved with a modification that reduced net income by \$815,000 by further lowering the price of books and booklets to A.A. purchasers by approximately 12½% together with a reduction in non-A.A. prices to the revised A.A. price, resulting in single pricing to all purchasers. This adjustment was effective March 1, 1988, and resulted in a reduction in book and booklet net income of \$652,000. This was due to a reduction in book and booklet sales of \$1,030,000 (annualized) and a concomitant reduction in royalty expenses of \$247,000. Prices of other items were also modified to produce the overall impact on net income noted above of \$815,000.

- We authorized transfer of \$971,574 to the General Service Board to cover operating deficits for the year ended December 31, 1987. Surplus cash in excess of basic operating requirements amounting to \$450,000 was transferred to the General Service Board Reserve Fund in March 1988.

- Consistent with actions taken and approved in 1987, the board requested approval from the General Service Board to move \$300,000 down from the Reserve Fund between January and the end of the year due to an anticipated temporary cash flow shortage; of which \$200,000 was to be moved immediately. The intention was that these monies would be moved back to the Reserve Fund when we achieve a more comfortable cash position, i.e., at a level in excess of \$500,000.

- The board met regularly during 1988 on the self-support project. A review of the self-support committee showed that 12-month contributions were about 6.8% over 1987; or approximately 7.3% under budget. The first six month's contributions were strong while those of the second six months were somewhat weaker. A

comprehensive self-support update was prepared to be sent out in January 1989, with primary distribution to delegates, alternate delegates, D.C.M.s, intergroups and central offices. It also went to other area officers. A self-support session is planned for this 1989 Conference with an emphasis on delegate input.

- The combined managements of the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Boards presented their recommendations for a computer system based on the newly announced IBM AS/400 together with software provided by CSCI. This recommendation was reviewed at several meetings of the external advisory board, was approved by the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Boards and forwarded to the trustees' Finance Committee for their approval. By year end the hardware had arrived and after some delay, contracts with the software vendor were signed in January 1989. In this regard, a recommendation was forwarded to the Finance Committee in July that \$435,000 be added to G.S.O.'s 1988 budget, consisting of an additional \$320,000 for the computer project plus \$115,000 for other items, mainly unanticipated personnel expenses, the cost of providing the *Conference Report* to all G.S.R.s, and international expenses. We requested authorization to draw up to \$435,000 from the Reserve Fund to cover these budget additions.

- During 1988, we accepted a recommendation to publish the Big Book on computer disc and to produce a videotape version of Chapter 5 in sign language for the hearing impaired. We forwarded to the Conference Sharing Session the results of a questionnaire to delegates regarding taping stories from the Big Book for members with reading disabilities.

- After considerable discussion, Creating a Sober World (CASW) has decided not to underwrite a Russian translation of the Big Book which had been undertaken by an A.A. member in Finland. Instead, individual A.A. members supported the initial phase of the work. Accordingly, A.A.W.S. approved an expenditure of \$2,000 to cover completing the translation, asking the translator to assign the copyright to A.A.W.S., which has been agreed to.

- On the advice of legal counsel, we took appropriate action with respect to trademark violation regarding Nan Robertson's book *A.A. - Inside Alcoholics Anonymous*. As a result, the title was changed to *Getting Better*, as was the design and color of the cover and dust jacket, and an appropriate disclaimer was included. Finally, we withheld permission to use certain portions of A.A.'s copyrighted material. Response to this office regarding the book, along with articles about it was less than we had anticipated. Our response to outsiders has been our usual "no comment," although there was strong objection among the Fellowship to this serious anonymity break.

- We forwarded to the General Service Board our recommendation to continue copyright renewal activities on the Big Book. (In 1985 we authorized and initiated our original inquiries regarding reinstatement.) It has since become clear, however, that there is little chance for success in this regard.

- John Bragg attended the Mexican National Convention in Mexico City in June 1988, where he was an invited speaker. A.A.W.S. accepted an invitation to participate as observers at the third A.A. General Service Conference of Polish in Warsaw, during July 1988. Sarah Price from the General Service Office, and Webb Johnson, trustee-at-large/Canada, attended.

- At the request of the National Council of World Affairs Organization, Don Pritts, Webb Johnson, Sarah Price and John Bragg attended the American-Soviet Exchange on Alcohol Abuse and Alcohol Prevention and Treatment on April 26 in Washington, D.C. The Soviet delegation later arrived at G.S.O., on May 6, and spent a day hearing presentations on A.A., with a wrap-up session

on the following day. The Soviets expressed considerable interest in learning more about A.A. In connection with hosting this historic event, A.A.W.S. approved an expenditure of up to approximately \$10,000.

- Two members of the Soviet professional community have indicated they would like to translate, publish and distribute A.A. literature. Recognizing the great need in the U.S.S.R., we are studying various alternatives for the translation, publishing rights and cost of literature, particularly the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and *Living Sober*. This subject was referred to the trustees' International Committee for further discussion.

- A draft of a new policy on Big Book and other translations of Bill W.'s work was forwarded to the International Committee for their review and comments, and was subsequently approved by the A.A.W.S. Board.

- We granted permission/did not object to 113 requests to reprint and five requests to tape-record/videotape from A.A. literature. We withheld or objected to 12 requests.

- We approved the following prices: A.A. in Correctional Facilities 20¢; A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators 10¢; Bill's Own Story, ½" video cassette, weekly rental, \$35, long-term leasing \$80; Bill Discusses the Traditions, ½" video cassette, weekly rental \$35, long-term leasing \$80; TV PSAs, existing spots available on 1" tape \$35; It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell, (Spanish) \$15; Young People and A.A., video cassette (Spanish) \$15; Big Book cassette album (Spanish) \$25; Guidelines on Answering Services (Spanish) 10¢ (first ten available at no charge); A.A. In Your Community (Russian) 40¢; If You Are A Professional (Russian) 45¢.

- During 1988 the board initiated an intensive study of ways to reduce current operating costs when the present lease expires in 1991.

- The Third Central Office/Intergroup Seminar was held in Dallas, Texas November 4-6, with assistance from A.A.W.S. There were 162 in attendance, up 21 percent from the previous year. The Seminar was well-received and we are hopeful that a fourth annual seminar will be scheduled later in 1989.

- We welcomed two new directors – Jan Kelly Williamson from Texas and Hugh Freyer from New York City, replacing Joe Phelan and Harold Greene upon their rotation. In August, G.S.O. welcomed two new staff members, Pat Rosenstiel from Texas, and Richard Bush from Missouri.

- We have developed a statement of policy for the office regarding the use of A.A.'s logo, which was forwarded to the Conference Report and Charter Committee with the suggestion that it be included as an addendum under "use of the logo" in the A.A. *Service Manual* (p. 93).

- We formally notified the Roosevelt Hotel that we will not be using their facility in 1989 or 1990, and have accepted the Omni Park Central's bid for 1989. Prices will be about 10% greater for rooms, but about the same for meals. We have informed the Roosevelt that we will review the progress of their renovation later in 1989 with an eye toward possibly renewing our relationship with them at some future date.

- A draft of the 1989 budget was examined and approved in December for referral to the trustees' Finance Committee. It was recommended that \$500,000 be moved from the Reserve Fund to serve as operating capital during 1989.

- The total budget projects a contributions increase of 7% and an expense increase of approximately 10.8%, which will create a shortfall of contributions to service expenses. Because contributions in 1988 increased by only 7% over 1987, we are budgeting only the same increase for 1989, in spite of the fact that service expenses will increase. This year the discrepancy will be covered by excess publishing income, but the five-year self-support plan requires that by 1992 service expense and contributions be brought into balance. Our long-range plan is based on this.

Bill Croke, chairperson.



ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: A wide range of archival activity was covered at our three meetings since the 1988 General Service Conference. Our summer meeting was held in the archives at G.S.O. where committee members saw first-hand the new acquisitions and reviewed the procedures for gathering, handling and preserving our collection. We attempted to improve access policies by preparing and approving for use several new documents designed to strengthen our primary goal of assuring confidentiality of our material and the anonymity of our members who use it. These include a statement of rules governing use of the G.S.O. Archives reading room; an application for use of research facilities; a statement of the rules governing the use of confidential material; researcher's agreement; and policy statements regarding the trustees' Archives Committee and the Archives Department.

We expressed the belief that the G.S.O. collection should consist of all relevant documents pertaining to the beginnings and subsequent growth of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous both in the U.S./Canada and worldwide. These items should include but not be limited to correspondence of our co-founders and other influential past and present members and nonalcoholic supporters, group correspondence, oral histories, and films, slides and photographs of A.A.-related subjects. In each case, it would be desirable to have originals; however, if originals are unavailable, we would appreciate photocopies. The committee discussed the purchase of a new archival junior display because of the increasing demand from conferences and forums. Committee approval was contingent on the availability of funds. The committee approved the Archival Display Form designed to gather data on usage.

We extend the policy of photocopying our correspondence to our directories and other confidential items in order to preserve the physical directories and to assure confidentiality. We will continue to provide photocopies to area archives centers that have a permanent repository and an archives committee providing access approval.

It was suggested that we systematically collect intergroup and central office pictures and histories. It was agreed there would be a mailing to intergroups, particularly those with newsletters, inviting them to participate in the collection of these photos and histories. The mailing might contain a suggested "article" for incorporating some of our "Don't Throw Me Away, I Belong to A.A." objectives.

It was suggested that our newsletter *Markings* contain an "archival swap" section so that members can trade archival items.

Since three of our very earlytimers passed away in the last few months, Milton Maxwell, Lois Wilson and Dr. Jack Norris, the committee recommended that through the widest means possible, the historical contributions of these individuals be made known to our members. Gordon Patrick was suggested as a potential author of such a piece because he knew each of these individuals quite well over many years. Additionally, the possibility of developing audiovisual material and other ideas designed to expose our members to the history of A.A. was posed. The committee felt that new ways should be explored to bring a sense of the Fellowship's history to members and that this be placed on the agenda for the next meeting.

The committee recommended that "Markings on the Journey" be separated from *Box 4-5-9* and "Circles of Love & Service" on the video cassettes.

Thomas G. Hills, chairperson

Archivist's report: Near the close of 1988 and again in the opening weeks of this year we lost three significant witnesses to our past. Lois, who by nature of her viewpoint and longevity lived a life inextricably bound to the fabric of A.A. life. Her destiny was ours. She died on October 6, 1988. Milton Maxwell, past chairperson of the General Service Board and our archives committee, passed on to us a deeper understanding of our own strengths and vulnerabilities, which underscore the need for vital reflections on our Traditions. His paper on the Washingtonians, which included comparisons to our Fellowship, was written almost forty years ago and remains fresh and informative. Milton died on October 28, 1988. Finally, Dr. Jack Norris whose footprints on our Fellowship assure him a featured place in our history, passed away on January 13, 1989. These nonalcoholics leave imprints of their characters on our collective character. We are they.

To accommodate the burgeoning growth within our Fellowship and to respond more fully to increasing calls for historically relevant material, the trustees' Archives Committee has urged the computerization of our retrieval systems. It is expected that we will be on-line by fall of 1989. The archives will then progress from a custodial mode to a pro-active, informative mode.

Our collecting continues to make important acquisitions. From a family member came a large assemblage of Ruth Hock's personal correspondence, photographs and even some home movie footage. These items bring a human dimension to our material on one of the most significant persons in early A.A. history. Other members provided personal letters to and from Dr. Bob and some between Ebby and a long-timer from Ohio. Our appreciation of these individuals increases as these letters reveal more of each individual.

Don P., trustee-at-large/U.S., and Sarah P., staff member, returned from the Soviet Union laden with memorabilia for the archives: a very large porcelain tea/coffee pot inscribed with greetings to the General Service Board from the Moscow Group and a Proclamation of Gratitude in English and Russian signed by members of the same Moscow group.

Finally, from Dr. Bob's family came a First Edition, first printing of the Big Book with dedications from Bill to Lois and from Lois to Dr. Bob's family – quite an addition! How fortunate we are to be custodians of this treasure. Come see it!

Frank Mauser, archivist



CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: The committee reviewed the 1988 Advisory Actions pertaining to the General Service Conference and recommended to the Conference Agenda Committee that the theme for the 39th Conference be "Anonymity – Living Our Traditions." The committee recommended that there be one workshop, that it be longer in duration and the topic be on the Conference theme. The committee reviewed suggestions received through the Conference Evaluation Questionnaire, the G.S.O. Post Conference Sharing Session and other suggestions and recommended the following:

- Move the agenda items that have routinely taken place on Monday morning to Sunday afternoon, thereby adding 1½ hours to the agenda for use in other places.
- Investigate other hotels in N.Y.C. and perhaps one site outside the city for possible relocation of the Conference.
- As a result, the committee recommended the Omni Park Central for 1989.
- Include three 30-minute presentations on the Grapevine, the 1990 International Convention and the trustees' trip to the U.S.S.R.

In addition, the following are noted:

- The committee also felt that time should be scheduled on the agenda for a brief acknowledgment of the 50th anniversary of the Big Book.
- The committee reviewed and selected questions for the workshop on anonymity.
- The committee reviewed all items sent for the Conference Agenda and suggested the secretary communicate our decision regarding each rejected item and why it was not chosen. Such reasons included issues of group or area autonomy and recent Conference discussion.
- Most items were forwarded to the appropriate Conference or trustees' committee.
- The committee reviewed and finalized the Conference Agenda and selected participants for the various presentations.
- The committee reaffirmed that we refrain from addressing the same committee agenda topics at two consecutive Conferences.

Ruth Jagodzinski, chairperson

Staff report: The responsibilities of this assignment involve coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for the Conference. The Conference Coordinator is a contact for all Conference members and all those serving on the general service committees in the 91 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

The purpose of the General Service Conference is to assume the responsibility of leadership once held by the founders of Alcoholics Anonymous and, through its structure, to carry the A.A. message. It is a body that expresses the group conscience of the Fellowship.

All A.A. members are encouraged to submit suggestions for the agenda. This is usually accomplished through the delegates. The suggestions are then presented to the trustees' Conference Committee for discussion and referral to the appropriate Conference Committee. All suggestions sent in are discussed and considered.

The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- Collecting ideas for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics.
- Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Corresponding regularly with all delegates in preparation for the Conference and throughout the year with news from G.S.O.
- Working with the general manager, office manager, and G.S.O. staff in planning and coordinating the Conference.
- Scheduling and routing all reports and other material for the Conference Manual, Early Bird Edition of Box 4-5-9 and the *Final Conference Report*.
- Reviewing minutes, reports and all communications received from area and district committees.

Helen Turnquest

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community has met three times since the last General Service Conference. At the July 31 meeting of the trustees' C.P.C. Committee, a subcommittee comprising Jim Ahern, Peter Brock and John King was appointed to study possible revisions in C.P.C. literature. Terry Barrett was later added to the committee, and John King was named chairperson. The subcommittee met and forwarded a recommendation for changes in the text of the pamphlet "Alcoholics Anonymous and Occupational Alcoholism Programs" to the trustees' C.P.C. Committee, and recommended the name of the pamphlet "Alcoholics Anonymous and Occupational Alcoholism Programs" be changed to "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs."

At the January meeting the Committee accepted the report of the C.P.C. literature subcommittee and put the item on the agenda for the Conference C.P.C. Committee. A joint meeting of the trustees' C.P.C. and Public Information Committees was held to discuss the issue of carrying the A.A. message to minorities as requested by the 1988 Conference C.P.C. Committee. The C.P.C./P.I. joint committee meeting was held January 29, 1989. After reports and discussion, a proposal was forwarded to the trustees' C.P.C. Committee to publish an article in Box 4-5-9 in which we indicate to the Fellowship that we are taking our inventory as to how well we are doing in carrying the message to minorities, and ask all C.P.C. committees to do the same and share their experience.

The Committee received a report from the joint C.P.C./P.I. meeting and voted to forward the report to the General Service Board and the Conference C.P.C. Committee for consideration.

The committee regularly reviewed the Professional Exhibit schedule for 25 national conventions in 1990 and made appropriate deletions as well as adding the National Association of Social Workers, the Midwest Addictions Conference, the Canadian Criminal Justice Association, the American Bar Association, and the National Organization of Student Assistance Programs.

William E. Flynn, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: The staff member on this assignment serves as secretary to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community and the Conference C.P.C. Committee. This fall, the C.P.C. staff member attended three seminars and meetings with special interest in workshops and meetings on minorities, in an effort to gather information for the minorities initiative. The first was a "Self-help groups for people of color" seminar sponsored by four New York area self-help clearing houses. The second conference was the Association of Alcohol and Drug Problems National Convention in Charlotte, North Carolina, which included workshops on working with minorities. The third conference was the Conference on Alcoholics in the Black Community held in Newark, New Jersey. The minorities initiative was discussed at the trustees' joint subcommittee meeting in January and a report was forwarded to the trustees' C.P.C. Committee.

The staff member on this assignment participated in a C.P.C. workshop held by the Boston Intergroup and the Eastern Massachusetts Area C.P.C. Committee. Two meetings of the National Advisory Council of the National Institute of Alcoholism and Alcohol Abuse in Washington, D.C. provided helpful information.

An approved list of national professional conventions at which the professional exhibit will be shown this year is underway. The staff member on this assignment has passed on information about professional conventions at which we are scheduled to exhibit to area delegates. Some area C.P.C. committees arrange for an exhibit at these conventions and we provide literature for them as we do for Professional Exhibit volunteers. The staff member has also helped update the pamphlet "Alcoholics Anonymous and Occupational Alcoholism Programs," which may soon have a new title, "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs."

Richard Bush



CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to recommend ever-improving ways to help carry the message to alcoholics in correctional facilities. Since the last Conference, our committee has met three times and we have several projects in progress.

The literacy project has prompted much discussion on whether A.A. is effectively communicating the letter and spirit of the A.A. Fellowship to alcoholics in correctional facilities. Printed words alone do not reach the reader with limited reading skills who is in correctional facilities. A huge gap can exist between those on the outside and those in prison. It is this gap that the committee wishes to eliminate. To that end, prison regulations must be understood and honored. "There is a cool and healing sympathy" through one A.A. reaching out for another . . . there is no substitute.

In thinking about the various avenues for carrying the message behind the walls, the trustees' committee participated in lengthy discussions about how best to utilize audio tapes of A.A. talks (especially stories of present and former inmates) as a tool to carry the message to inmates who are not strong readers. The trustees' committee will bring this topic to the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for discussion this week. The committee believes that the idea of audio tapes for inmates who are not good readers is a very positive one, and that perhaps it would be the prerogative of the local committees and service workers to assess the need for, as well as acceptability of tapes of A.A. talks. It would then be the responsibility of the A.A. member on the outside to make arrangements with the correctional facility concerning the delivery of such tapes to inmates.

A subcommittee to develop suggestions for revision to the leaflet "Carrying the Message Inside the Walls" was appointed. The subcommittee decided on a revision of the leaflet to a small pamphlet that would include the suggestions of the 1988 General Service Conference. This new material will be available for review by the Conference Committee. The revisions to the pamphlet "A.A. in Prisons" (recommended by the 1988 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities) are available now. They include an easy-to-read pamphlet for inmates and outside A.A.s interested in starting A.A. groups, as well as a brief pamphlet to provide information about A.A. to administrators of correctional facilities.

The phrase "A.A. contact" has replaced the term "prerelease sponsorship" in the workbook, and has been included as other pamphlets are being printed.

Trustees' committee member Jim Shannon, accompanied the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee's exhibit to the Congress of Correctional Facilities in Denver, Colorado, in August.

The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities hopes that new ways to carry the message inside the walls will continue to be discussed and discovered. Our concern is that we keep an open mind to the best ways of carrying the message behind the walls. We search for, and encourage everyone involved, to help find and use the best methods for becoming part of the solution for the suffering alcoholic who is incarcerated.

Amos E. Reed, chairperson

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities Desk services approximately 1,600 correctional facilities groups and their outside A.A. contacts, 600 correctional facilities and institutions chairpersons, and the Southeastern U.S. Region. A.A. groups in correctional facilities, which are listed in the Correctional Facilities Directory, receive a Correctional Facilities Group Handbook that contains Conference-approved pamphlets directed to members who are confined and the Correctional Facilities Directory. In addition, each group receives a copy of the Big Book, complimentary literature and *Box 4-5-9*. Discount packages of A.A. literature in English, Spanish and French are always welcomed by inside groups and Correctional Facilities Committees. The Grapevine donates back issues and damaged literature to groups and confined A.A.s.

A.A. members in prison write to G.S.O. for prerelease group, individual, or intergroup/central office contacts. Before the inmate's release the G.S.O. staff member works with correctional facilities committees and the central office and local A.A. groups to help the A.A. member make this transition with a meeting list and telephone number in his or her pocket. Hundreds of free-world A.A. members share experience, strength and hope with A.A. members who are in correctional facilities through the Institutions Correspondence Service. It has been wonderful to see the positive response of outside A.A.s to our recent *Box 4-5-9* plea for correspondents.

The staff member in this assignment updates the Institutions Correspondence List and helps match inmates who may have been waiting for months for contact with an individual A.A. who will write to them. The Correctional Facilities Workbook is sent to new chairpersons. Guidelines and pamphlets are available for A.A. members interested in correctional facilities work.

The video "It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell" has been well-received. A total of 1,086 video cassettes were sold and 86 complimentary copies were sent out. The films "A.A. An Inside View," "Bill's Own Story," and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," and the film strips and videos "Circles of Love and Service" are available at no charge to correctional facilities groups.

The staff member in this assignment answers all correspondence from inmates and correctional facilities committees and writes approximately 6,000 letters a year. She reads committee minutes and newsletters and prison newsletters prepared by A.A.s on the "inside." The staff member is also responsible for the correctional facilities section of *Box 4-5-9*. A.A. inmates frequently contact the staff member on this assignment for help bringing "outside" A.A.s to share in prison meetings. Local contacts are found to answer these requests. The staff member visited the Texas Department of Corrections and the New York State Department of Corrections to better understand how Alcoholics Anonymous can carry the message "inside."

The pamphlet "A.A. in Prisons" has been discontinued and the material has been revised and updated in two new pamphlets: "A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators" and "A.A. in Correctional Facilities."

Institutions Correspondence Service, outside A.A. prison contacts, group sponsors, individual A.A. members who visit men and women behind the walls, all offer a ray of hope to A.A. members who are incarcerated. Each of these is a means of communication with A.A. worldwide. We see letters which share with us the miracles of recovery which are a result of your Twelfth Step work; voices of gratitude for your sharing experiences, strength and hope for a future of spiritual Fellowship a day at a time.

Pat Rosenstiel

Trustees' committee: As treasurer and chairperson for the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, I have the privilege to serve a group where spirituality and money have to mix. An underlying theme of this committee's activities and deliberation comes from the Tradition of self-support, which means "I am Responsible."

Four years ago, when I became chairperson of this committee (after a three-year apprenticeship as a consultant), I observed that the Fellowship emphasizes the Twelve Traditions, and I began asking a question about fulfilling the "I am Responsible" ideal. Why don't we live by the Seventh Tradition in group services? Ought we be fully self-supporting consistently?

The 1989-1991 junction, aided by full cost accounting allocation, is beginning to provide a clearer picture of group support for services. Specifically, groups have the *capacity* to support services but such support requires a full-time effort, as the fall-off of the last several months of 1988 reflected; and serious budgeting in the future must be undertaken if we are to live up to and within the Seventh Tradition. This will be a year of serious financial reflection by the trustees' committee. The budgetary process for 1989-1991 will clearly have to recognize those services for which groups are willing to pay. This process may be painful if certain services cannot be considered affordable.

Excess income from literature sales, which contained an increasing profit from sales to outsiders, had overtones of "outside contributions." Increasing self-support efforts and awareness of growing dependency on outside sales, followed by lower prices and single pricing, have helped reemphasize the Seventh Tradition.

A review of 1988's operations was highlighted by several key items. Contributions, although greater than 1987, were significantly less than budgeted for 1988; publishing income was higher than 1987 and greater than budgeted for 1988 due to higher than projected unit sales. In addition, there was an operating deficit in 1988 compared to a budgeted operating income in 1988 and



GENERAL SHARING SESSION

an actual 1987 operating income. Net sales of \$7,803,000 were \$384,000 less than those of 1987, primarily due to 1988 price decreases, but were \$270,600 greater than budgeted due to greater unit sales than anticipated. Contributions were \$248,000 greater than those of 1987, but \$308,000 (7.3%) less than budgeted. This created a 1988 shortfall of contributions against G.S.O. service expenses of \$513,000 (exclusive of computer costs of \$541,000). By comparison, in 1987 there was a \$177,000 shortfall. Operating expenses exceeded budget in 1988 primarily due to shipping and mailing costs related to greater than budgeted sales and higher than anticipated legal fees. The operating net for 1988 was a loss of \$164,000 compared to a net operating income of \$1,339,000 in 1987 and a budgeted net income of \$274,000 in 1988.

The 1989 G.S.O. budget was approved without price reductions. Contributions are budgeted at an 8% increase over 1988, which had a 6.8% increase over 1987 versus the 15% which had been budgeted for 1988. Gross sales are budgeted to be 9.5% greater than those of 1988. Operating expenses are projected to be about 9.1% higher than those of 1988. Net income from operations, exclusive of non-recurring costs, is budgeted to be \$27,300. In view of this "nearly breakeven" budget, the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee will meet during Conference week to review a list of "discretionary" items in the 1989 budget. A report on the Self-Support Project is also scheduled.

Grapevine's total revenue of \$1,900,700 was \$267,000 higher than 1988, mainly due to sales of the new book *The Language of the Heart*. Circulation of the magazine was 3% higher than in 1987. Total expenses were \$57,300 over budget, but \$52,900 of this was attributable to the unbudgeted new book sales. Net income for the year, including interest, was \$212,000, which was \$211,200 over the 1988 budget. The 1989 Grapevine budget was approved. Income is projected at \$1,995,000. After expenses, which include an indexing project, net income after interest is budgeted at \$450.

The General Service Board Reserve Fund had a fund balance of \$7,203,300 yielding approximately 8% on book value, and represented 9.1 months of combined operating expenses (A.A.W.S. and Grapevine). A request for a \$500,000 transfer from the Reserve Fund to A.A.W.S. to restore working capital to an adequate level was approved. This was based on a report of a special subcommittee who reviewed the cash flow of 1988 and projected 1989 cash flow, including inventory additions and prepaid expenditures for the 1990 and 1995 International Conventions.

Thanks to the wisdom of those who came before us, the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee had the Reserve Fund as a backup while fairly dramatic shifts in revenue sourcing and increased dependence on group contributions were instituted in the interest of the Seventh Tradition. It was felt that while it is improper to "budget" a deficit we might expect some unusual cash flow patterns from these endeavors. Financial risks might ensue for a period of time until we get a handle on what the groups are prepared to pay for. The Reserve Fund was and is a comfort during this period.

The committee felt that in light of another very tight budget, a statement should be read at the beginning of each Conference Committee meeting, to increase awareness of the costs of recommended projects and subsequent impact on the budget.

We are ever mindful of the importance of the Traditions to the A.A. way and the consequences when they are ignored. We are responsible when anyone, anywhere reaches out for help – we want the hand of A.A. always to be there.

Robert P. Morse, treasurer

Trustees' report: In-depth reports were presented by the following board committees: Archives, Conference, Finance, International Convention/Regional Forums, Treatment Facilities and the GV Corporate Board. The reports encompassed the scope of the committees and highlighted their history. In addition to detailed accounts of activities and projects in progress, areas of concern were addressed, along with plans for the future.

The three General Sharing Sessions since the last Conference also discussed issues of specific interest to the board and the Fellowship. In July, the topic for discussion was "Whatever Happened to Anonymity?" G.S.O.'s archivist gave a brief history on how anonymity originated. A general service trustee reported on the subcommittee that was formed to explore methods of raising the Fellowship's consciousness of anonymity. Conclusions to date were: a) we cannot approach the Fellowship from a position of righteousness; b) we find humorous approaches get most attention; c) shared experiences are more powerful; and d) to raise consciousness, learn to apply a basic Tradition to a changing society. Following discussion, it was pointed out that we cannot enforce spiritual principles. In summary, the chairperson concluded that all this collective experience has taught us that anonymity is real humility at work – we are sure this humility is the greatest safeguard that A.A. could ever have.

In October, the topic was: "The Committee System – Do We Trust It?" Three presenters covered Roberts' Rules of Order in describing A.A.'s committee system and its unique qualities; how A.A.'s committee system works through trustees' and delegates' committees; and how the committee system can be improved. One trustee summarized by saying, "Sometimes the committee system breaks down when delegates are bypassed. . . . It is time for everyone in A.A. to look at the wonderful A.A. program we have. . . . We need to slow down and look at where we are going."

The most recent General Sharing Session (January 1989) addressed the topic of the trustees' trip to Russia. The chairperson of the International Committee said the primary objective of the trip was to share with professionals, government officials and alcoholics in the U.S.S.R. what A.A. is. The speaker felt that they accomplished their mission and that we could assist A.A. groups in the U.S.S.R. by providing them with A.A. literature in Russian. One of the many highlights of their experience was meeting sober members in three A.A. groups. On the whole, the chairperson said he felt A.A. was off to a good start in the U.S.S.R. and reiterated that other countries (Finland) were helping in this effort. The trip was a highly emotional and spiritual experience for all.

The last item on the January agenda was to discuss topics for future General Sharing Sessions. Anyone with suggestions for topics should submit them in writing to the General Service Office, c/o staff coordinator.

John Hartley Smith, M.D., chairperson

*We are responsible when
anyone, anywhere reaches
out for help—we want the hand
of A.A. always to be there.*

GROUP SERVICES COORDINATOR

Staff report: The primary responsibility of the group services coordinator is to provide communication services to the Fellowship as a whole, overseeing the production of service material, which includes the 15 A.A. Guidelines, new Group Handbooks (English, Spanish, and French), self-support materials, and G.S.R. kits.

G.S.O. continues to work toward providing identical services to all A.A. groups within the U.S./Canada service structure in the three major languages of our North American structure. G.S.O. lists approximately 1,600 French- and 700 Spanish-speaking groups.

The storehouse of service material items is available to A.A.s upon request. This material differs from Conference-approved literature in that it has not come about through Conference Advisory Actions. Rather, service material reflects A.A. group experience and specific and timely information that is subject to change.

The group services coordinator also has oversight responsibility for the production of the five A.A. directories; serves on the A.A. World Services Self-Support Committee; acts as a liaison for central offices/intergroups, and organizes the central office/inter-group seminars (1988 marked the third such seminar).

Eileen Gatzka

INTERNATIONAL / WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee: The International Committee is the focal point for information about A.A. around the world. It develops ways to help A.A. growth in countries where A.A. is just getting started.

U.S.S.R.—This year we went one step farther than usual to offer the hand of A.A. abroad. From April 26 to May 8, 1988 two committee members and our staff secretary traveled with eight members of the professional community from the Soviet Union as they visited alcoholism facilities in the United States. The Soviet visit was the American portion of the American-Soviet Exchange on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism Prevention and Treatment, which was coordinated by the National Council of World Affairs Organizations and the Soviet All-Union Temperance Promotion Society. During the visit, the Soviets were hosted by the General Service Board for a day, where they heard presentations on A.A. and attended an A.A. meeting in the community. On the final day of the visit when the Soviets and Americans who had participated in the exchange met to explore future topics the Soviet's list of subjects was topped by "more understanding of A.A. principles." From November 9 through 25, as a continuation of the exchange (this time independent of the initial coordinators), three International Committee members and its staff secretary, visited the U.S.S.R. It was a C.P.C. trip which took us to Tallinn, Estonia, Leningrad and Moscow. All of the alcoholism professionals we met on the trip were familiar with A.A., and knew something of our Steps and Traditions. We didn't meet anyone who was unreceptive to the A.A. program in total or at least in part. Several professionals told us that God, or the religious overtones of our program would be a deterrent to A.A. there, a concern apparently not shared by individual Soviet alcoholics. We learned that a psychiatrist in Estonia and a doctor in Leningrad were translating some of our literature, one of whom asked for our publishing rights. Another professional in Moscow said

he was planning to ask for our publishing rights as well. Of course we made no commitments. All three were adapting or condensing the material. Upon our return, we reported to A.A. World Services, Inc. Board the great need for our literature in Russian and recommended that A.A.W.S. translate into Russian and publish *Living Sober* and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*. A major highlight of the trip was when we attended the Moscow Beginners Group. There were about 20 present (we had an interpreter). The meeting was opened by the chairman with the A.A. Preamble. This was followed by other members reading the Steps and Traditions. Then there was a brief qualification followed by what we perceived as open and heartfelt sharing from around the table. There appeared to be no difficulty with any portion of the program. The meeting was closed with the Serenity Prayer, followed by tea, cake and fellowship. The questions members asked us after the meeting centered on sponsorship, anonymity and self-support. And at another time when we were with the members, they presented us with a beautiful china tea pot inscribed "To General Wourld Service of A.A." 20/XI/1988, and a World Service plaque which read:

Dear Friends!

With all our heart we greet you, the representatives of A.A. General Service Office on the hospitable Moscow land!

More than a year has passed since that time when you registered our group Moscow Beginners – the first group of A.A. in the Soviet Union. It is very pleasant today to thank our dear friends: J.W.C. and Julia S., who helped us a lot in formation and strengthening of Moscow Beginners. The name of our group is symbolic. There are newly sober people in the group and those who is carryings the noble message of recovering from the first steps of A.A. in the Soviet Union.

We can solver our common problem together!

One day at a time – to sober life!

Moscow Group of A.A.
20.XI.1988

Poland—At the invitation of the National Service Board in Poland, an International Committee member and its committee secretary attended the Third General Service Conference July 1-3, 1988 in Poland. There are about 230 groups there. Their Conference body consisted of seven members of their board and 145 voting delegates. (Their delegates in our structure would be called general service representatives). One of the major discussions of the conference was how it could manage its business affairs, such as finances and publishing, within Polish law.

Tenth World Service Meeting—Another major event was the Tenth World Service Meeting held October 23-27, 1988 in New York City. It was the largest meeting held to date, with 24 countries represented by 39 delegates. Poland participated for the first time. The theme was "A.A. and Its Responsibilities." The two trustees-at-large, Webb Johnson and Don Pritts, represented U.S./Canada at the meeting.

Translating Overseas Literature—In view of the possibility that A.A. World Services, Inc. may begin to translate and publish foreign literature on a limited basis, the International Committee has discontinued its project to translate and publish foreign language pamphlets that are needed for special groups within the U.S./Canada service structure.

Don I. Pritts, chairperson

Staff report:

Overseas—Correspondence from groups and individual A.A.s in countries without a service center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment. When correspondence comes to us in a foreign language, it is translated and a response sent in the same language. Additionally, the staff member on this assignment corresponds with 36 G.S.O.s and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (French-speaking), Belgium (Flemish-speaking), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, Ecuador, El Salvador, Finland, France, Great Britain, Guatemala, Honduras, Iceland, India, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, Paraguay, Poland, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland (French-speaking), Switzerland (German-speaking), Trinidad/Tobago, Uruguay, Venezuela and West Germany.

When letters are received from groups and individuals in those countries, they are encouraged to correspond with their own G.S.O.s. If an overseas G.S.O. needs a more detailed sharing of experience, it contacts G.S.O., U.S./Canada. For non-English-speaking countries with their own G.S.O.s, we list English-speaking groups and contacts, intergroups/central offices, and Loners. Travelers are encouraged to contact those offices for up-to-date meeting information.

A.A. Literature Overseas—To protect A.A.'s message, careful consideration is given to granting overseas boards, centers, and literature committees, permission to print A.A. Conference-approved literature in the language of the country. A request to print should come from the board or representative A.A. committee and before any printing begins G.S.O. first explores how material will be financed and distributed. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to A.A.W.S. Board of Directors.

As of February 1989 the A.A. World Services, Inc. Board has revised its publishing policy to include the possibility of undertaking translating and printing foreign language literature needed overseas. This will apply to countries where there is no G.S.O., or no G.S.O. that publishes in the country's language. Each proposal for translation will be considered on an individual basis by A.A. World Services, Inc. The first effort is the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in Russian.

World Service Meeting—A major highlight of this assignment is planning and coordinating the World Service Meeting which meets biennially in the United States and overseas. The Tenth World Service Meeting was held October 23-27, 1988, in New York City. It was the largest meeting to date, with 24 countries represented by 39 delegates. The theme was "A.A. and Its Responsibilities." To more fully understand this week of sharing, a final report of the meeting is available at G.S.O.

Interim Zonal Meetings—The European and Ibero-American Service Meetings, held biennially, alternate with World Service Meetings. Their primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. They sponsor countries without service structures into service and contribute to the growth of A.A. worldwide. The Pacific Basin countries are currently considering holding interim meetings too.

Travel to Eastern Bloc Countries—This year the staff secretary accompanied members of the General Service Board to the U.S.S.R. and Poland. (See trustees' International Committee report). On the way to Poland the secretary stopped in Prague, Czechoslovakia to visit a Loner who wrote to G.S.O. saying it was difficult to stay sober on his own. The Loner, sober for two years, was most anxious to "officially" start A.A. in his country. He

thought this might be possible if General Service Board members met informally with Czech medical people to explain what A.A. is and is not. We contacted G.S.O. West Germany and their general manager has since visited the Loner, met with several Czech physicians and invited four physicians and the Loner to attend their April 1989 A.A. convention in Hannover. The Czech physicians will meet with German doctors and visit treatment centers in Hannover. A.A. World Services, Inc. plans to send the Czechoslovakian manuscript of the Big Book, currently being edited, to West Germany for the physicians.

Sarah Price

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION / A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—This report was given as a presentation (see presentation section).

Regional Forums—It is fitting that this particular report on Regional Forums pays tribute to Dr. Jack Norris, Class A chairman of the board emeritus, who died on January 13 last. It was his ideas and energies that in 1975 prompted the beginning of Regional Forums. Dr. Jack recognized the need for continuing dialogue between the General Service Board and the A.A. members in all regions. To date, there have been over fifty-five Regional Forums, four within the past year, and communication and sharing are abundant. Regional Forums foster wider understanding and receptivity to the service functions of our Fellowship. They help achieve the present and future goals of A.A.

During the year, the trustees' committee reviews and provides input on planning these Forums. Responses from a large number of Forum-goers indicate they have benefitted greatly from these weekends of improved communication and service sharing. Attendance at the past year's Forums ranged from 292 at the Southeast Forum in Florida to 596 at the Eastern Canada Forum in the Province of Quebec. Approximately two-thirds of the participants at each Forum were first-time attendees. Workshops and presentations on "Anonymity," "Carrying the Message to Minorities," and "Self-Support" generated lively and appreciative responses, and the highlights produced in the Regional Forum Reports continue to be well received.

Box 4-5-9 keeps the Fellowship informed regarding upcoming Regional Forums. The schedule for 1989 and 1990 is as follows:

1989		
May 12-14	East Central	Ann Arbor, MI
June 2-4	Northeast	Portland, ME
August 4-6	West Central	Billings, MT
December 1-3	Southwest	Wichita, KS
1990		
August 17-19	Pacific	San Diego, CA
September 28-30	Western Canada	Winnipeg, Man.
	Eastern Canada	Western Ont.
December 7-9	Southeast	Shreveport, LA

Joe Phelan, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Convention—A.A.'s 55th Anniversary International Convention will be celebrated in Seattle from Thursday, July 5, through Sunday, July 8, 1990. The four A.A. committees working on the Convention are: Trustees', Conference, Host and G.S.O. Planning. The staff secretary coordinates and serves as secretary to these four committees. He is also the liaison to the Al-Anon Planning Committee. The major events – the Flag Ceremony and the Big Meeting (Friday night), the professional entertainment (Saturday night), and the Spiritual Meeting (Sunday morning) – will be held at the King County Stadium ("Kingdome"), which is a free Metro ride from the Seattle Center and the Washington State Convention and Trade Center. All Convention facilities are convenient to all major downtown hotels. The Seattle Center is where we will hold registration as well as the majority of the panels and workshops; the Center has three floors of ethnic and fast food concessions. There will be opening dances (Thursday night) throughout the downtown Seattle area. Alkathons and some special meetings will be held at the hotels. Registration forms for the Convention will be mailed to all groups around the world in September 1989, and will contain a list of hotels and motels, prices and a map of locations. Rooms will be made available on a first-come, first-served basis.

Our members coming from all over the world will find getting to Seattle easy. The Seattle-Tacoma International Airport ("Sea-Tac") has service from twenty-five major domestic and international carriers. Convenient rail and bus connections can also be made to Seattle. We are looking forward to celebrating A.A.'s Ninth International Convention with A.A. members from more than 40 countries.

Curtis Monahan

Regional Forums—The responsibilities of this assignment involve coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for Regional Forums. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. service workers, the General Service, A.A. World Services, and Grapevine Boards as well as the General Service Office. Regional Forums are held at the invitation of a particular region every two years – thus, usually four Regional Forums take place annually.

Working in conjunction with the regional trustee, area delegates, and host city liaison person, the Regional Forum coordinator is in contact with a region's delegates, requesting agenda topics and suggestions, and produces and mails invitations to G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area committee officers, central offices and intergroups, past delegates and past trustees. The staff member prepares the agenda for the Forum weekend, following through with our hotel requirements at each stage of planning, to ensure that myriad details are handled. She or he is also responsible for providing literature displays at each Forum. Following a Forum, highlights of the weekend's sharing are produced by the coordinator, and sent to all registrants.

General Service Board personnel attendees usually include the chair of the board, trustees (from among nonalcoholic, regional, general service and trustees-at-large), directors of A.A. World Services, and Grapevine Corporate Boards and staff members. Work for a Regional Forum begins at least one year in advance, and great care is taken to ensure that each Forum creates an environment and program conducive to lively sharing in a comfortable setting.

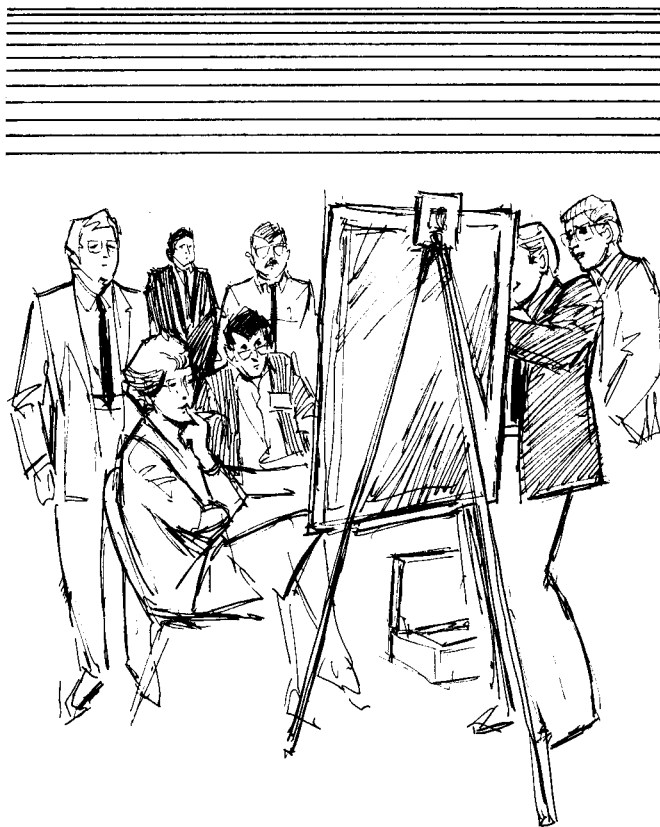
Eileen Gatzka

LITERATURE

Trustees committee: Projects Completed—As a result of General Service Conference approval, the following items have become available: "The A.A. Group" revised; "A.A. for the Native North American"; "Your D.C.M."; copy of the structure of an A.A. group has been prepared as service material; the article in the April/May 1988 issue of *Bar* 4-5-9 entitled "Service Sponsorship: A Vital Stepping Stone to Service and Sobriety" has been prepared as service material.

The following will be available when current inventory is depleted: "A.A. and the Armed Services" revised; "Young People and A.A." revised.

Projects in Progress—(1) A.A. History Book: This project is now on two tracks. The area histories are being separated from the project and the Conference Archives Committee will receive the material. The Conference Literature Committee will be asked to consider how the area histories can best be utilized. Four writers with experience in developing histories were asked to submit an outline of how they would treat an A.A. history in addition to submitting two sample chapters on subjects of their choosing related to A.A. history. (2) Daily Reflections Book: Because of an insufficient number of manuscripts suitable for publication, the deadline for receiving manuscripts was extended to April 1. More appeals were made to the Fellowship through a mailing to area delegates, intergroups/central offices, World Service Meeting delegates, overseas G.S.O.s and announcements in the March issue of the Grapevine and February/March issue of *Bar* 4-5-9. (3) Twelve Steps pamphlet: An illustrated, easy-to-read literature piece for people with limited reading skills.



Projects Forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee—"Is A.A. For Me?" an easy-to-read, illustrated version of "Is A.A. For You?" for people with limited reading skills; "The A.A. Group," a proposal for a thorough revision of the pamphlet; manuscript for a pamphlet for gay/lesbian alcoholics; Big Book formats - the Conference Literature Committee will be asked to consider the feasibility of making the message of the Big Book more available through formats such as large print editions for visually impaired, an easy-to-read version, pocket-size edition, etc.; consider developing a pamphlet for the "non-believer" or some sort of spiritual literature in response to requests from atheists and agnostics.

John E. King, chairperson

Staff report: The literature coordinator works closely with editors on updating and revising all recovery pamphlets, and with writers, illustrators, and editors on preparing new recovery pamphlets, books, displays and audiovisuals in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Production of this material is under the auspices of G.S.O.'s Publications Division. Correspondence from A.A. groups and individuals requesting specific information about literature comes to the literature desk. A letter is sent semi-annually to all central offices, intergroups, literature chairpersons, and literature distribution centers to inform them of new developments in A.A. literature and other service material.

In addition, the literature coordinator serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*, our bimonthly newsletter. The circulation of *Box 4-5-9* is: English 82,439; French 3,979; Spanish 13,221.

Every A.A. group registered with G.S.O. receives a complimentary copy of the newsletter. Copies are also sent, at no charge, to overseas General Service Offices, intergroups and literature distribution centers. The total figures include paid individual and bulk subscriptions.

Lois Fisher

LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

Staff report: The following excerpt from the letter of a member of the *Loners/Internationalists Meeting* by mail correspondence service provides a typical example of the comments we receive:

"Recently, I had the opportunity to attend two A.A. meetings while my ship was in dry-dock in Yokohama, Japan. Being a Seagoing A.A., I have to rely on my Loners' program, literature and tapes most of the time."

As the name implies, Loners are A.A.s who are unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. There are now about 550 Loners in 90 countries, including the United States and Canada. Seagoing A.A.s are known as Internationalists and their number continues to grow. There are now about 550 Internationalists and 60 Port Contacts; 60 Internationalists Groups meet aboard ships or in ports. Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability. We now have 150 Homers in the Loners/Internationalists Group. Loners, Homers, and Internationalists stay sober by reading A.A. literature and sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters and tapes.

A literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer, or Internationalist. Each of them also receive directories of Loners, Homers, and Internationalists. Additionally, they receive com-

plimentary subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners/Internationalists Meeting (LIM)*, which is a bimonthly discussion meeting in print which shares excerpts of letters received at the General Service Office from LIM members.

A growing number of A.A.s serve as Loner Sponsors, sharing group activities and personal experience with the Loners, Homers and Internationalists. With approximately 3,500 A.A.s (including the Loner Sponsors) participating in the *Loners/Internationalists Meeting* by mail, we might call it the largest A.A. group in the world. A.A.'s phenomenal worldwide growth can be attributed largely to Loners in distant lands and Internationalists sailing the Seven Seas who carry the A.A. message wherever they may be.

Curtis Monahan

NOMINATING

Trustees' committee: The committee reviewed and approved for mailing in August the letter, procedures, and resumé forms for election of candidates for regional trustees of East Central and Southeast U.S. Regions and for trustee-at-large/U.S. The committee also reviewed and approved, as eligible for election, the candidates for East Central and Southeast U.S. regional trustees and trustee-at-large/U.S.

The committee recommended the following to the General Service Board: (1) that John Nelson Chappel, M.D. serve as Class A trustee, replacing William E. Flynn, M.D.; and (2) that the General Service Board consider Wayne Parks as a replacement for John Bragg when he retires as general manager of the General Service Office. In addition, the committee recommended that the Conference Committee on Trustees review the report on the role of the trustee-at-large.

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 1989 General Service Conference for their disapproval, if any:

Class A

Michael Alexander	Robert P. Morse
John Nelson Chappel, M.D.	Amos E. Reed
Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.	John H. Smith, M.D.
John E. King	

Class B

Donald J. Bruner	W.F. (Webb) Johnson
Phil J. Cels	Stanley Silverman
William H. Croke	John A. Sharkey
Harold Greene	Desmond Towey
Thomas G. Hills	Jan Kelly Williamson
Ruth C. Jagodzinski	

(To be selected 4/26/89)

Two regional trustees - Southeast U.S. and East Central U.S.
One trustee-at-large/U.S.

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

Chairperson	Michael Alexander
First vice-chairperson	Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.
Second vice-chairperson	John E. King
Secretary	Ruth C. Jagodzinski
Treasurer	Robert P. Morse
Assistant Treasurer	Edward H. Gordon
Assistant Secretary	Susan Ulseth ¹

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., to be presented to the 1989 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

John Bragg ²	Michael J. McPherson
Phil J. Cels	Jean Smith
William Croke	Susan Ulseth ¹
Hugh Freyer	Jan Kelly Williamson
Harold Greene	

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to be presented to the 1989 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Bernard C. Benziger	Jane Murphy Schulberg
Donald J. Bruner	Stanley Silverman
Thomas G. Hills	Ames Sweet
John E. King	Desmond Towey
Fran Polek	Ann Warner

Shepherd Raimi, chairperson

¹ To be replaced at rotation, September 1989

² To be replaced July 1, 1989 by Wayne Parks

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with helping the membership carry the message through the media to the alcoholic who still suffers. We try to create a better understanding of A.A. among the general public and equally as important, we try to prevent misinformation. We try to maintain some awareness of the composition and growth of A.A. as a whole, and among specific groups such as young people and women. This is done through our triennial membership survey, which plays an important role in helping us formulate P.I. communications. We create and produce films as well as radio and TV announcements. We write press releases and press feature stories. We maintain the Public Information Workbook and help produce the P.I. section in *Box 4-5-9*. Specifically, in the past year, the committee:

- Completed new radio public service announcements for approval by the 1989 Conference.
- Appointed a subcommittee to elevate the Fellowship's consciousness of anonymity. This committee has (1) completed a service piece on the history of anonymity which will be distributed at the 1989 Conference; (2) sent a questionnaire on anonymity to D.C.M.s and delegates to determine the Fellowship's current attitudes on the subject; and (3) developed articles in *Box 4-5-9* on the subject.
- Approved production of A.A.'s television public service announcements on one-inch videotape.
- Developed material for convention P.I. chairpeople.

The committee hears reports of P.I. activities in the areas through staff reports and the input of regional trustees. We applaud the work the areas are doing and we will continue to assist with effective media materials.

John R. Whitehouse, chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Public Information assignment is to help to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic and potential alcoholic through the media. The staff member and his/her staff assistant respond to an average of 12,500 written and telephoned inquiries that come in annually from the general public and the Fellowship. The staff member is also responsible for handling interviews with the media describing what A.A. is and what we can and cannot do, and providing accurate information. A partial list of interviews includes those by *The New York Times*, *The Washington Post*, ABC television news, and *U.S.A. Today*.

During the past year, literature has been provided for approximately 300 health and community fairs. We also read and processed 15,000 newspaper, magazine and television feature stories; wrote approximately six letters of gratitude each month to publications printing accurate articles about our Fellowship; followed up on a monthly average of three to five anonymity breaks; and sent a letter of thanks to all 2,000 local P.I. contacts.

New public information chairpersons are automatically sent the Public Information Workbook, and all P.I. committee members and contacts receive *Box 4-5-9*, as well as any new public service materials. (Additional Public Information Workbooks are available for \$5.46.) Discount packages are also made available to public information committees at \$15.60 and \$54.60, respectively. (Local committees may also order half-quantities of each package.)

The existing and most recent radio and television public service announcements and our films "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View" and "Young People and A.A." have been widely aired by major networks and local television and radio stations. Requests for help in planning programs including references to Alcoholics Anonymous have also abounded. We have ongoing contact with major networks as well as the PBS and cable channels. We are working with the trustees' P.I. Committee on production of new radio PSAs which will be available before the year is out. The 1989 Membership Survey Questionnaires will be sent out to area delegates in July of this year.

G.S.O. services are backed up in a large measure by the tremendous dedication of more than 800 local public information committees and about 900 P.I. contacts, as we strive to reach out to the alcoholic who still suffers.

Betty Liddle



SPANISH SERVICES COORDINATOR

Staff report: In our general service structure there are approximately 20,000 Spanish-speaking A.A. members who don't speak English. They meet in 747 Hispanic groups in the United States and Canada. The Spanish services coordinator, who does not rotate, coordinates and revises Spanish translations of material from the other ten staff assignments and assists other staff members in providing services to the Hispanic community that are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish has a section entitled Spanish Services that gives information on general service activities. Each of those groups receives *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving and the groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been added recently to the areas in our service structure. Service material is translated into Spanish and updated. More and more Conference-approved literature is published in Spanish by our publications department. Spanish services helps answer the correspondence received in Spanish by most other assignments.

The staff member on this assignment represents G.S.O. at the Ibero-American Commission for Translation and Adaptation of A.A. Literature. In addition, the Spanish services coordinator attends conventions, Hispanic intergroup meetings, Regional Forums, World Service Meetings and International A.A. Conventions. The Spanish services coordinator greets G.S.O.'s Spanish-speaking visitors.

Vicente Mejía



STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services provided by G.S.O. to A.A. groups and members are divided at present into 11 staff assignments. In addition to assuming a functional responsibility such as Public Information, Regional Forums, or Literature, most staff members correspond with groups and members in a specific region of the U.S. and Canada, or with A.A.s in overseas countries where there is no national G.S.O. Staff members rotate assignments every two years. Staff assignments are monitored by the staff coordinator. Currently, the work is apportioned as follows:

Conference: Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; Early Bird *Box 4-5-9*; *Final Conference Report*.

Cooperation With the Professional Community: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; *About A.A.*; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant on C.P.C. page); coordinator, Native North American Initiative.

Correctional Facilities: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant on Correctional Facilities page).

Group Services Coordinator/Regional Forums: Supervision of service material, Guidelines, and A.A. directories; secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee; coordinator, Self-Support Committee; liaison with intergroups/central offices and coordinator of Intergroup/Central Office Seminars.

Literature Coordinator: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees; preparation of new recovery pamphlets, books, and audiovisual materials; updating of recovery pamphlets and books; editor, *Box 4-5-9*; assistant coordinator, 1990 International Convention.

Loners, Internationalists: *Loners-Internationalists Meeting*; secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees; coordinator 1990 International Convention.

Overseas, World Service Meeting: Secretary, trustees' International Committee; secretary, Tenth World Service Meeting; *World Service Meeting Report*.

Public Information: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for P.I. page).

Spanish Services: Consultant on any committee providing services to the Hispanic community; Spanish language correspondence; editor, Spanish *Box 4-5-9*; consultant Tenth World Service Meeting.

Treatment Facilities: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for Treatment Facilities page).

The staff work is divided in three units so that G.S.O. mail is processed and responded to expeditiously. Unit A consists of P.I., C.P.C., C.F., and T.F. Unit B includes coordinators of staff, Conference, Literature and Group Services. Unit C includes Overseas, World Service Meeting, Loners/Internationalists and Spanish Services.

During 1988, the G.S.O. staff handled almost 24,000 pieces of mail. The staff coordinator ensures that mail is answered during vacations, sickness, or a staff member's involvement with a special project. Training new staff members is another segment of the staff coordinator's service assignment. In 1988, two new

staff members joined the General Service Office. When there is a staff opening, a letter is sent out to the trustees and directors announcing the opening and briefly describing the requirements for the job. The information is also posted in Box 4-5-9. Six years of sobriety is a requirement for a G.S.O. staff member. Business experience, good communication skills, A.A. service experience and geographic considerations are some of the criteria used in the selection process.

Weekly staff meetings are scheduled to provide a forum for discussion of problems that require direction from the group conscience. From time to time, a service meeting is scheduled to give the staff an opportunity to become better informed about a particular assignment. The purpose of all staff meetings is to seek more and better ways of providing the most useful services to A.A. groups and members.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff vacations and scheduled trips in order to ensure that the office is covered at all times. She also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments as a member of the Office Policy and Procedures Committee.

In 1988, staff attended 73 conventions, assemblies, roundups and forums in the U.S. and Canada. This provides the staff with opportunities to become acquainted with A.A.s all over the U.S. and Canada, to communicate about G.S.O. services and, most important, to gain information on local activities that can be shared with other groups.

During the past year, approximately 1,166 visitors from all over the world visited G.S.O. Each visitor has the opportunity to tour the various G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. These visits create an opportunity to explain services to the Fellowship and learn about A.A. activities in each visitor's hometown or country. Often members and guests attend the weekly A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays, for staff and A.A. visitors.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, and preparing and distributing the minutes of the General Service Board meeting; she also serves as editor of the *Quarterly Report*, the newsletter account of the board's activities.

As secretary of the General Sharing Session during the board weekend, trustees, members of all board committees, G.S.O. and Grapevine directors, and G.S.O. staff members are encouraged to discuss a wide range of topics, including in-depth reports from trustees' committees, at a two-hour General Sharing Session.

The staff coordinator is a voting member of the General Service Conference and serves as secretary of the trustees' Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. In accordance with Concept IV, the staff coordinator is a director and vice-president of A.A. World Services, Inc.

Susan Ulseth

A Case of Mistaken Residence

When the host committee took delegate spouses and significant others to Brooklyn to see Bill and Lois's house on Clinton St., they passed staff member Betty Liddle's apartment building. The tour guide at the head of the line commented that Betty lived in that building; a few people back someone took a picture and, by the end of the line, visiting spouses were all taking pictures of what they thought was Bill W.'s home.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: We selected Crommie & Crommie (filmmakers) to produce three minutes of sample film footage targeted for treatment facilities. A subcommittee was appointed to discuss the content of the film. They suggested that the film follow the guidelines set down by the 1988 General Service Conference, which entailed (1) what A.A. is and is not; (2) anonymity; (3) Traditions; (4) Steps; (5) meeting types; (6) sponsorship; and (7) home groups. The committee also suggested that singleness of purpose be the major thrust of the film. The filmmakers completed three minutes of sample footage, which was viewed by the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee. The committee recommended that with minor edits the film be submitted to the 1989 General Service Conference for approval. If approved by the Conference, a fifteen-minute film will be produced and submitted to the 1990 General Service Conference.

The committee produced a Treatment Facilities Newsletter, targeted for A.A. members who carry our message into treatment facilities. This newsletter will print shared experience from the Fellowship on issues regarding treatment facilities. Some of these include: influx of large numbers of patients to A.A. groups; nonalcoholic patients at A.A. meetings; behavior of mandated patients at A.A. meetings; temporary contact program; anonymity; singleness of purpose.

The committee added delegates, alternate delegates and district committee members to the mailing list. The newsletter will be produced quarterly (when possible) and to date three have been issued.

Jim Shannon, chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to carry the A.A. message to the suffering alcoholic in treatment facilities. Staff activities include being secretary to both trustees' and Conference Committees and responding to mail from these committees as well as from all treatment facilities and treatment facilities chairpersons throughout the U.S. and Canada. There are 271 treatment facilities committees and 296 institutions committees.

Highlights of the past year are as follows:

- After approval by the 1988 General Service Conference a three-minute sample film for treatment facilities was produced. The sample (which was viewed by the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities in January 1989) depicts A.A.'s singleness of purpose and will serve as an adjunct to A.A. members who carry the message into treatment facilities. The film will also inform treatment facility personnel what A.A. is and is not.

- The "Temporary Contacts" service piece which was added to the *Treatment Facilities Workbook* has had favorable results in getting discharged patients to their first A.A. meeting.

This assignment continues to gather information for articles in the treatment facilities section of Box 4-5-9 and the Treatment Facilities Newsletter. The mail from members of our Fellowship continues to reflect concern about nonalcoholics attending meetings and the overloading of A.A. groups by the influx of patients from treatment facilities and court programs.

John Grant

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: Since the 1988 Conference, the Grapevine Corporate Board has been consolidating the preceding year's progress and building on the solid foundation that the Conference and the service structure as a whole have helped us to build. We believe that the magazine has become increasingly responsive to the Fellowship and the rising circulation curve would seem to validate that perception. The board and the staff have worked hard to make magazine fulfillment and other mailing services fully efficient and effective, and given the decreasing number of problem letters, we believe that goal, too, is well on the way to full realization.

Circulation for the past year has been moving steadily upward. Starting at the beginning of 1988 at about 121,000, it reached 128,450 by the December issue and as of the March 1989 issue, it stands at about 131,500. Since the magazine is published twelve times a year, the A.A. message of recovery is being delivered through the Grapevine one million six hundred thousand times.

Editorial highlights of the year since the 1988 Conference include publication in October of *The Language of the Heart: Bill W.'s Grapevine Writings*. Advance orders for about 9,000 copies were in house when the book came off press, and by the end of 1988 total sales came to about 25,000 copies. The book is now in its second printing and orders are continuing to come in at a brisk pace.

The Grapevine representative network has grown apace; currently about 5,000 GvRs are listed, there is greater activity at the district level and almost all delegate areas now have standing committees on the Grapevine. The *A.A. Grapevine Workbook* has been revised and reprinted, and in response to requests, the "Traditions Checklist" (a collection of the checklists that appeared in the magazine throughout 1987) has been published as a separate item.

Year-end results for 1988 showed a profit (after interest earned) of \$212,000, about \$170,000 of which can be attributed to sales of *The Language of the Heart*. Without that income, the bottom line would have been around \$40,000 or \$50,000.

The budget for 1989, approved at the board's January 1989 meeting, projects a break-even year (\$450 profit), based on sales of about 40,000 *The Language of the Heart* and an average circulation of 127,000-128,000. Two components of the budget should be particularly noted: 1) Anticipating another profitable year, we have put some of the expected income back into the magazine, to give readers more for their subscription dollar.

There will be two expanded issues, in June (Grapevine anniversary) and September or October (featuring young people in A.A.), and also a few additional four-color covers. 2) A new item is a comprehensive Index of the magazine, from the first issue through 1989, and part of the cost is included in the 1989 budget. This project, to be completed within two years, will make the contents of back issues more readily available to Grapevine readers and all A.A. members, as well as outside researchers.

Following are other significant items and actions. The Grapevine Board:

- Accepted the report and recommendations of the Hay Group regarding a salary policy and structure for The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and approved salary adjustments for Grapevine personnel based on that report.
- Approved the manuscript of staff-written introductory material for the book of Bill W.'s Grapevine writings, as specified in 1988 Conference Advisory Action #26.

- Implemented the one-time trial distribution of complimentary Grapevines to nonsubscribing groups, intended to increase awareness of the magazine as a recovery tool (1988 Conference Advisory Action #25).

- Reviewed the Grapevine copyright permissions policy, and adopted policies in regard to registered trademarks and the granting of permission for reproduction of Grapevine material in other media.

- Discussed at length the feasibility of early acknowledgment of new subscription orders (1988 Conference Advisory Action #29). This was implemented on an experimental basis with Christmas gift orders, and can be fully implemented when the new computer system is installed and working.

- Met three times as a planning committee in addition to the regular quarterly meetings of the board, and welcomed Conference Committee chairperson Leo Gregory to the December 9, 1988 meeting of the planning committee to ensure the best possible communication with this Conference.

- Accepted the resignation of Laurance Allen as Grapevine director.

- Forwarded to the trustees' Nominating Committee the names of two new director candidates, replacing Laurance Allen and Norman Adams.

- Forwarded to the trustees' Nominating Committee the name of Stanley Silverman as general service trustee nominee, replacing James Shannon.

- Approved and forwarded to the trustees' Finance Committee the budget for 1989.

- Transferred approximately \$150,000 to the General Service Board Reserve Fund. These funds go toward meeting the Grapevine's unfulfilled subscription liability.

A decisive factor in the positive steps that the Grapevine has taken over the past two years has been regular two-way communication between the board and staff and the delegates to this Conference. Those positive steps have led to some fairly impressive financial results, and in the spirit of full communication, I want to end this report with a few reflections on the implications of our present comfortable position.

At the January board meeting, we heard a controller's report on the long-range solvency of the Grapevine, in which we were advised that without sales of *The Language of the Heart*, it would have been necessary by now to consider an increase in the price of the magazine. As a board, we feel no discomfort with the fact that the book is helping to pay the way at this point, because like several of the other special items, the book is simply an extension of the magazine into a different medium. But we are aware that if the magazine itself is to be self-supporting at the current price level, circulation needs to be increased significantly.

We believe that both the magazine and the Grapevine operation as a whole have become more effective and efficient in meeting the needs of the Fellowship, and we need you to keep us attuned to those needs in the years to come. It is our goal to maintain a rising circulation curve by continuing to improve the quality of the magazine and its ability to respond to A.A. as a whole. We will be able to do that as long as we continue to receive your wholehearted help and counsel. What are your thoughts about the Grapevine? What are the needs of A.A.s in your areas? How can the message of A.A. be carried most effectively through our international monthly journal of experience and opinion?

J. Desmond Towey, chairperson

Staff report: The Grapevine office has been running smoothly since last year's Conference, with only a few minor bumps and scratches to keep us on our toes. The management team has been working together creatively and productively, and supporting personnel continue to turn in a dedicated, high-quality performance for the Fellowship. We are happy to report that the problems of the office are for the most part the problems of success.

As the new management structure has shaken down over time, it has become clear that the job of controller/business administrator is overloaded – especially with the changes on the horizon as a result of the new computer system. Thus, with board approval, we are seeking a person to fill the newly created job of accountant/assistant controller, with the aim of freeing more of Don Meurer's time for administration and implementation of the new technology. The position of office manager, created a year ago and filled by corporate secretary Naomi Strassberg, has localized the responsibility for providing internal office services and made them run far more smoothly.

The growth of the GvR program, which for the past year has been under the overall supervision of managing editor Ames Sweet, has made it necessary to redefine the responsibility of the GvR coordinator, and this is now a full-time rather than a part-time job. The recently revised *A.A. Grapevine Workbook* continues to be in demand, as is the new "Traditions Checklist" pamphlet, which seems to be filling a real need in many groups, districts and areas.

With the Bill W. book project completed, the editorial staff can concentrate even more of their energy on magazine planning, and with two expanded issues coming up in the next year, there is a good deal of planning to do. The volume of contributed manuscripts has increased significantly, especially with the "Is A.A. Changing?" emphasis, which has clearly touched some nerves throughout the Fellowship. The Grapevine Editorial Board, too, is working harder, and voted to meet nine times a year instead of its former six bimonthly meetings, in order to be the most effective possible resource for the staff.

There is more work for the circulation department, also – as more and more people read and subscribe to the magazine, our data entry people have been busy ensuring that subscription orders are entered in a timely fashion and any problems that might occur are solved promptly. When the new computer system is fully installed, a number of improved procedures that have been only a gleam in the circulation supervisor's eye can be implemented, and we look forward to having expanded computer capability in order to give increasingly high-quality service to A.A.s who read the Grapevine.

A long-wished for, long-term project, preparation of a comprehensive Grapevine Index from the first issue through the present, is now in the beginning stages and should be completed within the next two years. The editorial staff regularly receives requests – readers, researchers and organizers of service workshops – for material from out-of-print issues of the magazine and many must go unanswered because the existing Index is not adequate. This fact greatly lessens the effectiveness of the magazine as a source of A.A. experience and opinion, so we are pleased to be getting the new Index underway and look forward to being able to provide this service in the future.

Ann Warner, executive editor

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION – GEOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 1988	APRIL 1989	
UNITED STATES			
Alabama	1,211	1,461	250
Alaska	473	518	45
Arizona	1,445	1,531	86
Arkansas	741	781	40
California	13,203	13,600	397
Colorado	1,505	1,590	85
Connecticut	2,085	2,201	116
Delaware	383	392	9
District of Columbia	338	311	- 27
Florida	6,230	6,064	- 166
Georgia	2,470	2,932	462
Hawaii	374	411	37
Idaho	628	687	59
Illinois	5,217	5,556	339
Indiana	1,730	1,808	78
Iowa	1,584	1,692	108
Kansas	1,551	1,730	179
Kentucky	1,167	1,038	- 129
Louisiana	1,317	1,264	- 53
Maine	793	841	48
Maryland	2,080	2,098	18
Massachusetts	4,760	5,665	905
Michigan	3,393	3,528	135
Minnesota	3,934	3,886	- 48
Mississippi	771	766	- 5
Missouri	2,038	2,103	65
Montana	772	809	37
Nebraska	1,647	1,788	141
Nevada	598	613	15
New Hampshire	782	823	41
New Jersey	3,550	3,972	422
New Mexico	654	680	26
New York	7,860	8,584	724
North Carolina	3,166	3,386	220
North Dakota	649	648	- 1
Ohio	3,527	3,663	136
Oklahoma	1,708	1,674	- 34
Oregon	1,102	1,179	77
Pennsylvania	3,806	4,435	629
Rhode Island	745	670	- 75
South Carolina	1,691	1,694	3
South Dakota	673	661	- 12
Tennessee	1,473	1,671	198
Texas	5,242	5,366	124
Utah	380	408	28
Vermont	522	506	- 16
Virginia	3,154	3,116	- 38
Washington	2,955	3,134	179
West Virginia	577	574	- 3
Wisconsin	2,675	2,828	153
Wyoming	368	421	53
Puerto Rico	125	116	- 9
U.S. Possessions	—	—	—
Total	111,822	117,873	6,051
CANADA			
Alberta	1,227	1,335	108
British Columbia/Yukon	1,360	1,527	167
Manitoba	576	615	39
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	423	514	91
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	638	776	138
Ontario	4,842	5,529	687
Quebec	360	360	0
Saskatchewan	852	881	29
Total	10,278	11,537	1,259
FOREIGN			
	1,264	1,400	136
Grand Total	123,364	130,810	7,446

Literature Distributed – 1988

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	729,305
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft-cover)	380,596
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	553,134
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	123,215
A.A. Comes of Age	29,616
As Bill Sees It	113,719
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	27,577
"Pass It On"	33,908
Total	1,991,070

Booklets

Living Sober	133,174
Came to Believe	271,369
Total	404,543

Pamphlets

A.A. and Occupational Programs	43,700
A.A. and the Armed Services	32,500
A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession	92,900
A.A. for the Woman	288,500
The A.A. Group	177,200
A.A. in Your Community	164,400
A.A. in Prisons	65,400
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	93,900
The A.A. Membership Survey	177,100
The A.A. Member – Medications and Other Drugs	263,500
The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service	40,000
A.A. Tradition – How It Developed	100,600
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	33,100
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	365,200
The Clergy Ask About A.A.	75,200
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	62,900
Do You Think You're Different?	292,700
44 Questions	565,400
G.S.R.	96,700
How A.A. Members Cooperate	51,000
How It Works	157,000
If You Are a Professional	119,300
Inside A.A.	128,700
Is A.A. For You?	708,700
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	239,600
It Happened to Alice	127,700
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	107,900
The Jack Alexander Article	99,900
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	39,100
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	199,400
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	208,500
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	98,400
A Newcomer Asks	480,400
Problems Other Than Alcohol	224,400
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	452,000
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	54,700
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	46,800
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	107,400
The Twelve Traditions of A.A.	8,200
This Is A.A.	701,900
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	59,500
Time to Start Living	147,100
Time to Start Living (large print)	18,800
Too Young?	265,400
Understanding Anonymity	168,700
What Happened to Joe	145,900
Young People and A.A.	371,100
Total	8,572,400

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards – two-fold	1,100,000
Wallet cards – I Am Responsible	158,000
Wallet cards – Anonymity	91,500
Parchment – scrolls	9,900
Placards	1,200
C.P.C. Workbook	1,100
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1,100
P.I. Workbook	1,500
Treatment Facilities Workbook	970
A.A. Guidelines	190,200
Group Handbook	6,600
Wire Racks	3,300
Cassettes	5,700
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	5,200
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	3,100
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	530
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	600
Twelve Steps Shade displays	3,000
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	2,600
Fact Files	4,200
Total	1,590,300
Grand total	12,558,313

SPANISH

Books

Alcohólicos Anónimos	22,000
Como Lo Ve Bill	5,300
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad	2,100
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (New)	800
Total	30,200

Booklets

Viviendo Sobrio	9,200
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial	1,800
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones	14,500
Llegamos a Creer	5,300
Total	30,800

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad	10,400
44 Preguntas	23,300
Esto es A.A.	34,400
¿Es A.A. para Usted?	55,000
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica	8,200
¿Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (new)	7,100
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser un Alcohólico	6,700
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A.	6,600
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander	7,300
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Médicas por Bill W.	3,600
A.A. y el Empleado Alcohólico	600
Un Principiante Pregunta	8,800
Como Trabaja el Programa	24,200
Lo que le Sucedió a José	15,800
Comprendiendo el Anonimato	5,600
El Grupo de A.A.	7,000
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento	11,200
El Miembro de A.A. – Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas	11,400
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas	5,800
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento	3,800
Los Jóvenes y A.A.	10,550
La Tradición de A.A. – Cómo se Desarrolló	3,500
Una Breve Guía a A.A.	12,400
A.A. en Prisiones	5,900
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol	9,300
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda	4,600
Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.	2,700
Dentro de A.A.	2,700
A.A. como Recurso para la Profesión Médica	1,700

Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A.	2,000
R.S.G.	3,200
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (new)	7,500
A.A. Para la Mujer (new)	6,000
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (new)	1,200
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales (new)	800
Total	330,850

Miscellaneous

Guías	8,300
Parchments, Spanish	400
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera	22,300
Los Doce Pasos (Cassette Album)	470
Total	31,470
Grand total	423,320

FRENCH

Books

Gros Livre (First edition)	171
Gros Livre (2nd edition)	10,647
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte	1,722
Réflexions de Bill	4,658
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions	6,704
Total	23,902

Booklets

Nous en sommes venus à croire (Came to Believe)	3,843
Vivre . . . sans alcool! (Living Sober)	3,765
Album Souvenir (Souvenir Album)	7,654
Total	15,262

Pamphlets

Voici les A.A.	11,512
Les A.A.: 44 Questions	3,247
Les A.A. sont-ils pour vous?	34,637
Les A.A. pour la femme	1,579
Collaboration des membres des A.A.	812
Les A.A. et le monde du travail	1,924
Le membre des A.A. face aux méd. et à la drogue	2,620
Les A.A. – Article du <i>Saturday Evening Post</i>	583
Collaborons avec nos amis	661
Questions et réponses sur le parrainage	3,648
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins	1,296
Les A.A. et la profession médicale (discontinued)	364
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement	1,102
La Tradition des A.A. et son développement	1,018
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme?	1,312
Alice l'a trouvée	1,224
Jean face à son problème d'alcool	1,647
Les A.A. dans votre milieu	1,783
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme	1,817
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A.	1,338
Les Douze Traditions illustrées	2,062
Notre méthode	19,455
Les A.A. dans les prisons	947
Ca vaut mieux que de poireauter en prison	881
Petit guide pratique des Alcooliques Anonymes	7,389
Un ecclésiastique s'interroge sur les A.A.	1,404
Biographies des cofondateurs	877
Lettre à un détenu	1,204
Le groupe des A.A.	2,677
Le Manuel de services/12 Concepts	752
12 Etapes/12 Traditions Carte	2,785
Carte des Etapes et Traditions	596
Les Douze Concepts illustrés	1,260
Le sens de l'anonymat	2,246
Trois causeries à des sociétés médicales	981
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie?	1,756
Si vous exercez des activités professionnelles	952

Le R.S.G.	1,873
Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A.	887
Suggestions pour réunions de débutants	601
Les meilleurs articles de Bill	9,613
Trop jeune?	2,047
Structure de l'Ass. des A.A.	1,527
L'héritage des Services des A.A.	761
Cercles d'amour et de service	1,067
Vous croyez-vous différent?	1,292
Lettre à une femme alcoolique	1,258
Carte anonymat	363
Sondage sur les membres des A.A.	3,099
Les jeunes et les A.A.	2,211
Votre B.S.G.	1,413
Il est encore temps de vivre	1,980
Un nouveau veut savoir	11,356

Total 163,696

Guidelines

5,574

Miscellaneous

Prière Sérénité (Carte)	50,990
Prière Sérénité (5 × 7)	2,172
Prière Sérénité (12 × 16)	521
Prière Sérénité (23 × 34)	224
Slogans (série de 5)	394
Littérature . . . une aide essentielle	503
La Vigne A.A.	1,770
Etiquettes Allô!	2,000
Liste de réunions – Area 87	7,099
Liste de réunions – Region 88	34
Liste de réunions – Region 90	300
Médailles rhodium français	1,119
Médailles rhodium anglais	237
Jetons aluminium "appelle avant"	13,176
Jetons 3 mois aluminium	2,772
Jetons 6 mois aluminium	2,170
Jetons 9 mois aluminium	1,658
Jetons 12 mois aluminium	1,248
Pochette re: kit nouveau membre	2,054
Annuaire Est E.-U.	53
Annuaire Ouest des E.-U.	23
Annuaire International	78
Annuaire canadiens	69
Videocassettes Les Jeunes & AA (video VHS)	160
Videocassette Les Jeunes & AA (video Beta)	17
Videocassette Les Jeunes & AA (U-Matic)	2
Videocassette Ca Vaut Mieux que de poireauter en prison (video VHS)	108
Chez les Alcooliques anonymes (video VHS)	15

Total 91,046

Service literature

Kits nouveaux groupes	71
Assortiments pour centres correctionnels	6
Assortiments Information publique	29
Assortiments C.M.P.	1
Manuels Information publique	106
Manuel de la C.M.P.	11
Aperçu sur A.A.	42,662
La transmission du message dans les prisons	2,910
Message aux adolescents	30,360
Et Maintenant, que vais-je faire?	1,210
Renseignements sur les A.A.	1,011
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme (citations)	2,310
Feuilles illustrées sur la finance	600

Total 81,287

Grand total 373,159

Reports on Area Service Highlights

Alabama/N.W. Florida: Our area has a strong interest in service and we have a strong area assembly structure. All of our committees are very active, not only at area assembly but in their districts as well. We have 20 districts and 358 groups. This is tremendous growth from our area assemblies in the 60s, where at one assembly in Montgomery, Alabama in 1962, there were 18 people in attendance, representing a total of four districts. Now they last all weekend and are attended by many. I know this is not a big area to some, but this is tremendous growth to us. God has been good to our area.—*Jim Drysdale*

Arkansas: Our assembly has doubled in size and all districts have active D.C.M.s. Many districts have a full complement of active committees corresponding to the area committee. One district grew so large it was divided. Our institutions committee was split into corrections and treatment facilities committees. The corrections facilities committee established an A.A. group at the state penitentiary. Some inmates have obtained permission to attend the area assembly and wardens from four penitentiaries have attended, sharing how A.A. has helped make their jobs easier, and offering their suggestions. We have an active archives committee with an archivist and a permanent archives display. Everyone in Arkansas is grateful to Wayne Parks and we wish him the best as G.S.O.'s new general manager.—*Robert Barros*

British Columbia/Yukon: Ours is the second largest geographical area in North America. We have 54 districts and 650 groups. Each district is represented by one D.C.M. and D.C.M. funds and district workshops are becoming more popular. The Vancouver Area and some districts hold pre-Conference workshops. We participate in the Western Regional A.A. Service Assembly and voted to participate in the Pacific Northwest Conference as long as it is service-oriented. District P.I./C.P.C. committees are active. Treatment and correctional facilities are separated at the area level. G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s are well informed and service meetings are conducted in relative peace.—*Carolyn Beaupre*

California (Northern Coastal): Our area has approximately 1,998 groups. We were proud to have 54 candidates at our election assembly for eight area officer positions. We are heavily involved in P.I., C.P.C., archives, H.I.E., and young peoples committees. We maintain close contact with our central offices and intergroups while cherishing their autonomy. Most of our districts hold regular service or unity days. We are excited over the start of high school groups and the unification of our Spanish-speaking groups through a new district. We strongly encourage self-support at the group level. Problems include our constant growth, changes, court referrals, problems other than alcohol, and how to cooperate with our ever-growing "Twelve Step Treatment" community.—*Frank Piazza*

California (Southern): Our area has approximately 1,600 groups and 49 districts. We hold assemblies every other month with meetings for our eight standing committees – C.P.C., P.I., archives, registration, finance, policy and guidelines, Grapevine and literature. G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, and other interested A.A.s are encouraged to become active on the committees. Districts meet on a monthly or bi-monthly basis. The four-area sharing session held by the Baja, California; San Diego/Imperial; Mid-Southern; and Southern California Areas has helped increase interest in service work. We hold a workshop each March to discuss the topics on the General Service Conference Agenda. Our 100-plus Spanish language groups hold some 800 meetings each week and are divided into five districts. The Spanish-speaking G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s are very active in service work.—*Juan Martinez*

Colorado: Our area currently has 595 groups and 24 districts. We hold quarterly assemblies in which approximately 60% of groups participate. Our corrections committee last year purchased and distributed over \$12,000 in literature (English and Spanish) to 55 correctional facilities by using "pink cans" to collect loose change contributed during meetings. The committee's first annual corrections workshop was well-attended by A.A.s as well as non-A.A.s, including judges, sheriffs, prison wardens and the Colorado State Chairperson of the Department of Corrections. A second workshop is planned for this summer. The area hosted the first Southwest Regional Service Assembly in February. We are attempting to clarify and rewrite our *Area Structure Manual*, to be presented at our first area assembly in 1989.—*Frank King*

Connecticut: We are self-supporting in our service work. Our guidelines committee defines the duties and responsibilities of our area officers, special service chairs, and district committee members. The committee also clarifies financial questions, qualifications for officers, and conduct of area meetings and assemblies. As a result of this committee's work we doubled the number of D.C.M.s in each district. We also relocated our area convention with great success. As reported in *Box 4-5-9*, we started and are successfully running an A.A. meeting in one of our high schools, for students only. The kids are doing just fine and the experiment is being tried in other schools in the state.—*Bob FitzSimons*

District of Columbia: The Washington, D.C. Area General Assembly (GSA) comprises 32 districts, 400 groups and 1,300 weekly meetings. Area monthly meetings are attended by D.C.M.s, G.S.R.s and other interested members. Assembly meetings are held three times annually with 80% of districts represented, including active Hispanic participation. Annual GSA-sponsored events include a mini-conference, convention, and gratitude breakfast. GSA and intergroup maintain a good rapport. The area delegate and GSA chair attend intergroup meetings. Our newsletter is published three times annually; the intergroup newsletter is published monthly. GSA encourages groups to do their part in the self-support effort toward our goal of 100% participation.—*Ann White*

Florida (North): We have an influx of approximately 800 people a day into north Florida; many join A.A. groups. The North Florida Area Assemblies have grown to a two-and-a-half-day agenda, which approximately 600 alcoholics and Al-Anons attend. We now have P.I., C.P.C. accessibilities, Grapevine, treatment and correctional facilities committees. Because we have many older members who have been active in other areas of the country, our committees have expanded greatly. Our concerns are with singleness of purpose and the addition of many members from treatment centers and court programs to our rural groups. We need to get back to basics and follow the Traditions.

—*Jimmy Gann*

Composite of Average Delegate

The average delegate is 51.7 years old, sober 12.9 years and has been involved in service work for 10.5 years.

To refine that: oldest 72, youngest 33; longest sobriety 22 years, shortest 6 years; longest time in service 20 years and shortest 4.

— *Statistics compiled at G.S.O.
based on 91 responses*

Florida (South): Our area has grown to 14 districts with over 1,200 groups. An intergroup/central office committee was added for a total of six standing committees. We now have a quarterly coordinator and a "how to" package for districts hosting quarterly assemblies. Our archives committee has been extremely successful. The Southeast Regional Forum was held in December in Hollywood, Florida and was well-attended. We customarily invite a G.S.O. staff member to be our guest at the January quarterly assembly and this year it was a pleasure to have Ann Warner with us. We shared with her our experience of using the Grapevine as a sponsorship tool. It was an additional pleasure to present to G.S.O. a check, which Ann carried back.—*Frances Cherry*

Hawaii: Our area now has 12 districts and over 200 groups. We have six area committee meetings and six assemblies each year. A.A. growth on our outer islands of Maui and the "Big Island" of Hawaii is exciting. The Big Island recently added a new district, Puna. Our districts are becoming more active and all now provide for D.C.M. transportation costs to off-island committee meetings and some pay for G.S.R.s to attend assemblies. The burst of enthusiasm at the district level has spilled over into Oahu and had a positive effect on the entire area. Our area archives, after years of moving from one garage to closet to another, has found a home in Honolulu in a small office. We recently hosted the 21st annual Pacific Region A.A. Service Assembly.—*Dick Mabery*

Illinois (Chicago): September 20, 1989 is the 50th anniversary of the first A.A. meeting in the Chicago area. Our celebration begins with a spring banquet and dance and concludes in the fall with the annual All Chicago open meetings. The 1987 All Chicago open meeting had an estimated crowd of 10,500 who consumed 350 gallons of coffee, purchased \$12,000 in literature, and contributed \$19,350 to A.A. Our area membership of 75,000 attend 3,200 meetings weekly. Eight new districts bring the total to 23 districts. It is hoped the new districts will attract new G.S.R.s, give us more committee members and help with Twelfth-Step calls. The Chicago Area Service Committee has made the Grapevine committee a full-standing committee.—*Jim Engle*

Illinois (Southern): Our area has 11 districts, 328 groups and 5,700 members. We hold quarterly assemblies and next year will hold our annual spring conference and area assembly separately. We participate in both the annual Illinois All-State Conference and Tri-State Convention. Many of us are involved in carrying the A.A. message to correctional facilities. Our area C.P.C. committee is just being formed. Our P.I. committee coordinates the distribution of pamphlets and places P.I. spots in the local media. The Grapevine committee reports an increase in Grapevine materials purchases. We're moving forward with the 5-year plan of the Challenge of the Seventh Tradition.—*Herman Gremmels*

Indiana (Northern): We have just finished our first year as an area assembly. Several districts held productive workshops on cooperation with the professional community, service, anonymity, the Steps, the Traditions, and other topics. The newly elected trusted servants of Area 22 look forward to helping our area carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. At present there are approximately 534 groups in northern Indiana. We have a cooperative attitude with southern Indiana and hope to increase this effort over the next few years.—*Michael Oester*

Iowa: We have 19 districts and 596 groups. We hold state service conferences in June and October each year. At our tri-annual area assemblies the state committee and D.C.M.s handle business, the state chairs give updated reports, and the D.C.M.s report on

their districts. We applied for and received an Articles of Association tax-exempt number. Our state needed to provide an insurance policy at the facilities where we hold our state conferences. We recently added a state newsletter to be sent out three times a year to all registered groups in Iowa. We hold cluster meetings throughout our state and our committees and past and present D.C.M.s and state chairpeople help with these.—*Janet Petska*

Louisiana: We now have 460 groups, of which approximately 45 percent sent G.S.R.s to the four 1988 Louisiana Area Assemblies. We formed correctional and treatment facilities committees and approved a \$3,500 budget for them. Their chairpersons are voting members of our assembly. The archives committee was reactivated, and we approved a \$7,000 prudent reserve. The Louisiana Area Assembly contributed \$848.98 to G.S.O. in 1988, ten percent of our third-quarter monies. We moved our assembly to Baton Rouge from Alexandria. We continue to hold service workshops.—*Bobby Broussard*

Massachusetts (Eastern): Our 1,800 groups and 100,000 members are served by an area committee, D.C.M.s from 26 districts, and archives, C.P.C., corrections, Grapevine, P.I., and treatment facilities committees. Rapid growth has resulted in a substantial influx of members misinformed or uninformed about Traditions, the Third Legacy and self-support. We hold six assemblies with agendas that include increased use of workbooks and workshops; more district visits by Conference committee chairs and area committee officers; updating district boundaries; increasing the number of D.C.M.s and alternates; and establishing a permanent home for our archives. Although we do not have a D.C.M. for Spanish-speaking groups, outreach to all minorities is long overdue.—*Annmari Matulis*

Michigan (Central): The Central Michigan Area meets once a month in different cities in central Michigan. Our finance committee oversees financial requests from our committees, and the chairperson of the finance committee takes the requests and their recommendation to the general service meeting for approval. In December 1988 Central Michigan Inter Area filed for incorporation as a nonprofit organization under the name Central Michigan Inter Area of Alcoholics Anonymous Inc. This was done due to the amount of literature we sell, to protect our trusted servants from liability. Two years ago we sent 12 people to the East Central Regional Forum; this year we will send twenty. Michigan is a three-delegate state and every quarter we hold a statewide meeting. We hold a statewide workshop once a year.—*Roger Crist*

Michigan (Southeast): Our estimated six-month reserve is \$3,000 and we have \$4,200 in active treasury. In one district with seven registered groups we discovered 42 previously unknown groups. We now have 24 districts with 461 registered groups. Redistricting is under study and as groups register with G.S.O., G.S.R.s are elected. Most districts lack officers and know only of central office as a service entity. We are making efforts to overcome communication problems and now C.P.C., P.I., institutions, and correctional facilities committees meet with one another bimonthly prior to the area committee meeting. Delegates call on district, area, and central office committees to encourage teamwork and eliminate overlap. Two representatives from our local central offices attended the seminar in Texas.—*George Cerny*

Minnesota (Southern): Our P.I. committee sponsored a successful luncheon for 200 professionals in conjunction with our eighth annual service conference. We see a need for more P.I. Twelfth-Step work. The temporary contact program for treatment centers,

patients and A.A. volunteers bridges the gap from treatment to A.A. The A.A. information program is offered to treatment facility staffs and patients. The workshop committee held several service workshops on anonymity, self-support and singleness of purpose. All three programs were featured in the February/March issue of *Box* 4-5-9. A number of groups held Big Book birthday parties in April on the theme "The A.A. Big Book, 50 Years of Service, April 1939 – April 1989."—*Chuck Rice*

Missouri (Eastern): Sixteen of our 20 districts hold monthly or bi-monthly meetings and most districts hold one or two workshops each year. Five larger districts now have L.C.M.s (local committee members) who each have up to 12 groups to help serve. Our quarterly assembly has increased and 18 districts participated in 1989. We have nine standing committees at the area level, of which seven function at the district level. Our special needs committee addresses concerns of the physically, visually, and hearing-impaired. One of our district C.P.C. committees makes extensive presentations to students at St. Louis University Medical School. Several districts have A.A. hotlines or answering services.—*Ginny Jackson*

Missouri (Western): Our area has pulled together as one. Our Grapevine committee is probably more active than ever. Our P.I. and C.P.C. committees hold monthly sharing sessions at different locations. Treatment and corrections committees have been strong for several years. Each committee hosts an institutions weekend where people from different facilities share. Many more people are interested in the archives committee. Western Missouri has an archives second to none. Our new literature committee is pioneering in this field and the chairperson has kept our area informed of literature changes and has an attractive display for our assemblies. Sixteen of our 17 districts are active. We've grown from a handful of attendees at assemblies to an average 180 attendees at 1988 assemblies.—*John Sullivan*

Nevada: Our districts are well-informed through workshops and an overall focus on service sponsorship. We strive to be fully self-supporting and we emphasize participation. District treasuries fund service work in most districts. Area officers are distributed throughout the large, sparsely populated area. Alternate area officers serve as chair, secretary, and treasurer of our two service bodies. Our annual assemblies are held in September. Committees were appointed to study finances, participation, guidelines, funding and the possibility of a mid-year area committee meeting. The committees also considered guidelines for the area treasurer to ensure that financial decisions are made with a conscience that prevents one individual from having undue responsibility for making decisions. We continue to grow in members and new groups.—*Joyce Yourdan*

New Jersey (Northern): Our area committee of 30 districts serves 1,075 groups. We hold three assemblies, six to ten area committee meetings, a mini-conference and a convention each year. In October 1989 we will host the Northeast Regional Convention. Our P.I., treatment and correctional facilities committees have combined with intergroup's P.I. and hospitals and institutions committees. Our P.I. committee guides A.A. members who speak at non-A.A. functions. Our treatment facilities committee is active in most districts. Our Grapevine committee was reorganized and is active and growing. C.P.C. and correctional facilities appear to be our weak committees at the area level. We publish a quarterly newsletter and hold G.S.R. and D.C.M. workshops. Several new Traditions meetings have formed throughout the area.—*Carol Casaleggi*

New York (Central): We have approximately 500 groups located throughout our six districts. Our area assemblies rotate within the districts and meet monthly except during May, when we hold our area convention. We have five subcommittees: P.I., C.P.C., treatment, corrections, and archives. Last year we split P.I./C.P.C. into two committees, and split the institutions committee into treatment and corrections. We are forming a finance committee. The percentage of groups contributing has increased, both to the area and to G.S.O. We mail our assembly minutes to all known groups in our area. More groups are represented at our assemblies and there is a heightened interest in and awareness of the needs of the Fellowship.—*Rosemary Palmeri*

New York (Southeast): Service awareness and participation is growing in SENY, and younger group representatives are staying longer in service. Our six assemblies include workshops while our committee meetings address current concerns. In mid-1988 our area hosted the New York State Convention during which plays about carrying the message of recovery proved educational. A subcommittee produced and updated a set of by-laws, which clarify many procedures in our area. Many districts held share-a-days, spiritual breakfasts and round-ups. We continue efforts to identify and meet the needs of alcoholics in black and foreign-language communities, especially Spanish. Efforts to draw minorities into the full range of area activities often produce heartening examples of mutual support in true fellowship.—*Boyce Bengé*

North Carolina/Bermuda: Our area purchased a computer to store and process information for our 680 groups. The 27 D.C.M.s and all G.S.R.s are to be commended for their interest in service at the area level, evidenced by better record keeping and increasing attendance at our two annual assemblies. We have 12 workshops on three topics, led by D.C.M.s and alternates. Each G.S.R. attends three workshops and has a vote on assembly actions. At our spring and fall committee planning meetings we have workshops for D.C.M.s and alternates, and for officers of the area committee on a service topic. Our fall assembly voted to pay expenses for our delegate, exemplifying self-support at the area level. Cluster workshops where two or more districts meet are increasing. One district hosted a Grape-a-thon for other districts at which an editor from the Grapevine attended.—*Judy Mize*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Our area has 16 districts, 255 groups and a total membership of around three thousand. Our geographical structure is large; the island of Newfoundland makes up six districts. Travel is difficult and expensive. We have one assembly a year (usually in October), which rotates among our major centers. We have two service weekends each May, one in Nova Scotia and another immediately following in Newfoundland. A full report is given by all D.C.M.s and area officers, including a detailed report by the delegate to the General Service Conference. We have formed archives committees in Nova Scotia and Newfoundland and most districts have formed C.P.C., P.I. and institutions committees. All are working well. Last August the first national convention, held in Halifax, Nova Scotia, was a tremendous success.—*William Bungay*

Ohio (Central and Southeastern): Our area has about 550 groups and 42 districts. After redistricting we have seen more service and information workshops, district meetings and other service activities. The C.P.C. committee conducts presentations throughout the area and our Grapevine committee exhibits their display at workshops, anniversaries, district meetings and the area assembly. Area P.I. and C.P.C. committees are enthusiastic

cally accepted. A secretaries workshop created much group interest. Together with the four areas of Ohio and G.S.O., "Area 53 Goes to Orient," an all-day information session for inmates and staff of Orient Correctional Institute was held. Our second area convention was successful and will be held annually. We will host the 1989 13th East Central Regional and the 33rd Ohio State Conference in Columbus in July.—*Melvin R. Blades*

Ohio (Northeast): Our area consists of 904 groups, 46 districts and seven central or intergroup offices. Redistricting continues, generating increases in assembly attendance and D.C.M. participation. A traveling service display is now available for service panel presentations. Monthly district workshops on the *A.A. Service Manual* are held for new G.S.R.s and G.S.R. information packets are distributed to new G.S.R.s at our assembly and district meetings. An additional area meeting has been added for workshops on service. History on the early black A.A. members from our area will be presented to the G.S.O. archives, and our area archive committee is compiling local group histories.

—*Mary Branche*

Oklahoma: The Oklahoma State Committee sponsored two service workshops last year and two more are planned. The Round-Up of Young People in A.A. was held in July in Oklahoma City and the Second Mid-America Big Book Seminar was held in Tulsa in November. The Four-State Round-Up was held in February in Grove. Enid hosted the Northwest District Conference and a round-robin was held at Beaver's Bend State Park. In March, Oklahoma City hosted the Southwest Regional Delegates Assembly. At our general assembly in September, the bridging the gap committee was approved as a funded, permanent committee taking meetings into treatment facilities in every part of the state and helps assure discharged patients of an A.A. contact to take them to their first meeting. Last year this program carried the message to over 3,000 people. There are 334 groups in Oklahoma with a membership of 5,455. The 48th Anniversary State Conference will be held in Oklahoma City in May.—*Joe McCoy*

Ontario (Eastern): Our area has 23 districts and 500 groups. Our committee was formed 12 years ago and many things have changed yet many remain the same. Our 1988 fall assembly had the largest attendance ever and as of January the position of group registrar has been added to our committee. In 1988 for the first time the area received contributions from all districts. Grapevine subscriptions have increased and special item sales are enormous. The Eastern Canada regional trustee is from our area. Last but not least we have our first female delegate to the General Service Conference. Our cup runneth over and for that we are truly grateful.—*Katie Gellately*

Ontario (Northeast): Activity has increased as membership grows and newer members rotate into service. Solutions to group problems are shared at the district and area levels in workshops using literature, workbooks and video. Members are encouraged to contact G.S.O. to benefit from its experience. Concerns expressed by the G.S.R.s include meaningful, well-attended group business meetings, meeting length, and what and how to report without boring everyone. An ongoing challenge at the district level is helping G.S.R.s inform members about the Traditions and service work. We believe the goal of total self-support at all service levels will be achieved through implementing the following ideas at upcoming assemblies; two-day get-togethers, effectively planned agendas, ample notice, and effective meeting content.

—*Hazel King*

Delegates are often accompanied to New York by spouses, friends and/or children. A Hospitality Suite was available for those "significant others"; each morning began with coffee and pastry and a Host Committee planned various daily activities. This year's schedule included a Circle Line cruise around Manhattan, tours of the Statue of Liberty and the Brooklyn Botanic Garden and a visit to the Geraldo Rivera TV show. Ten hardy people even trooped out to Shea Stadium for an evening Met game. And, of course, there was shopping and A.A. and Al-Anon meetings. This year's Host Committee was headed by Dorothy Conley and Dorothy Driscoll and included other New York A.A. and Al-Anon members.

Ontario (Northwestern): Our area has 84 groups and we are still striving for perfection in participation. Fortunately, we aren't easily discouraged. We are receiving feelers from Native [American] reservations regarding starting A.A. groups and in fact a couple of groups have already registered. The efforts of our assembly chairpeople continue as do those of the P.I., institutions, and correctional facilities committees. Our numbers are comparatively small yet year after year new people rotate into these jobs. Our area will discuss raising the mileage expenses where applicable from ten to fifteen cents per kilometer. This self-support underscores that we should not carry extra financial burdens caused by service work, even when we want to.—*Gareth Davis*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): We have 34 districts and 1,100 groups. The newly formed Grapevine Committee held two workshops and as a result, GV meetings are growing. The structure committee's *Area Structure Manual* has been reprinted for the third year. Our P.I. and treatment/correctional committees effectively share the experiences of our Fellowship with our local committees. The archives committee seeks group, district and area history. The finance committee shares information on our Seventh Tradition and our calendar committee helps us plan our A.A. activities. We have four mini-assemblies each year. Our annual convention includes an assembly in odd years and our elections in even years.—*Reba Warren*

Pennsylvania (Western): We have two major metropolitan areas, Erie and Pittsburgh. The three most significant areas of improvement are communications with outlying districts, C.P.C./P.I. committees and our area newsletter. We created several new districts. Our annual weekend of sharing has helped improve communications with outlying districts, as have three or four spring and fall sharing days. We now have approximately 25 active chairpeople on our C.P.C./P.I. committees, thanks to Carol T. Our area newsletter has vastly improved. Our new area secretary, Lois C., has put two and a half years into the newsletter, which is supported by contributions and by the districts.—*Bill Stigliano*

Quebec (Northeast): The four areas of the Province of Quebec differ from the other areas of North America because of the "French fact" of our members. This limits individual communication with G.S.O. but creates solidarity between groups in each district. We have 20 districts and usually hold some 20 area service meetings each year. Our area committee concentrates on four objectives: conveying the conscience of our groups to the General Service Conference; making A.A. better known to the public through our P.I., and institutions committees and through

two publications; holding regional information seminars and service meetings to develop well-informed group consciences; and promoting the spiritual dimension of the Seventh Tradition.—*Serge Filion*

Quebec (Southeast): Our area has 18 districts that cover approximately 1,000 miles end to end from Drummondville to the Madeleines Islands, Quebec. We have penal institutions, P.I., and Grapevine committees. We hold regional assemblies in a different location every month. We meet thrice yearly with the other three areas of Quebec, which we call the provincial committees. We have 232 groups that hold 265 meetings per week; 165 open and 100 closed. We have two gratitude dinners where the delegate gives the annual Conference report and we also host a "Day of the Delegate" in six locations. Our area is very active and we look forward to a very hopeful future.—*Jean Bureau*

Texas (Northeast): We have 403 groups, which represent a growth rate of 15 percent of the past three years. We've increased the number of assemblies to four. Eighteen of 22 district committee members are active in monthly meetings. There are two Regional Forums in the vicinity, our own and one in Arkansas. The regional assembly this year should help. Much has been done to increase awareness of the need for service yet there remain inactive D.C.M.s, and some G.S.R.s who do not attend any of the assemblies or district meetings. We added another intergroup central office in the area, making five, and we plan to add another.—*Les Williams*

Texas (Southeast): Our area has completed its first year on the quarterly meeting schedule with positive results. More groups participate on the district and area level and group contributions have increased quarterly. We now have a D.C.M. for each district. The districts have become more unified as they take turns hosting the quarterly meetings. We have established two new committees at the area level, a correctional and a C.P.C. committee. Putting together the bid for the 1995 International Convention involved many people and a great amount of time and effort. This was a wonderful experience for all involved. We are proud of Olga M., a past delegate, who was selected as a member of the trustees' Correctional Committee.—*Beth Cury*

Utah: Our area has over 200 groups, ten districts, and three central (intergroup) offices. We have several Native North American groups that are increasingly strong and involved. Increased interest in service sponsorship is helping us to understand the Traditions and our primary purpose. District budgets are set up to support D.C.M. and committee efforts. Our P.I., C.P.C., and treatment facilities committees hold "speaker familiarization experiences" and our corrections and Grapevine committees are very strong. Registration and finance committees were created to better structure the area. We have new literature and convention committees and have just published the third edition of our quarterly area newsletter. We supported the 1989 I.C.Y.P.A., held in Salt Lake City.—*Patti Walters*

Virginia: We continue to grow in leaps and bounds with 960-plus groups and 31 districts. Our area assembly has become so busy that we are looking at having three assemblies a year instead of two. We have completed and published our Service Structure and Guidelines and they are being distributed. The area convention is well underway and we are expecting over 1,200 participants in August 1989 in Roanoke. We are also planning our 1990 convention. We have experienced much growth with several of our districts and new districts have been formed. Many districts

are continuing to carry the message through events such as Super Saturday in Richmond, district workshops on Anonymity, Seventh Tradition workshops, Service workshops and more. Come visit us in Virginia.—*Mary Ann Cunningham*

West Virginia: We now serve 227 groups in 14 districts. Our statewide toll-free answering service has had a dramatic impact. West Virginia is primarily a rural, poor state where travel is hard and population centers are few. The 800 number is always available and as a result, our rural and urban districts are experiencing the same growth rate. The 800 number has given our service structure a focal point and has created interest in service. The area service committee is conducting a district-level needs assessment survey to determine which districts need help and in what areas of service. We are forming teams of area officers and committee chairpeople to help districts put on workshops and informational meetings.—*Jerry Smith*

Wisconsin (Southern): Our 35 districts all have D.C.M.s and one past delegate has been providing a "G.S.R. school" in the Milwaukee area. Our outgoing delegate becomes the Grapevine chairperson and thanks to our "Count on Us" program, a large number of Grapevine subscriptions go to our correctional facilities. Three-quarters of our districts have corrections chairpeople and most of our correctional facilities have weekly A.A. meetings. The Southern Wisconsin Matching Literature Fund helps meet their literature needs. The treatment committees have had a struggle with treatment centers who want to turn ours into Addictions Anonymous meetings. Tradition Seven is stressed in group, district and area meetings.—*Karen Raschella-Norbert*

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 1989

	Groups	Members
United States	40,693	835,489
Canada	4,749	81,293
Overseas	38,060 ¹	762,046 ¹
Correctional facilities	1,768 ²	54,808
Internationalists		559
Lone members		539
	85,270	1,734,734

1. At the end of 1988, we had reported members from 72 of the 134 overseas countries with A.A. groups. These totaled 30,359 groups and 634,390 members. To establish an estimate for the 62 countries not yet responding, we excluded the ten largest responding and obtained an average of the balance. This average was applied to the 62 and the overall estimate emerged.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

Financial Overview

FINANCE: G.S.O. had a net total operating expense of \$168,000 (after paying extraordinary expenses for computer acquisition of \$541,000, the 1988 portion of an expected total \$900,000 project cost). As a result, there was no surplus capital to transfer to the Reserve Fund in 1989.

The negative G.S.O. net contrasts sharply with the positive \$274,000 that had been budgeted. The difference is due mainly to 1988 contributions falling short of budgeted projections by over \$300,000. Sales were slightly over budget, by \$60,000, in spite of greatly reduced prices and implementation of single pricing in March 1988.

G.S.O.'s efforts to maintain low literature prices will continue to depend on responses to the Challenge of the Seventh Tradition.

SERVICES: Contributions for 1988 were \$3,900,000, 6.8% greater than 1987, but far short of expectations. After the success of 1987 when contributions increased by 37% in one year, we failed to properly communicate the continuing need for contribution increases to deal with demand for increased services and to hold literature prices down. The shortfall of \$513,000 relative to all service expenses was \$282,000 greater than anticipated.

PUBLISHING: 1988 literature sales net of discounts were \$7,761,000, down 5% from 1987. However, this was \$229,000 greater than budgeted; a result of greater than anticipated unit sales that were brought on by what we believe was a positive reaction to the lower pricing policy. That made literature available to more people. Unit sales in 1988 for our major book titles ran around 30% over those of 1987, in contrast to our projected 12% increase.

Expenses charged to publishing increased by 15.9%. This increase was substantially larger than budgeted and mainly due to costs related to processing a greater than expected number of items sold.

EDP SYSTEM DEVELOPMENT: The acquisition of a new computer system is an extraordinary expense categorized as a General Service Board expense. The total computer acquisition project is budgeted at \$900,000, of which \$514,000 was expended in 1988. The balance will be incurred in 1989. This expenditure includes the cost of equipment (including four computers from the new IBM AS/400 series), acquisition of several new software packages (including word processing) and implementation assistance. The Grapevine has participated in planning this project and will be served by this new equipment.

BOARD SPONSORED INTERNATIONAL VISITS: The Soviet Union has begun to deal with alcoholism and the treatment of it. A sharing began in 1987 when A.A. accepted an invitation to participate in a trip to the U.S.S.R. In April 1988 representatives and professionals from the U.S.S.R. traveled to the U.S. and visited G.S.O. and other institutions and programs dealing with recovery from alcoholism.

This expanded worldwide interest in the A.A. program has been an exciting experience for the Fellowship and has raised the consciousness of the board. This has resulted in the commitment on the part of the board to initiate translations for the purpose of making our literature available to those who wish to acquire it, but where the A.A. structure is not yet in place.

WORKING CAPITAL: The balance sheet for G.S.O. shows a marked decrease in cash from \$1,476,000 to \$542,000. This has been caused by a combination of factors: the net expense from operations plus unusual additions to inventory due to increased unit sales. A movement of \$500,000 from the Reserve Fund was authorized by the General Service Board on January 31, 1989, to increase working capital.

GRAPEVINE: The Grapevine's results for 1988 show an increase in revenue of \$267,000, which is mainly attributable to sales of the new book *The Language of the Heart*. Circulation of the magazine was approximately 3% higher than in 1987.

Grapevine's expenses for 1988 were \$1,755,000, compared with a budget of \$1,698,000 in 1988, and \$1,583,000 in 1987. Expenses were \$57,000 over budget, of which \$53,000 were directly attributable to cost of sales of *The Language of the Heart* that were not included in the original budget.

Grapevine's net income for 1988, including interest earned, was \$212,000, compared to \$106,500 in 1987, and a budgeted net income in 1988 of \$750.

Grapevine's 1989 budget projects income at \$1,995,000, about \$94,000 higher than 1988, with expenses for 1989 anticipated at \$2,063,000, resulting in a net income of \$450.

RESERVE FUND: The General Service Board Reserve Fund had a fund balance at December 31, 1988 of \$7,203,000, yielding approximately 8% on book value. Although \$450,000 was transferred to the Reserve Fund in March 1988, \$760,000 was drawn down subsequently during the remainder of 1988 for several reasons, including (a) contributions ran significantly less than anticipated; (b) lower gross profits were derived from literature sales and greater than anticipated inventory replacements; and (c) funding for the computer acquisition was supplied by the Reserve Fund due to insufficient available funds.

As a result of 1988 operations an additional \$500,000 was transferred to the General Service Office in February 1989 from the Reserve Fund to provide sufficient operating capital levels. When measured against 1988's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., the General Service Board of A.A., Inc., and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., the Reserve Fund stands at about 9.1 months, as compared to a similar measurement for 1987 of 11.7 months.

It appears that the concerns about the Reserve Fund reaching its limit have been addressed through the reduction in literature prices, contributions falling below expectations, and capital expenditures for the computer acquisition.

Summary: Although G.S.O. significantly reduced literature prices in 1988, no further reductions are planned for 1989. The 1988 shift in emphasis from the self-support message (successful in 1987) to an emphasis on *participation*, seems to have been received as a mixed message. The continuing challenge of self-support requires a message that includes financial commitment from the individual member to all levels of A.A. service.

An Unsung Hero

Some may have been mystified when rotating trustee Joe Phelan, thanking a list of people, included "... Pablo, the greatest check-writer in A.A." He was referring to Pablo Roman, of G.S.O.'s accounting department, who prepares the checks for the trustees' expenses.

The General Service Office

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1988

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund Office	Other	General Service Office Total
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$8,107,743			\$8,107,743
Less: Discounts	346,298			346,298
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>7,761,445</u>			<u>7,761,445</u>
Cost of printing	(3,130,928)			(3,130,928)
Royalties	(872,854)			(872,854)
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	<u>3,757,663</u>			<u>3,757,663</u>
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$3,900,327		3,900,327
Interest income	7,524	14,681		22,205
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>3,765,187</u>	<u>3,915,008</u>	<u>\$ - 0 -</u>	<u>7,680,195</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	1,348,690	1,698,796		3,047,486
Pension	208,640			208,640
Rent	333,931	245,301		579,232
Box 4-5-9		142,617		142,617
A.A. Directories		95,757		95,757
Other service materials		283,152		283,152
Shipping and mailing	1,112,445			1,112,445
Other office expenses	70,018	587,339		657,357
Insurance and payroll taxes		587,724		587,724
Professional services	136,525		23,000	159,525
Board, committee and staff meetings	57,675	8,746	129,411	195,832
Writers' fees	65,997			65,997
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	12,852		92,295	105,147
General Service Conference		241,937		241,937
EDP system development	67,415		513,926	581,341
Regional Forums and other			96,331	96,331
Film project			28,472	28,472
EDP system review			26,944	26,944
Leasehold improvements			20,756	20,756
Self-support project			12,843	12,843
Foreign literature assistance (net)	84			84
World Service Meeting			59,579	59,579
Board sponsored international visits			65,329	65,329
<u>Total Expenses</u>	<u>3,414,272</u>	<u>3,891,369</u>	<u>1,068,886</u>	<u>8,374,527</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>350,915</u>	<u>23,639</u>	<u>(1,068,886)</u>	<u>(694,332)</u>
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND				
Balance, January 1				\$6,961,426
Transfer from A.A.W.S.				450,000
Transfer to General Fund				(760,000)
Investment Income				551,847
Balance, December 31				<u>\$7,203,273</u>

() denotes red figures

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund, and the basis of such allocation. "It should be remembered that this distribution of expense is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not as to the individual accounts."

The General Service Office

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1987

	<u>A.A.W.S. Publishing</u>	<u>A.A. G.S.B. General Fund</u>		<u>General Service Office</u>
		<u>Office</u>	<u>Other</u>	<u>Total</u>
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$8,354,886			\$8,354,886
Less: Discounts	<u>(182,382)</u>			<u>(182,382)</u>
<u>Net Sales</u>	8,172,504			8,172,504
Cost of products	<u>(2,722,078)</u>			<u>(2,722,078)</u>
Royalties	<u>(1,018,966)</u>			<u>(1,018,966)</u>
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	4,431,460			4,431,460
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$3,652,163		3,652,163
Interest income	<u>16,429</u>	<u>13,650</u>		<u>30,079</u>
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>4,447,889</u>	<u>3,665,813</u>	<u>\$ - 0 -</u>	<u>8,113,702</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	1,136,815	1,557,242		2,694,057
Pension/retirement expense	231,383		9,017	240,400
Rent and electric	296,938	217,780		514,718
Box 4-5-9		149,857		149,857
A.A. Directories		78,659		78,659
Other service materials		234,826		234,826
Shipping and mailing	860,834			860,834
Other office expenses	60,174	442,989		503,163
Insurance and payroll taxes		484,053		484,053
Professional services	151,404		20,875	172,279
Board, committee and staff meetings	44,444	13,031	105,275	162,750
Writers' fees	81,642			81,642
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	14,193		74,881	89,074
General Service Conference		209,204		209,204
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	58,318			58,318
Regional Forums and other			86,754	86,754
Film project			101,604	101,604
EDP system review			93,850	93,850
Relocation study	26,550			26,550
Leasehold improvements and construction			914,375	914,375
Self-support project			43,115	43,115
Foreign literature assistance (net)	<u>(17,391)</u>			<u>(17,391)</u>
<u>Total Expenses</u>	<u>2,945,304</u>	<u>3,387,641</u>	<u>1,449,746</u>	<u>7,782,691</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>1,502,585</u>	<u>278,172</u>	<u>(1,449,746)</u>	<u>331,011</u>
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND				
Balance, January 1				\$6,161,097
Transfer from A.A.W.S.				500,000
Transfer to General Fund				(200,000)
Investment Income				<u>500,329</u>
Balance, December 31				<u>\$6,961,426</u>

() denotes red figures

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund, and the basis of such allocation. "It should be remembered that this distribution of expense is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not as to the individual accounts."

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1988

	<u>1988</u>	<u>1987</u>
INCOME — from magazine and other sales	<u>\$1,900,718</u>	<u>\$1,633,684</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$196,140	\$185,730
Printing	230,337	219,160
Mailing — service	89,126	101,857
postage	167,561	142,262
Other production costs	154,765	103,054
Calendar costs	35,950	35,007
Occupancy costs	77,011	65,911
Telephone	1,727	1,546
Writers' fees	—	23,000
Office supplies and other	<u>13,682</u>	<u>7,779</u>
<u>Total</u>	966,299	885,306
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	366,086	298,166
Data processing costs	19,374	19,746
Stationery and supplies	10,004	10,537
Occupancy costs	76,983	65,911
Telephone	1,727	1,546
Office expense, including agency fees	15,355	15,304
Selling expense — Regular	48,157	36,792
GvR program	30,306	14,131
Postage	<u>52,705</u>	<u>42,661</u>
<u>Total</u>	590,697	504,794
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	3,996	4,746
Insurance	68,236	44,633
Professional fees	21,039	27,130
Payroll taxes	40,694	34,861
Meetings and conferences	18,527	15,621
Computer system development, etc.	—	21,070
Furniture and equipment	4,054	9,883
Contribution to Retirement Plan	19,107	33,963
Canadian exchange and other	3,916	1,188
Compensation study	<u>18,952</u>	<u>—</u>
<u>Total</u>	198,521	193,095
<u>Total Costs and Expenses</u>	<u>\$1,755,517</u>	<u>\$1,583,195</u>
<u>Income from Operations</u>	145,201	50,489
Interest earned	<u>66,757</u>	<u>56,029</u>
<u>Net Income for Year</u>	<u>211,958</u>	<u>106,518</u>

() denotes red figures

The General Service Office and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

December 31, 1988

	December 31, 1988		December 31, 1987	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
Assets				
Cash — checking accounts	\$ 268,764	\$ 233,120	\$ 573,699	\$ 230,849
Short-term cash investments	273,513	162,985	902,158	154,868
Investment (Note C)	—	767,941	—	617,941
Accounts receivable	100,569	75,718	144,784	59,638
Due from Grapevine	804	—	26,339	—
Inventories	1,772,060	157,571	1,056,299	101,537
Prepaid expenses and deposits	241,630	48,946	144,666	61,933
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>2,657,340</u>	<u>1,446,281</u>	<u>2,847,945</u>	<u>1,226,766</u>
Deduct Liabilities				
Accounts and accruals payable	1,083,636	107,540	909,863	141,354
Deferred income	32,411	1,097,267	12,457	1,055,896
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>1,116,047</u>	<u>1,204,807</u>	<u>922,320</u>	<u>1,197,250</u>
Net Worth				
Balance, January 1	1,925,625	29,516	1,894,614	(77,002)
Net income (loss) (Exhibits A and B)	(694,332)	211,958	331,011	106,518
Transfer (to) from Reserve Fund (net)	310,000	—	(300,000)	—
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>1,541,293</u>	<u>241,474</u>	<u>1,925,625</u>	<u>29,516</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$1,484,280		\$1,868,612	
General Fund — G.S.B. (Note B)	57,013		57,013	
Total Operating Funds — as above	1,541,293		1,925,625	
Reserve Fund	7,203,273		6,961,426	
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>8,744,566</u>		<u>8,887,051</u>	
RESERVE FUND				
Cash	\$ 277		\$ 260,624	
Short term cash investments	827,104		684,691	
Due from (to) A.A. Grapevine	(57,500)		(48,000)	
U.S. Treasury obligations	7,048,297		6,557,038	
Accrued interest	153,036		125,014	
Less: Liability for Grapevine subscribers	(767,941)		(617,941)	
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>7,203,273</u>		<u>6,961,426</u>	

() denotes red figures

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. NOTES TO FINANCIAL STATEMENTS, DECEMBER 31, 1988

NOTE A — PURPOSES AND RESTRICTIONS OF DIFFERENT FUNDS

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which, during 1977, was re-defined as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and, since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. were amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

The GENERAL FUND comprises assets not included in any of the other funds and which may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

NOTE B — After transfers of \$285,247 in 1988 and \$971,574 in 1987 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE C — Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund — \$767,941, represents the deferred subscription income of the Grapevine at December 31, 1979, plus subsequent net investments of \$287,221 as shown below:

	Investment (Withdrawal)
1981	\$ (100,000)
1983	13,418
1984	60,000
1985	60,000
1986	52,803
1987	51,000
1988	150,000
	<u>287,221</u>

The attached financial statements and above notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountants.

The General Service Office

1989 BUDGET

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund Office	Other	General Service Office Total
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$9,069,900			\$9,069,900
Discounts	(457,700)			(457,700)
<u>Net Sales</u>	8,612,200			8,612,200
Cost of products	(3,340,400)			(3,340,400)
Royalties	(953,500)			(953,500)
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	4,318,300			4,318,300
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$4,214,000		4,214,000
Interest income	20,000	5,000		25,000
<u>Total Income</u>	4,338,300	4,219,000	\$ - 0 -	8,557,300
EXPENSES				
Salaries	1,419,300	1,928,900		3,348,200
Pension/retirement expense	260,600		20,200	280,800
Rent and electric	365,500	268,400		633,900
Box 4-5-9		149,600		149,600
A.A. Directories		106,400		106,400
Other service materials		328,000		328,000
Shipping and mailing	1,156,100			1,156,100
Other office expenses	44,000	659,100		703,100
Insurance and payroll taxes		733,200		733,200
Professional services	81,200		22,200	103,400
Board, committee and staff meetings	60,200	11,500	140,000	211,700
Writers' fees	91,500			91,500
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	17,000		120,800	137,800
General Service Conference		275,100		275,100
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	88,700			88,700
Regional Forums and other			82,600	82,600
Film development			58,400	58,400
Leasehold improvements			4,300	4,300
World Service Meeting (every other year)			0	0
Self-Support Project			23,000	23,000
Computer System Acquisition			388,700	388,700
Board Expense — Int'l. Visits			5,000	5,000
Foreign literature assistance (net)	9,200			9,200
<u>Total Expense</u>	3,593,300	4,460,200	865,200	8,918,700
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>745,000</u>	<u>(241,200)</u>	<u>(865,200)</u>	<u>(361,400)</u>

NOTE:

Extraordinary expenses:

Computer system acquisition

388,700

388,700

Net Operating Income (Expense)

exclusive of extraordinary expenses

745,000

(241,200)

(476,500)

27,300

() denotes red figures

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund, and the basis of such allocation. "It should be remembered that this distribution of expense is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not as to the individual accounts."

1989 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

Income: The sales income budget of \$9,069,900, is \$962,200 (11.8%) greater than 1988. No literature price reductions are planned in this budget. With the implementation of single pricing in 1988 and lower sales prices, the effect is lower gross profits from the publishing operation.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$3,593,300, about 9.1% higher than 1988.

Net: Net publishing income is expected to be \$745,000, an increase of \$394,100 over 1988. The additional income is a result of anticipated higher unit sales and is required to offset the anticipated shortfall.

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: The budget reflects a projected 8% increase in contributions over 1988 (1988 had a 6.8% increase over 1987. However, a 15% increase had been projected for 1988 based on anticipated continued support to the self-support project).

Expenses: Total group expenses to be directly charged against contributions are budgeted to be \$4,460,200. This results in an anticipated shortfall of these expenses charged against contributions of \$241,200.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$865,200. This includes \$388,700 towards the acquisition of the new computer system project which started in 1988. Exclusive of this item, other expenses are budgeted \$78,500 less than 1988. The total other expenses will be solely offset by the excess net publishing income.

RECAP

The shortfall for 1989 of "group services" (as defined by the 1986 General Service Conference) supported by group contributions, is budgeted to be \$722,700. This is exclusive of the computer acquisition which will be funded by the General Service Board Reserve Fund if necessary.

1989 Grapevine Budget

Total revenue: The 1989 budget presented shows revenues of \$1,995,300. This anticipates paid subscriptions in the 127,000-128,000 range, and total circulation including monthly sales of about 130,000.

Total expenses: Printing of the magazine shows a \$44,000 (19%) increase from the 1988 actual, a significant increase from the 1988 budget. There are three basic reasons for this, first higher anticipated circulation, second increase in printing contract, and third higher paper costs due to an increased number of copies being printed, two expanded 64 page issues, and the paper market in general.

Mailing service costs are projected lower than the 1988 budget because of a change in mailing houses.

Magazine mailing postage is somewhat higher based upon a larger circulation. We will see what surprises the Post Office has for us.

Total editorial and printing costs are budgeted at \$1,036,100, an increase of \$70,000 (7%) over 1988 actual.

Total costs and expenses are budgeted at \$2,062,850, an increase of \$307,300 (17.5%). As mentioned above, \$44,000 of this deals with magazine production. Additional expenses are budgeted for an Assistant Controller and clerical employees. Insurance costs show a significant increase (which is being looked at) and a new item, an A.A. Grapevine indexing project has been budgeted at a cost of \$25,000 for 1989.

Net: After including interest income of \$68,000 we show a break even budget of \$450.

COMPARISON OF SHORTFALL OF 'GROUP SERVICES' SUPPORTED BY GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS

April 1986 Conference Advisory Action 16.a:

16. The area delegates strongly consider implementation of the following suggestions to improve contributions to G.S.O., area assemblies, districts, and central or inter-group offices:

- G.S.O. make available to all delegates an itemized list of group service expenses and other expenses of the board, combined into one total, representing group services supported by group contributions.

The following is a recap of these lists [detailed reports appear in delegates' Manual and Final Conference Report]:

1987

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members				\$3,652,163
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$3,387,641			
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board				
	\$1,449,746			
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:				
Construction	(914,375)			
System review	(93,850)	441,521	3,829,162	
Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions				(176,999)

1988

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members				\$3,900,327
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$3,891,369			
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board				
	\$1,068,886			
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:				
Computer Acquisition	(513,926)	554,960	4,446,329	
Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions				(546,002)

1989 BUDGET

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members				\$4,214,000
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$4,460,200			
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board				
	\$ 865,200			
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:				
Computer Acquisition	(388,700)	476,500	4,936,700	
Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions				(722,700)

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

1989 BUDGET

		1989
INCOME — from magazine and other sales		<u>\$1,995,300</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including part-time and temporary help	\$180,600	
Printing	274,000	
Mailing — service	95,100	
— postage	187,500	
Other production costs	201,500	
Occupancy costs	82,500	
Telephone	1,700	
Office supplies and expenses	7,100	
Other editorial expenses	<u>6,100</u>	
Total		1,036,100
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including part-time and temporary help	470,700	
Computer processing costs	21,650	
Stationery and supplies	10,850	
Occupancy costs	82,500	
Telephone	1,700	
Office expense	19,300	
Selling expense — regular	59,000	
— GvR program	34,300	
Postage	<u>60,000</u>	
Total		760,000
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Indexing project	25,000	
Compensation study	3,000	
Consultant fee	4,000	
Insurance	88,300	
Professional fees	23,500	
Payroll taxes	49,200	
Meetings, conferences and travel	23,000	
Furniture and equipment — normal operations	11,250	
Contribution to Retirement Fund	36,500	
Canadian exchange	1,000	
Bad debts	<u>2,000</u>	
Total		<u>266,750</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES		<u>2,062,850</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS		(67,550)
Interest earned		<u>68,000</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR YEAR		<u><u>450</u></u>

(For Management Presentation Only)

The General Service Office

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1988

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund Service Expenses	General Service Office Total
INCOME			
Sales of literature	\$8,107,700		\$8,107,700
Discounts	<u>346,300</u>		<u>346,300</u>
Net Sales	7,761,400		7,761,400
Cost of products	(3,130,900)		(3,130,900)
Royalties	<u>(872,800)</u>		<u>(872,800)</u>
Gross profit from literature	3,757,700		3,757,700
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$3,900,300	3,900,300
Interest income	<u>7,500</u>	<u>14,700</u>	<u>22,200</u>
Total Income	<u>3,765,200</u>	<u>3,915,000</u>	<u>7,680,200</u>
EXPENSES			
Salaries	1,132,700	1,914,800	3,047,500
Pension	77,200	131,400	208,600
Rent and electric	333,900	245,300	579,200
Box 4-5-9		142,600	142,600
A.A. Directories		95,800	95,800
Other service materials		283,200	283,200
Shipping and mailing	749,900	362,500	1,112,400
Other office expenses	328,700	328,700	657,400
Insurance and payroll taxes	217,400	370,300	587,700
Professional services	94,900	64,600	159,500
Board, committee and staff meetings	74,400	121,400	195,800
Writers' fees	66,000		66,000
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	12,900	92,300	105,200
General Service Conference		241,900	241,900
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	20,200	47,200	67,400
Regional Forums and other		96,300	96,300
Film development		28,500	28,500
Leasehold improvements	6,200	14,600	20,800
World Service Meeting		59,600	59,600
Self-Support Project		12,800	12,800
Computer Acquisition and Study		540,900	540,900
Board Expense — Int'l. Visits		65,300	65,300
Foreign literature assistance (net)	<u>100</u>		<u>100</u>
Total Expense	<u>3,114,500</u>	<u>5,260,000</u>	<u>8,374,500</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>650,700</u>	<u>(1,345,000)</u>	<u>(694,300)</u>

NOTE:

Extraordinary expenses: Computer system acquisition	<u>540,900</u>	<u>540,900</u>
Net Operating Income (Expense) exclusive of extraordinary expenses	<u>650,700</u>	<u>(804,100)</u>
		<u>(153,400)</u>

() denotes red figures

Footnote: This report reflects an allocation of costs based on a more direct costing assumption. Salaries were used as the basis for most "allocable" costs. Direct salaries for the publishing operation and services costs were arrived at first with the balance of administrative salaries distributed according to the relationship of the direct salaries. Related "allocable" costs, such as payroll taxes, insurance, and pension expansion, were distributed according to the salary distribution. The allocation of other items were determined on a line by line basis. This particular reallocation results in a greater shortfall than methods previously used. It should be noted that this report has been created for illustrative purposes only.

1988 Contributions From Groups — by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA								GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA							
AREA #	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA		AREA #	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA	
1. Ala./N.W. Fla.	359	215	59.9%	\$ 21,634.51	4,876	\$4.44		61. Rhode Island	192	113	58.9	18,785.00	3,843	4.89	
2. Alaska	199	97	48.7	7,931.29	2,602	3.05		62. South Carolina	250	164	65.6	22,012.22	4,247	5.18	
3. Arizona	663	344	51.4	39,475.85	11,184	3.53		63. South Dakota	137	66	48.2	6,630.58	2,683	2.47	
4. Arkansas	226	126	55.8	10,565.34	3,220	3.28		64. Tennessee	396	227	57.3	25,019.23	6,367	3.93	
California								Texas							
5. Southern	1,524	731	48.0	112,389.80	50,101	2.24		65. Northeast	392	225	57.4	40,658.82	11,230	3.62	
6. N. Coastal	1,724	1,161	67.3	188,111.59	43,255	4.35		66. Northwest	214	131	61.2	14,321.25	4,834	2.96	
7. N. Interior	544	301	55.3	39,114.12	12,016	3.26		67. Southeast	439	230	52.4	29,726.50	11,984	2.48	
8. San Diego/Imp.	616	330	53.6	40,219.00	16,866	2.38		68. Southwest	439	230	52.4	28,413.76	8,270	3.44	
9. Mid-South	1,377	731	53.1	80,753.89	42,549	1.90		69. Utah	219	134	61.2	13,786.97	3,913	3.52	
10. Colorado	541	333	61.6	39,343.69	12,675	3.10		70. Vermont	185	103	55.7	15,184.41	3,207	4.73	
11. Connecticut	1,047	576	55.0	80,175.12	21,620	3.71		71. Virginia	919	584	63.5	86,220.82	17,442	4.94	
12. Delaware	132	88	66.7	1,092.02	2,082	.52		72. Washington	1,018	576	56.6	81,563.15	18,466	4.42	
13. D.C.	360	229	63.6	44,596.02	11,523	3.87		73. West Virginia	237	130	54.9	10,160.81	2,687	3.78	
Florida								Wisconsin							
14. North	475	305	64.2	48,371.26	8,260	5.86		74. N.Wis./Upper							
15. South	1,185	662	55.9	106,523.37	19,931	5.34		Pen. Mich.	568	283	49.8	25,659.49	8,423	3.05	
16. Georgia	578	420	72.7	57,255.15	12,386	4.62		75. South	721	384	53.3	34,891.62	13,441	2.60	
17. Hawaii	209	160	76.6	22,744.07	3,626	6.27		76. Wyoming	129	75	58.1	5,506.83	1,973	2.79	
18. Idaho	174	106	60.9	10,785.72	2,075	5.20		77. Puerto Rico	115	81	70.4	4,330.30	1,480	2.93	
Illinois								78. Alberta/N.W.T.	531	251	47.3	26,942.57	6,956	3.87	
19. Chicago	908	404	44.5	57,293.73	21,049	2.72		79. B.C./Yukon	628	353	56.2	39,438.43	9,633	4.09	
20. North	776	399	51.4	39,678.97	13,944	2.85		80. Manitoba	151	64	42.4	7,546.30	3,405	2.22	
21. South	359	173	48.2	21,552.61	6,024	3.58		81. N.B./P.E.I.	228	112	49.1	6,861.79	3,210	2.14	
Indiana								82. N.S./Nfld./Lab.	263	130	49.4	9,707.96	3,063	3.17	
22. North	540	261	48.3	27,562.43	8,256	3.34		Ontario							
23. South	314	211	67.2	23,481.54	6,257	3.75		83. East	500	268	53.6	38,608.28	11,620	3.32	
24. Iowa	607	329	54.2	30,101.66	11,387	2.64		84. Northeast	186	64	34.4	11,616.15	2,228	5.21	
25. Kansas	356	219	61.5	25,639.47	8,333	3.08		85. Northwest	85	34	40.0	5,995.52	1,306	4.59	
26. Kentucky	475	312	65.7	50,166.48	7,619	6.58		86. West	429	204	47.6	37,065.03	7,327	5.06	
27. Louisiana	478	252	52.7	26,598.25	8,235	3.23		Quebec							
28. Maine	369	193	52.3	22,075.28	6,416	3.44		87. Southwest	558	389	69.7	32,372.21	14,435	2.24	
29. Maryland	699	403	57.7	52,460.65	9,813	5.35		88. Southeast	239	179	74.9	12,230.15	3,446	3.55	
Massachusetts								89. Northeast	333	270	81.0	19,501.91	6,230	3.13	
30. East	1,064	531	49.9	102,729.90	31,866	3.22		90. Northwest	318	261	82.0	59,700.00	5,717	10.44	
31. West	172	102	59.3	22,360.25	3,856	5.80		91. Saskatchewan	329	161	48.9	12,135.13	4,323	2.81	
Michigan								Total U.S./Canada	45,424	25,203	55.5%	\$3,310,555.83	916,398	\$3.61	
32. Central	438	232	53.0	34,140.17	9,149	3.73		Bahamas	8	2	25.0	110.00	119	.92	
33. Southeast	489	258	52.8	49,212.53	10,806	4.55		V.I. of U.S.	10	9	90.0	3,916.35	265	14.78	
34. West	359	209	58.2	26,607.64	6,828	3.90			45,442	25,214	55.5%	\$3,314,582.18	916,782	\$3.62	
Minnesota								Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings				\$ 209,782.96			
35. North	502	279	55.6	20,167.62	7,816	2.58		Specials				342,387.98			
36. South	943	441	46.8	40,359.68	25,762	1.57		Total for U.S. & Canada				\$3,866,753.12			
37. Mississippi	213	121	56.8	8,251.57	2,526	3.27		FOREIGN AND OTHER							
Missouri								Birds of a Feather				\$ 233.00			
38. East	478	264	55.2	32,264.92	6,696	4.82		Correctional facility groups				140.00			
39. West	221	139	62.9	18,008.51	4,718	3.82		Foreign				26,246.21			
40. Montana	321	143	44.5	12,301.58	3,986	3.09		International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.				500.00			
41. Nebraska	651	381	58.5	47,517.01	11,835	4.01		International Doctors in A.A.				42.00			
42. Nevada	267	134	50.2	14,275.93	4,029	3.54		International Lawyers in A.A.				3,000.00			
43. New Hampshire	364	214	58.8	30,397.22	4,808	6.32		Internationalists				477.35			
New Jersey								Loners				839.74			
44. North	1,095	521	47.6	80,770.45	23,695	3.41		Treatment facility meetings				1,644.95			
45. South	286	181	63.3	29,575.32	4,321	6.84		World Hello				89.64			
46. New Mexico	251	143	57.0	14,895.68	3,867	3.85		Grand Total				\$3,899,966.01			
New York															
47. Central	542	261	48.2	47,356.08	8,379	5.65									
48. H./M./B.	543	292	53.8	29,733.22	6,765	4.40									
49. Southeast	1,442	757	52.5	168,572.24	39,235	4.30									
50. West	244	115	47.1	11,397.75	3,530	3.23									
51. N. Carolina/Ber.	642	436	67.9	58,529.72	10,291	5.69									
52. North Dakota	170	106	62.4	7,301.26	2,827	2.58									
Ohio															
53. Cent. & S.E.	476	235	49.4	30,760.76	5,474	5.62									
54. Northeast	935	291	31.1	25,719.66	22,466	1.14									
55. N.W. Ohio/															
S.E. Mich.	224	123	54.9	16,922.15	3,075	5.50									
56. S.W. Ohio	390	215	55.1	22,788.77	7,277	3.13									
57. Oklahoma	340	271	79.7	26,546.78	4,868	5.45									
58. Oregon	609	350	57.5	41,096.05	8,806	4.67									
Pennsylvania															
59. East	988	577	58.4	89,419.06	22,625	3.95									
60. West	603	334	55.4	40,290.28	8,647	4.66									

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

② Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

1988 Total Contributions — by State / Province

U.S.	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alabama	272	158	58.1%	\$ 14,591.42	3,922	\$3.72
Alaska	199	97	48.7	9,369.45	2,602	3.60
Arizona	645	329	51.0	46,511.27	11,061	4.20
Arkansas	226	126	55.8	11,249.87	3,231	3.48
California	5,838	3,287	56.3	509,615.92	166,733	3.06
Colorado	542	334	61.6	48,354.80	12,682	3.81
Connecticut	1,056	582	55.1	100,810.99	21,869	4.61
Delaware	130	86	66.2	19,132.57	2,030	9.42
District of Columbia	164	93	56.7	22,834.98	5,356	4.26
Florida	1,747	1,025	58.7	216,271.32	29,489	7.33
Georgia	579	420	72.5	58,475.98	12,407	4.71
Hawaii	209	160	76.6	26,795.86	3,626	7.39
Idaho	221	125	56.6	12,862.15	2,561	5.02
Illinois	2,044	977	47.8	153,913.54	41,063	3.75
Indiana	884	491	55.5	58,273.92	14,939	3.90
Iowa	608	330	54.3	36,322.73	11,393	3.19
Kansas	354	218	61.6	28,997.66	8,308	3.49
Kentucky	445	292	65.6	53,777.32	7,217	7.45
Louisiana	479	252	52.6	28,629.72	8,243	3.47
Maine	355	187	52.7	29,153.21	6,265	4.65
Maryland	889	534	60.1	81,047.73	15,868	5.11
Massachusetts	1,264	642	50.8	136,451.46	36,226	3.77
Michigan	1,454	772	53.1	146,229.21	29,007	5.04
Minnesota	1,438	717	49.9	70,280.97	33,232	2.11
Mississippi	213	121	56.8	8,878.62	2,526	3.51
Missouri	699	403	57.7	60,951.14	11,470	5.31
Montana	321	143	44.5	15,488.08	3,986	3.89
Nebraska	652	382	58.6	57,727.77	11,846	4.87
Nevada	226	114	50.4	15,377.79	3,451	4.46
New Hampshire	366	215	58.7	33,667.34	4,805	7.01
New Jersey	1,379	702	50.9	141,045.37	27,966	5.04
New Mexico	249	147	59.0	20,800.58	3,754	5.54
New York	2,770	1,423	51.4	294,299.63	57,532	5.12
North Carolina	622	438	70.4	63,202.37	10,119	6.30
North Dakota	170	106	62.4	10,730.13	2,827	3.80
Ohio	2,011	858	42.7	117,870.43	37,706	3.13
Oklahoma	341	271	79.5	28,196.96	4,872	5.79
Oregon	610	351	57.5	55,201.24	8,790	6.28
Pennsylvania	1,614	923	57.2	140,827.76	31,585	4.46
Rhode Island	190	112	58.9	22,417.67	3,746	5.98
South Carolina	250	164	65.6	25,924.54	4,247	6.10
South Dakota	137	66	48.2	8,408.28	2,683	3.13
Tennessee	395	226	57.2	28,118.16	6,363	4.42
Texas	1,482	811	54.7	131,958.44	36,175	3.65
Utah	219	135	61.6	17,043.31	3,924	4.34
Vermont	186	103	55.4	16,562.15	3,240	5.11
Virginia	926	589	63.6	94,953.01	17,584	5.40
Washington	961	550	57.2	85,384.44	17,845	4.78
West Virginia	225	123	54.7	11,635.61	2,560	4.55
Wisconsin	1,150	607	52.8	62,900.92	20,493	3.07
Wyoming	132	78	59.1	5,866.88	2,015	2.91
Commonwealth of Puerto Rico	115	81	70.4	4,567.75	1,480	3.09
Bahama Islands	8	2	25.0	110.00	119	.92
Virgin Islands of U.S.	10	9	90.0	3,916.35	265	14.78
Bermuda	22	0	0	500.00	185	2.70
TOTAL for U.S.	40,693	22,487	55.9%	\$3,504,486.77	835,489	\$4.19

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

CANADA (stated in Canadian dollars)	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alberta	464	229	49.4%	43,128.91\$	6,180	6.98\$
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	171	88	51.5	6,704.71	2,135	3.14
Newfoundland	99	49	49.5	5,620.46	908	6.19
Nova Scotia	165	81	49.1	8,118.06	2,145	3.78
Prince Edward Island	73	30	41.1	3,356.17	1,288	2.61
Labrador	1	1	100.0	21.18	22	.96
British Columbia	664	367	55.3	52,740.67	10,099	5.22
Manitoba	151	64	42.4	10,374.59	3,405	3.05
N.W. Territories	29	8	27.6	678.21	312	2.17
Ontario	1,165	544	46.7	129,798.21	21,983	5.90
Quebec	1,429	1,101	77.0 ①	154,718.41	28,379	5.45
Saskatchewan	329	162	49.2	18,240.98	4,329	4.21
Yukon Territory	9	3	33.3	574.38	108	5.32
TOTAL for CANADA (Canadian dollars)	4,749	2,727 ①	57.4% ①	434,074.94\$	81,293	5.34\$ ①
(converted to U.S. dollars \$ 362,263.35						\$4.46)

TOTAL for U.S. (U.S. and CANADA dollars) 45,442 25,214 ① 55.5% ① \$3,866,750.12 916,782 \$4.22 ①

FOREIGN AND OTHER

Birds of a Feather	233.00
Correctional facility groups	140.00
Foreign	26,246.21
International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.	500.00
International Doctors in A.A.	42.00
International Lawyers in A.A.	3,000.00
Internationalists	477.35
Loners	839.74
Treatment facility meetings	1,644.95
World Hello	89.64
GRAND TOTAL	\$3,899,963.01

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON 1988-1987 (IN U.S. DOLLARS)

	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. 1988	40,693	22,487	55.9%	\$3,504,486.77	835,489	\$4.19
U.S. 1987	38,276	21,696	56.7	3,239,664.59	775,040	4.18
Increase (Decrease)	2,417	791	(0.8%)	\$ 264,822.18	60,449	\$.01
Canada 1988	4,749	2,727 ①	57.4% ①	\$ 362,263.35	81,293	\$4.46 ①
Canada 1987	4,654	2,591 ①	55.6 ①	376,271.47	78,057	4.82 ①
Increase (Decrease)	95	136	1.8%	\$ (14,008.12)	3,236	\$ (.36)
U.S. and Canada 1988	45,442	25,214 ①	55.5% ①	\$3,866,750.12	916,782	\$4.22 ①
U.S. and Canada 1987	42,930	24,287 ①	56.6 ①	3,615,936.06	853,097	4.24 ①
Increase (Decrease)	2,512	927	(1.1%)	\$ 250,814.06	63,685	\$ (.02)

1989 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Robert Barros
Dan Gramke
Ray Lynch
²Roger Mansfield
¹Bill Miller
Karen Norbert
Chuck Rice
Reba Warren

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Finance

¹Gerry Flegel
Jimmy Gann
²Irv Hanson
Bobby Hobson
Ginny Jackson
Jim Kenna
Hazel King
Dick Mabery

Secretary: Ed Gordon

Policy/Admissions

Maxine Cramer
Jim Drysdale
Robert Fitzsimons
²Richard Gadoury
Judy Mize
¹Dick Rowell
John Sullivan
Herb Wales

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

Treatment Facilities

Mary Beaudry
George Cerny
²John Dunn
Serge Filion
Juan Martinez
Annemarie Matulis
¹Jim Schneck
Frank Shea

Secretary: John Grant

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Mary Branche
Lucille Gifford
Joe McCoy
¹John MacDonald
Victor Rosario
²Bill Smeal
Ann White
Les Williams

Secretary: Richard Bush

Grapevine

Jim Engel
Katie Gellately
¹Leo Gregory
Paul Hart
Becky Hathaway
Frank King
Jerry Smith
²Arv Straatmeyer
Lonnie Williams

Secretary: Ann Warner

Public Information

Bonita Anselmo
Bobby Broussard
²Ken Gray
Herman Gremmels
¹Larry Nelson
Rosemary Palmeri
Jan Petska
Ernie Truax

Secretary: Betty Liddle

Trustees

Jean Bureau
Vern Bryce
Frances Cherry
Beth Cuny
²Elizabeth Currier
¹Tom Heidler
Scott Johnson
Tim Martin
Mike Oester

Secretary: Curtis Monahan

Correctional Facilities

Carol Casaleggio
Roger Crist
Gareth Davis
¹Jake Ham
²Carl McDonald
Frank Piazza
Bob Stenberg
Red Walker

Secretary: Pat Rosenstiel

Literature

Boyce Bengé
Bill Bungay
Mary Ann Cunningham
¹Dennis Daley
²Gay Garner
Jim Magee
Ed Minarik
Patti Walters
Larry Yarrington

Secretary: Lois Fisher

Report and Charter

Dave Allen
Carolyn Beaupre
Melvin Blades
²Simonne Clutts
¹Gerry Ouellette
George Reid
Bill Stigliano
Joyce Yourdon

Secretary: Eileen Gatz

1990 International Convention

Gareth Davis
Judy Mize
Bill Stigliano

Secretary: Curtis Monahan

John Sullivan
¹Lonnie Williams

1990 CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Conference Agenda	Robert Barros, Arkansas	Karen Norbert, S. Wisconsin
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Joe McCoy, Oklahoma	Les Williams, N.E. Texas
Correctional Facilities	Frank Piazza, California, N. Coastal	Roger Crist, Central Michigan
Finance	Dick Mabery, Hawaii	Ginny Jackson, E. Missouri
Grapevine	Katie Gellately, E. Ontario	Lonnie Williams, Washington
Literature	Bill Bungay, Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador	Mary Ann Cunningham, Virginia
Conference Policy/Admissions	Bob Fitzsimons, Connecticut	Jim Drysdale, Alabama/N.W. Florida
Public Information	Jan Petska, Iowa	Bobby Broussard, Louisiana
Conference Report and Charter	Joyce Yourdon, Nevada	Carolyn Beaupre, British Columbia/Yukon
Treatment Facilities	Annemarie Matulis, E. Massachusetts	George Cerny, S.E. Michigan
Committee on Trustees	Beth Cuny, S.E. Texas	Frances Cherry, S. Florida

¹ Chairperson

² Alternate Chairperson

1989 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Thomas Hills, *chairperson*
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Don Pritts
Joseph Rhoads
Jean Smith
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

Ruth Jagodzinski, *chairperson*
Norman Adams
Don Bruner
Phil Cels
Hugh Freyer
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Jan Kelly Williamson
Helen Turnquest, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

William Flynn, M.D., *chairperson*
Terry Barrett
Peter Brock
Don Bruner
Webb Johnson
John King
Don Pritts
John Sharkey
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Richard Bush, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

Amos Reed, *chairperson*
Don Bruner
Ray McDermott
Olga Morris
Don Pritts
Joseph Rhoads
Dennis Robbins
James Shannon
Jean Smith
Pat Rosensteil, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Robert Morse, *chairperson*
Phil Cels
William Croke
Hugh Freyer
Gary Glynn
Tom Hills
Joe Phelan
Shepherd Raimi
Amos Reed
Joseph Rhoads
Desmond Towey
John Whitehouse
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Dennis Manders, *senior advisor*
Edward Gordon, *secretary*

International

Don Pritts, *chairperson*
William Flynn, M.D.
Webb Johnson
Fran Polek
Amos Reed
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Desmond Towey
Sarah Price, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Joe Phelan, *chairperson*
Norman Adams
Phil Cels
Ruth Jagodzinski
Webb Johnson
Fran Polek
Shepherd Raimi
John Sharkey
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Curtis Monahan, *secretary*
— *International Convention*
Eileen Gatzka, *secretary*
— *Regional Forums*

Literature

John King, *chairperson*
Norman Adams
Don Bruner
Webb Johnson
Fran Polek
Jean Smith
Jan Kelly Williamson
Vincina McCarthy, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

Nominating

Shepherd Raimi, *chairperson*
William Croke
William Flynn, M.D.
Thomas Hills
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Ruth Jagodzinski
John King
Joe Phelan
John Whitehouse
Curtis Monahan, *secretary*

Public Information

John Whitehouse, *chairperson*
William Croke
Jill Hargrave
Alicia Martinez
Edward McDougal
Mary Ann Ryan
Jane Schulberg
John Sharkey
Desmond Towey
Betty Liddle, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

Jim Shannon, *chairperson*
James Ahern
Phil Cels
William Flynn, M.D.
Hugh Freyer
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Robert Lewis
Nancy McComas
Joe Phelan
Amos Reed
John Sharkey
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
John Grant, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

John Hartley Smith, M.D.,
chairperson
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*
All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S., and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Michael Alexander, Wayne Parks and John Bragg are ex officio members of all committees.



Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson
Michael Alexander
First vice-chairperson
William E. Flynn, M.D.
Second vice-chairperson
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Secretary
John R. Whitehouse
Treasurer
Robert Morse
Assistant secretary
Susan Ulseth
Assistant treasurer
Edward H. Gordon
The new slate of officers
(post-Conference)
is given on page 48.

1989 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Michael Alexander (460 Park Ave., New York, NY 10022) was elected chairperson of the board at the meeting following the 1988 Conference. Mike served as a trustee from 1976 to 1985, after 20 years as legal advisor to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, he was an associate of the late Bernard Smith — so significant in A.A. history. Mike is a director and past president of the British American Chamber of Commerce, director and national secretary of the Ireland-United States Council for Commerce and Industry, and trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society.

²**John Nelson Chappel, M.D.** (School of Medicine, University of Nevada, Reno, NV 89557) was elected to the board in 1989. A graduate of the University of Alberta Medical School, John has been professor of psychiatry, University of Nevada School of Medicine since 1974. He serves as consultant to many professional organizations and is widely published in the field of alcoholism.

¹**William E. Flynn, M.D.** (1254 Daleview Dr., McLean, VA 22102) joined the board in April 1980. A graduate of the Georgetown University School of Medicine, he is currently assistant professor of psychiatry at Georgetown and director of studies in alcohol and drug abuse. Bill chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee and serves on the Nominating, International and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D. (72 Downs Rd., Bethany, CT 06525) was elected to the board in April 1983. A graduate of McGill University, Montreal, and the University of Washington, Seattle, Joan taught sociology at both universities for many years. She has served on many local, state and national boards and committees on alcoholism and on health and human behavior. At the University of Washington Medical School in Seattle, she was involved in research and teaching about alcoholism, A.A., and Al-Anon. She serves on the Treatment Facilities, Archives, Conference and Nominating Committees.

John E. King (423 Hawthorn, Fayetteville, AR 72701) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of St. Mary's College, Kentucky, and Tulane University, Louisiana, John was an ordained priest and has a background in social work. Currently, he is on the faculty of the University of Arkansas in the Social Work Program, where he serves as consultant to many local, state, and regional agencies as well as in a treatment capacity. John has received numerous awards and honors for his professional and civic/community service. He chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community and Nominating Committees, as well as the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Robert P. Morse (96 Cove Rd., Oyster Bay, NY 11771) was elected to the board in April 1984 after serving as a consultant to the Finance Committee from April 1981. A graduate of the University of Pennsylvania, he has over 20 years' experience in the investment business, with an in-depth background in the fixed-income sector and management of equity portfolios. Robert is president of Morse Williams & Co., Inc., investment counselors, and is chairperson of the Wall Street Fund, a public mutual fund. He is also treasurer and an executive committee trustee of the Bermuda Biological Station for Research, Inc. Robert is chairperson of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.



John Nelson Chappel, M.D.

Amos E. Reed (2840 Holiday Dr. S., Salem, OR 97302) was elected to the board in April 1986. A graduate of McKendree College and Northern Illinois University, he has extensive background in corrections, education, and public welfare. He is past president of the American Correctional Association, National Association of State Correctional Administrators, and National Association of Training Schools and Juvenile Agencies and has received many awards for his services in corrections and other agencies. Retired from his position as Washington Secretary of Corrections, Amos has also held leadership positions in North Carolina, Florida, Oregon, and Illinois. He chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on the International, Treatment Facilities and Finance and Budgetary Committees.

John Hartley Smith, M.D. (828 West 10th Ave., Vancouver, B.C. V5Z 1L8, Canada) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of the Queens' University Medical School, Belfast, he has specialized in occupational medicine and public health and has served on many professional committees and advisory councils, both local and national. John has been assistant deputy minister in the British Columbia Ministry of Health since 1979; in 1986 he was appointed senior medical consultant in occupational and environmental health to the government. He was also a director of the American Board of Preventive Medicine and part-time clinical associate professor on the Faculty of Medicine at the University of British Columbia. John serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, International, International Convention/Regional Forums and Treatment Facilities Committees. He also chairs the General Sharing Session of the quarterly board meetings.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Donald J. Bruner (6420 Bluff Dr., Bloomington, MN 55438) was elected West Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1988. Don has been active in area activities from home group to intergroup board member, and served as Panel 33 Conference delegate. He was trained as a civil engineer and was an officer of an international construction company and has served on the boards of several construction and engineering companies. Don, who is now retired, serves on the Conference, C.P.C., Correctional Facilities and Literature Committees.

Phil J. Cels (5 Balmoral Bay, Brandon, Manitoba, Canada R7A 6E5), who was elected Western Canada trustee in April 1988, served as a Panel 32 Conference delegate. He is involved in C.P.C. and P.I. work for Southwest Manitoba, as well as being active in local A.A. activities. For the past 14 years Phil has been an account executive with a brokerage house. He serves on the Conference, Finance, International Convention/Regional Forums and Treatment Facilities Committees.

William H. (Bill) Croke (165 Perry Ave., Norwalk, CT 06850) was elected general service trustee in April 1986. He has been active in group service since 1970 and has served as A.A.W.S. director since 1983. Bill's background is in advertising/marketing, and he is currently a partner in a small advertising agency in New York City. Bill has been a member of the Public Information Committee since 1976. He also serves on the Finance and Nominating Committees and chairs the A.A.W.S. Board.

²**Harold Greene** (4 Windsor Terrace, White Plains, NY 10601) was elected general service trustee in April 1989. While serving on the Staten Island Council on Alcoholism, Harold helped set up the first detox unit on Staten Island. From 1984-88 he was a director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Currently, Harold is on the archives and P.I. committees in the Westchester District and on the board of N.C.A., Westchester Affiliate. He is currently involved in developing housing for the homeless.

Tom Hills (48 McGregor Road, Scarborough, ON M1P 1C8, Canada) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1986. Tom has been active in group, intergroup, and area service and was a Panel 33 Conference delegate. A former director of Ontario's Employees Benefits Branch, he recently served as a senior advisor to the Ontario Pensions Advisory Board. Tom chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the Finance and Nominating Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Ruth C. Jagodzinski (Sunrise Home Health Care, 3101 Maryland Pkwy., #104, Las Vegas, NV 89109), elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in April 1986, has been active in group, intergroup, and area service and was a Panel 29 Conference delegate. Ruth's background is in the home-health-care and nursing fields; she co-owns and administers a home-health-care program. She is a member of the governor's Advisory Board for Alcohol and Drug Abuse and vice-president of the We Care Foundation board of directors (a small rehabilitation house for alcoholic women). Ruth chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the International Convention/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees. She is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

W.F. (Webb) Johnson (1105 Palmerston Ave., West Vancouver, BC V7S 2J5, Canada), elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1987, has served his area as G.S.R., D.C.M., area treasurer, and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. Currently, Webb is a member of the finance committee for British Columbia/Yukon. A former stock broker and broker dealer, Webb is currently president of NTV Oil Services Industries, Inc. and director of U.C.A. Technologies, Inc. A golfer, Webb is also a member of the American Contract Bridge League. He serves on the Conference, International Convention/Regional Forums, International and Literature Committees.

²**Jacqueline Martin** (1305 Bluff Springs Ct., Louisville, KY 40223) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 1989. A Panel 30 delegate, Jackie has been active in her area's intergroup and treatment facilities committees and is past president of the Kentucky Alcoholism Council. With a background in real estate, Jackie recently went back to school to prepare for a new career in management.

¹**Joe Phelan** (272 The South Chace, Atlanta, GA 30328), elected Southeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1985, has been active in group and area service. As a Panel 30 Conference delegate, he chaired the Conference Finance Committee. Joe served on the Georgia Task Force on Alcohol, Marijuana, and Other Drugs and was president of the Metro Atlanta Council on Alcoholism. Now retired, his background is in the finance, marketing, and investment banking fields. Joe is chairperson of the International Convention/Regional Forum Committee and serves on the Finance and Budgetary, Nominating and Treatment Facilities Committees.

¹**Don I. Pritts** (1009 S. Lewiston Way, Aurora, CO 80017) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S., in April 1985. He has been active in group and area service and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. A part-time volunteer for adolescent treatment units, Don has been an employment counselor. Currently he is a sales director for the Conklin Company, establishing and training franchise holders. Don chairs the International Committee and serves on the Correctional Facilities, Cooperation With the Professional Community and Archives Committees.

²**John J. Quinn** (66 Brookwood Pkwy., Jackson, NJ 08527) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 1989. A Panel 35 delegate, he has also served his area as D.C.M., treasurer and area committee member. With a background in accounting, taxation and personnel, John is currently vice-president of a major international bank in New York City.

¹**Shepherd Raimi** (1040 Park Avenue, New York, N.Y. 10028), elected general service trustee in April 1985, is an active member of the Red Hook Group in Red Hook, N.Y. A native of Michigan, he is a lawyer in New York City, and has had a great deal of experience with the impaired lawyer and other aspects of law and alcoholism. Shep chairs the Nominating Committee and is also a member of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Finance Committees and a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

¹**James Shannon** (3106 Kingsbridge Ave., Bronx, NY 10463), elected general service trustee in April 1985, has been active in group, intergroup, and area service. He was a Panel 27 Conference delegate for Southeast New York and has been involved with the Grapevine, Public Information, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees as well as the S.E.N.Y. area convention. Jim worked as a supervisor at a management consulting firm and is now retired. He serves as a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board, is a member of the Conference Committee, and chairs the Treatment Facilities Committee.

John A. Sharkey (9 Valley Way, West Orange, NJ 07052). Elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1987, John is a past area chairperson and was a Panel 33 Conference delegate. He currently serves on the Essex County Alcoholism Advisory Board and was trustee of his intergroup committee. John, who owned and operated a tavern for seven years, is supply coordinator with New Jersey Bell Telephone Company. He is a member of the Cooperation With the Professional Community, International Convention/Regional Forums, Public Information and Treatment Facilities Committees.

²**Stanley N. Silverman** (137 E. 36th St., New York, NY 10016), who was elected a general service trustee in April 1989, served on the Grapevine editorial board and later on the Grapevine Corporate Board from 1983-87. During that time he was a member of the trustees' Finance, Retirement, Literature and Correctional Facilities Committees, as well as serving as treasurer of the Grapevine. Active at the group level, Stanley is a member of the American Institute of C.P.A.s and since 1985 has been a partner in a New York C.P.A. firm.

J. Desmond Towey (425 E. 58th St., #44, New York, NY 10022) was elected general service trustee in April 1988. Des's introduction to service work was as a consultant on the trustees' Public Information Committee. He is chairperson of the Grapevine Corporate Board and serves on the trustees' Public Information, Finance and International Committees. He is owner and president of a firm specializing in shareholder relations and marketing financial products.

¹**John R. (Jack) Whitehouse** (2981 Lakeview Dr., Sanford, MI 48657) was elected East Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1985. He has been active in group and area service and was a Panel 31 (Central Michigan, Area 32) Conference delegate. A practicing attorney for 30 years, he now serves as a mediator for the Workers' Disability Compensation Bureau for the State of Michigan's Department of Labor. Jack is chairperson of the Public Information Committee and serves on the Finance and Budgetary and Nominating Committees and the Grapevine Corporate Board.

²**Jan Whitney** (9700 Avalon Rd., Greenville, MI 48838) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 1989. A Panel 36 delegate, she has served as area secretary, chaired state conferences and assemblies, and chaired the board of the local chapter of N.C.A. Now retired, Jan's professional background was in business and real estate.

Jan Kelly Williamson (3208 Lampliter, El Paso, TX 79925), elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1987, has been active in her local intergroup, N.W. Texas Area, and in the Southwest Regional Delegate Assembly; she was a Panel 28 Conference delegate. A retired executive secretary, Jan serves on the boards of several local and state associations that deal with alcohol and drug abuse. Jan is primarily involved with local A.A. and her four grandchildren. She serves on the A.A.W.S. Board and the Conference, Literature, and Archives Committees.

¹ Rotating at the close of the 1989 Conference meeting.

² New trustee, elected by the General Service Board, April 29, 1989.



A.A. World Services Directors

William Croke, *chairperson*
John Bragg
Hugh Freyer
Ruth Jagodzinski
Shepherd Raimi

Joseph Rhoads
Jean Smith
Susan Ulseth
Jan Kelly Williamson

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Desmond Towey, *chairperson*
Norman Adams
Thomas Hills
John King
Fran Polek

Jim Shannon
Ames Sweet
Ann Warner
John Whitehouse

General Service Office Staff

Wayne Parks, *general manager*
John Bragg, *president, A.A.W.S., Inc.*
Richard Bush
Lois Fisher
Eileen Gatzka
John Grant
Betty Liddle
Curtis Monahan

Sarah Price
Pat Rosenstiel
Helen Turnquest
Susan Ulseth
Tom Jasper, *services director*
Frank Mauser, *archivist*
Vicente Mejia, *Spanish services*

Grapevine Staff

Ames Sweet Ann Warner

Others Assisting at the Conference (nonvoting)

Rosa Blanco, *financial secretary*
Chris Bradley, *supervisor, data processing*
Jenice Cameron, *Grapevine editorial secretary*
Joseph Dennan, *staff assistant*
John de Stefano, *editor*
Owen Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
Elizabeth Garcia, *manager, staff assistant/clerical department*
Edward Gordon, *director of finance/business administrator*
Lee Halligan, *director, human resources*
Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
Robert Hiltsey, *staff assistant*
Margie Janicek, *clerical*
John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller*
Steve Linek, *purchasing department*
Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
Jim McConnell, *designer, Conference Report*
Don Meurer, *Grapevine controller/business administrator*
Nancy Moore, *editor*
John Nayduch, *Grapevine art director*
Carol Nielsen, *records department*
Dorothy Phillips, *staff assistant*
Eve Ponzo, *staff assistant*
Edward Reilly, *data processing manager, systems & operations*
Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
Frank Segui, *staff assistant*
Darlene Smith, *staff assistant*
Joan Smith, *staff assistant*
Naomi Strassberg, *Grapevine administrative assistant*
Shirley Sykes, *staff assistant*
Gregg Talley, *events coordinator*
Cynthia White, *staff assistant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*

Trustees emeritus

Gordon Patrick

All nontrustee, nondirector members of the trustees' committees are encouraged to attend and participate at the joint meetings. They are also encouraged to attend, as observers, the Monday sessions of the Conference and one presentation session related to the committee on which they serve.

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 39th Conference includes Panel 38 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 39 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	39	Jim Drysdale, 739 Milgray Ln., Bessemer, AL 35020
Alaska	2	38	Simonne Clutts, Box 154, Anchor Point, AK 99556
Arizona	3	38	John H. Dunn, 7080 W. Bopp Rd., Tucson, AZ 85746
Arkansas	4	39	Robert Barros, 10901 Yosemite Valley Dr., Little Rock, AR 72212
California Southern	5	39	Juan Martinez, 15769 Loukelton St., La Puente, CA 91744
Northern Coastal	6	39	Frank A. Piazza, 2201 Valley Ct., #2, Belmont, CA 94002
Northern Interior	7	38	Tim Martin, 2600 Queenswood Dr., Rancho Cordova, CA 95670
San Diego/Imperial	8	38	Larry Nelson, 854 "A" Hollister St., San Diego, CA 92154
Mid-Southern	9	38	Maxine Cramer, 423 N. Emily St., Anaheim, CA 92805
Colorado	10	39	Frank King, 5435 W. Leawood Dr., Littleton, CO 80123
Connecticut	11	39	Robert FitzSimons, 32 Lydia St., Waterbury, CT 06705
Delaware	12	38	James Magee, Box 185, Ocean View, DE 19970
District of Columbia	13	39	Ann White, 3639 Cousins Dr., Landover, MD 20785
Florida North	14	39	Jimmy Gann, 1544 Landon Ave., Apt. 2, Jacksonville, FL 32207
South	15	39	Frances Cherry, 3901 S.E. St. Lucie Blvd., #14, Stuart, FL 34997
Georgia	16	38	Gay Garner, 528 Hammett Dr., Decatur, GA 30032
Hawaii	17	39	Lester Mabery, 7007 Niumalu Loop, Honolulu, HI 96825

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Idaho	18	38	Irv Hanson, 744 Tenth, Idaho Falls, ID 83404	Missouri Eastern	38	39	Ginny Jackson, 11597 Esperanza, Florissant, MO 63033
Illinois Chicago	19	39	James Engel, 672 Lakeview, #2C, Wheeling, IL 60090	Western	39	39	John Sullivan, HCR 81, Box 17-B, Cassville, MO 65625
Northern	20	38	Dennis Daley, 3903 John St., McHenry, IL 60050	Montana	40	38	Edward Minarik, 714 W. Thrush Ln., Glendive, MT 59330
Southern	21	39	Herman Gremmels, RR #4, T5, Waterloo, IL 62298	Nebraska	41	38	Bill Smeal, Box 62, Snyder, NE 68664
Indiana Northern	22	39	Michael Oester, 1031 Tulip Ln., Lafayette, IN 47904	Nevada	42	39	Joyce Yourdon, 365 Denslowe Dr., Reno, NV 89512
Southern	23	38	Bobby J. Hobson, 303 S. Airport Rd., Seymour, IN 47274	New Hampshire	43	38	Lucille M. Gifford, 124 Mammoth Rd., A-3, Hookset, NH 03106
Iowa	24	39	Janet Petska, 814 E. Fifth St., Spencer, IA 51301	New Jersey Northern	44	39	Carol Casaleggio, 24 Portland Ave., Fanwood, NJ 07023
Kansas	25	38	Tom Heidler, 1502 First Ave., Dodge City, KS 66212	Southern	45	38	Bonita M. Anselmo, Box 443, Pleasantville, NJ 08232
Kentucky	26	38	Paul Hart, 1554 Meadow Hill Ct., Florence, KY 41042	New Mexico	46	38	Ernest L. Truax, 7017 Edwina N.E., Albuquerque, NM 87110
Louisiana	27	39	Bobby Broussard, 106 Ave. C, Broussard, LA 70518	New York Central	47	39	Rosemary Palmeri, 12 Hilltop Dr., Pittsford, NY 14534
Maine	28	38	Jacob B. Ham, RFD 1, Box 1400, Winthrop, ME 04364	Hudson/Mohawk /Berkshire	48	38	Elizabeth Currier, Box 201, West Winfield, NY 13491
Maryland	29	38	Dick Rowell, 18 Carvel Circle, Edgewater, MD 21037	Southeast	49	39	Boyce Bengé, 73 Washington Ave., Brooklyn, NY 11205
Massachusetts Eastern	30	39	Annmarie Matulis, 140 Myrtle St., Brockton, MA 02401	Western	50	38	Leo A. Gregory, 48 Park Blvd., Lancaster, NY 14086
Western	31	38	Gerard Ouellette, 10 Belvidere St., Springfield, MA 01108	North Carolina/ Bermuda	51	39	Judy Mize, Box 5586, Cary, NC 27511
Michigan Central	32	39	Roger Crist, 1501 W. Stewart, Owosso, MI 48867	North Dakota	52	38	R.B. (Bob) Stenberg, RR1, Lake Metigoshe, Bottineau, ND 58318
Southeastern	33	39	George Cerny, 815 12th St., Port Huron, MI 48060	Ohio Central & Southeast	53	39	Melvin Blades, 358 Wilson Ave., Columbus, OH 43205
Western	34	38	Roger Mansfield, 242 Ives S.E., Grand Rapids, MI 49504	Northeast	54	39	Mary Branche, 1882 Forest Hills Blvd., #4, E. Cleveland, OH 44112
Minnesota Northern	35	38	Laurel Johnson, 209 S. First St. W., Aurora, MN 55705	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	55	38	Rebekah Hathaway, Box 145, Woodville, OH 43469
Southern	36	39	L.C. (Chuck) Rice, 2820 Jewel Ln., Plymouth, MN 55447	Southwest	56	38	Kenneth O. Gray, Box 284, Waynesville, OH 45068
Mississippi	37	38	Carl McDonald, 5859 Ferncreek Dr., Jackson, MS 39211	Oklahoma	57	39	Joe McCoy, 6910 S. 32nd Ave., Tulsa, OK 74132
				Oregon	58	38	Ray Lynch, 3404 N.E. Tillamook St., Portland, OR 97212

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Pennsylvania			
<i>Eastern</i>	59	39	Reba Warren, 5129 Knox St., Philadelphia, PA 19144
<i>Western</i>	60	39	William Stigliano, 7051 Kane Rd., Transfer, PA 16154
Rhode Island	61	38	Mary Beaudry, 54 Beach St., Coventry, RI 02816
South Carolina	62	38	James Kenna, 111 Axtel Dr., Summerville, SC 29483
South Dakota	63	38	Arvid Straatmeyer, 610 Garfield, R-4, Lennox, SD 57039
Tennessee	64	38	R. David Allen, 108 N. Greenwood St., Lebanon, TN 37087
Texas			
<i>Northeast</i>	65	39	Les Williams, 505 Cates Dr., Kaufman, TX 75142
<i>Northwest</i>	66	38	Herbert V. Wales, Box 11051, Midland, TX 79702-7051
<i>Southeast</i>	67	39	Beth Cuny, 215 Stratton Ridge Rd., #47, Clute, TX 77531
<i>Southwest</i>	68	38	Larry Yarrington, Box 208, La Coste, TX 78039
Utah	69	39	Patricia Walters, 4939 Old Post Rd., #112, Ogden, UT 84403
Vermont	70	38	William G. Miller, Box 23, Townshend, VT 05353
Virginia	71	39	Mary Ann Cunningham, Rt. 1, Box 143, Crimore, VA 24431-9714
Washington	72	39	Lonnie Williams, 4708 241st S.W., Mountlake Terrace, WA 98043
West Virginia	73	39	Jerry Smith, Box 2013, Huntington, WV 25720
Wisconsin			
<i>N. Wisconsin/ Up. Pen. Mich.</i>	74	38	James M. Schneck, 3833 Carl St., Wausau, WI 54401
<i>Southern</i>	75	39	Karen Raschella-Norbert, 2216 Kinzie Ave., Racine, WI 53405
Wyoming	76	38	Dan Gramke, Box 1481, Evanston, WY 82930
Puerto Rico	77	38	Victor Rosario, Box 823, Manati, PR 00701

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta / Northwest Territories	78	38	Red Walker, 9837 110th St., Apt. 1502, Edmonton, AB T5K 2L8
British Columbia / Yukon	79	39	Carolyn Beaupre, 1155 W. 11th Ave., Suite 104, Vancouver, BC V6H 1K4
Manitoba	80	38	Vern Bryce, 768 Berkley Ave., Winnipeg, MB R3R 1K3
New Brunswick / Prince Edward Island	81	38	George Reid, Box 568, Cornwall, PEI C1A 8W4
Nova Scotia / Newfoundland / Labrador	82	39	William Bungay, 24 Johnsons Rd., Corner Brook, NF A2H 1V8
Ontario			
<i>Eastern</i>	83	39	Elizabeth Gellately, Box 403, Long Sault, ON K0C 1P0
<i>Northeast</i>	84	39	Hazel King, 367 Regina St., North Bay, ON P1B 2J7
<i>Northwest</i>	85	39	Gareth Davis, Box 189, Red Lake, ON P0V 2M0
<i>Western</i>	86	38	Frank Shea, 140 Danforth, Learnington, ON N8H 2R2
Quebec			
<i>Southwest</i>	87	38	John MacDonald, Box 111, St. Laurent, PQ H4L 4V4
<i>Southeast</i>	88	39	Jean Bureau, 217 Route 281, St. Magloire de Bellechasse, PQ G0R 3M0
<i>Northeast</i>	89	39	Serge Fillion, 1335, de la Belle- Vue, Cap Rouge, PQ G1Y 2S9
<i>Northwest</i>	90	38	Richard Gadoury, B.P. 531, Piedmont, PQ J0R 1K0
Saskatchewan	91	38	Gerry Flegel, Box 1246, Humboldt, SK S0K 2A0



When Juan Martinez, delegate from Southern California, was asked to comment on the Spanish public service announcements he went to the mike and began to speak in Spanish.